



EUROPEAN INNOVATION COUNCIL AND SMES EXECUTIVE AGENCY (EISMEA)

EISMEA.I – Innovation Ecosystems, SMP/Entrepreneurship and Consumers
I.1 – EU and place-based Innovation Ecosystems

GRANT AGREEMENT

Project 101158152 — EVOLVE2CARE

PREAMBLE

This **Agreement** ('the Agreement') is **between** the following parties:

on the one part,

the **European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA)** ('EU executive agency' or 'granting authority'), under the powers delegated by the European Commission ('European Commission'),

and

on the other part,

1. 'the coordinator':

ARISTOTELIO PANEPISTIMIO THESSALONIKIS (AUTH), PIC 999895692, established in KEDEA BUILDING, TRITIS SEPTEMVRIOU, ARISTOTLE UNIVERSITY CAMPUS, THESSALONIKI 546 36, Greece,

and the following other beneficiaries, if they sign their 'accession form' (see Annex 3 and Article 40):

2. **EUROPEAN NETWORK OF LIVING LABS IVZW (ENoLL IVZW)**, PIC 984556306, established in KUNSTLAAN 6, SINT JOOST TEN NOODE 1210, Belgium,

3. **ANTHOLOGY VENTURES JSC (AV)**, PIC 895312523, established in 37 G. BENKOVSKI STR. 1ST FLOOR OBOR, SOFIA 1000, Bulgaria,

4. **SPLOROTECH SL (SPLORO)**, PIC 890190147, established in PARQUE TOMAS CABALLERO 2 PLANTA PRIMERA OFICINA 1, PAMPLONA 31006, Spain,

5. **VILABS (CY) LTD (VILABS)**, PIC 917943205, established in VICTORY HOUSE 205 ARCHBISHOP MAKARIOS, LIMASSOL 3030, Cyprus,

Unless otherwise specified, references to 'beneficiary' or 'beneficiaries' include the coordinator and affiliated entities (if any).

If only one beneficiary signs the grant agreement ('mono-beneficiary grant'), all provisions referring to the 'coordinator' or the 'beneficiaries' will be considered — mutatis mutandis — as referring to the beneficiary.

The parties referred to above have agreed to enter into the Agreement.

By signing the Agreement and the accession forms, the beneficiaries accept the grant and agree to implement the action under their own responsibility and in accordance with the Agreement, with all the obligations and terms and conditions it sets out.

The Agreement is composed of:

Preamble

Terms and Conditions (including Data Sheet)

Annex 1 Description of the action¹

Annex 2 Estimated budget for the action

Annex 3 Accession forms (if applicable)²

Annex 3a Declaration on joint and several liability of affiliated entities (if applicable)³

Annex 4 Model for the financial statements

Annex 5 Specific rules (if applicable)

¹ Template published on [Portal Reference Documents](#).

² Template published on [Portal Reference Documents](#).

³ Template published on [Portal Reference Documents](#).

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

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DATA SHEET

1. General data

Project summary:

Project summary
Charting a course for a more resilient and patient-centric healthcare future depends on continuous development and delivery of innovation to the market. EVOLVE2CARE focuses on HealthTech experimentation practice frameworks, standardizing and enhancing the symbiotic relationship between living labs and innovators in the context of the Transitional Care sector. Challenges ranging from an aging population to complexity of medical conditions and regulatory frameworks, bring a growing recognition of the importance of experimentation practices. By subjecting innovations to real-world scenarios, experimentation uncovers complexities, ethical considerations, interoperability challenges, and unforeseen barriers that controlled environments may not reveal. By harnessing the power of Living Labs – real-world environments involving users and stakeholders – EVOLVE2CARE will provide innovators with access to services for testing/validating research and products. EVOLVE2CARE focuses on three Use Cases (Hospital Discharge Management, Homecare Monitoring Solutions, Aging Population & Care Transitions), engaging stakeholders from across the value chain to examine complexities, barriers and enablers that regulatory frameworks pose to the development and commercialization of healthcare innovations. Recognizing the cross-disciplinary nature of healthcare, we will engage with EIT KICs and their beneficiaries. We will provide a scalable, collaborative experimentation space (the AccelUP marketplace), to aggregate Living Labs, innovators, researchers, regulators, investors, and other pertinent stakeholders. Trainings workshops, and reports will increase knowledge and disseminate findings to our stakeholders. The project partners encompass vast expertise and networks covering the development/commercialization of innovation in transitional care. The project advisory board consists of C-Level Experts in Healthcare/Pharma, Living Labs, Startups, EIT programs and Regulatory issues.

Keywords:

- Demand driven innovation
- Innovation support services
- Knowledge transfer
- Regulatory framework for innovation
- Experimentation Practice Frameworks, Living Labs, Transitional Care, HealthTech innovations

Project number: 101158152

Project name: Engaging the Value Of Living Labs to Innovate Care And Regulatory Environments

Project acronym: EVOLVE2CARE

Call: HORIZON-EIE-2023-CONNECT-02

Topic: HORIZON-EIE-2023-CONNECT-02-01

Type of action: HORIZON Coordination and Support Actions

Granting authority: European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency

Grant managed through EU Funding & Tenders Portal: Yes (eGrants)

Project starting date: fixed date: 1 October 2024

Project end date: 30 September 2026

Project duration: 24 months

Consortium agreement: Yes

2. Participants

List of participants:

N°	Role	Short name	Legal name	Ctry	PIC	Max grant amount
1	COO	AUTH	ARISTOTELIO PANEPISTIMIO THESSALONIKIS	EL	999895692	229 562.50

N°	Role	Short name	Legal name	Ctry	PIC	Max grant amount
2	BEN	ENoLL IVZW	EUROPEAN NETWORK OF LIVING LABS IVZW	BE	984556306	214 500.00
3	BEN	AV	ANTHOLOGY VENTURES JSC	BG	895312523	228 730.14
4	BEN	SPLORO	SPLOROTECH SL	ES	890190147	180 312.50
5	BEN	VILABS	VILABS (CY) LTD	CY	917943205	134 125.00
Total						987 230.14

Coordinator:

– ARISTOTELIO PANEPISTIMIO THESSALONIKIS (AUTH)

3. Grant

Maximum grant amount, total estimated eligible costs and contributions and funding rate:

Maximum grant amount (Annex 2)	Maximum grant amount (award decision)
987 230.14	987 230.14

Grant form: Lump Sum

Grant mode: Action grant

Budget categories/activity types: Lump sum contributions

Cost eligibility options: n/a

Budget flexibility: No

4. Reporting, payments and recoveries**4.1 Continuous reporting** (art 21)

Deliverables: see Funding & Tenders Portal Continuous Reporting tool

4.2 Periodic reporting and payments

Reporting and payment schedule (art 21, 22):

Reporting					Payments	
Reporting periods			Type	Deadline	Type	Deadline (time to pay)
RP No	Month from	Month to				
					Initial prefinancing	30 days from entry into force/10 days before starting date – whichever is the latest
					Interim payment	90 days from receiving periodic report
					Final payment	90 days from receiving periodic report
1	1	12	Periodic report	60 days after end of reporting period		
2	13	24	Periodic report	60 days after end of reporting period		

Prefinancing payments and guarantees:

Prefinancing payment	
Type	Amount
Prefinancing 1 (initial)	789 784.11

Reporting and payment modalities (art 21, 22):

Mutual Insurance Mechanism (MIM): Yes

MIM contribution: 5% of the maximum grant amount (49 361.51), retained from the initial prefinancing

Restrictions on distribution of initial prefinancing: The prefinancing may be distributed only if the minimum number of beneficiaries set out in the call conditions (if any) have acceded to the Agreement and only to beneficiaries that have acceded.

Interim payment ceiling (if any): 90% of the maximum grant amount

No-profit rule: n/a

Late payment interest: ECB + 3.5%

Bank account for payments:

GR4501722020005202002079917 PIRBGRAA

Conversion into euros: n/a

Reporting language: Language of the Agreement

4.3 Certificates (art 24): n/a

4.4 Recoveries (art 22)

First-line liability for recoveries:

Beneficiary termination: Beneficiary concerned

Final payment: Each beneficiary for their own debt

After final payment: Beneficiary concerned

Joint and several liability for enforced recoveries (in case of non-payment):

Individual financial responsibility: Each beneficiary is liable only for its own debts (and those of its affiliated entities, if any)

Joint and several liability of affiliated entities — n/a

5. Consequences of non-compliance, applicable law & dispute settlement forum**Suspension and termination:**

Additional suspension grounds (art 31)

Additional termination grounds (art 32)

Applicable law (art 43):



Standard applicable law regime: EU law + law of Belgium

Dispute settlement forum (art 43):

Standard dispute settlement forum:

EU beneficiaries: EU General Court + EU Court of Justice (on appeal)

Non-EU beneficiaries: Courts of Brussels, Belgium (unless an international agreement provides for the enforceability of EU court judgements)

6. Other

Specific rules (Annex 5): Yes

Standard time-limits after project end:

Confidentiality (for X years after final payment): 5

Record-keeping (for X years after final payment): 5 (or 3 for grants of not more than EUR 60 000)

Reviews (up to X years after final payment): 2

Audits (up to X years after final payment): 2

Extension of findings from other grants to this grant (no later than X years after final payment): 2

Impact evaluation (up to X years after final payment): 5 (or 3 for grants of not more than EUR 60 000)

CHAPTER 1 GENERAL

ARTICLE 1 — SUBJECT OF THE AGREEMENT

This Agreement sets out the rights and obligations and terms and conditions applicable to the grant awarded for the implementation of the action set out in Chapter 2.

ARTICLE 2 — DEFINITIONS

For the purpose of this Agreement, the following definitions apply:

Actions — The project which is being funded in the context of this Agreement.

Grant — The grant awarded in the context of this Agreement.

EU grants — Grants awarded by EU institutions, bodies, offices or agencies (including EU executive agencies, EU regulatory agencies, EDA, joint undertakings, etc.).

Participants — Entities participating in the action as beneficiaries, affiliated entities, associated partners, third parties giving in-kind contributions, subcontractors or recipients of financial support to third parties.

Beneficiaries (BEN) — The signatories of this Agreement (either directly or through an accession form).

Affiliated entities (AE) — Entities affiliated to a beneficiary within the meaning of Article 187 of EU Financial Regulation 2018/1046⁴ which participate in the action with similar rights and obligations as the beneficiaries (obligation to implement action tasks and right to charge costs and claim contributions).

Associated partners (AP) — Entities which participate in the action, but without the right to charge costs or claim contributions.

Purchases — Contracts for goods, works or services needed to carry out the action (e.g. equipment, consumables and supplies) but which are not part of the action tasks (see Annex 1).

Subcontracting — Contracts for goods, works or services that are part of the action tasks (see Annex 1).

In-kind contributions — In-kind contributions within the meaning of Article 2(36) of EU Financial

⁴ For the definition, see Article 187 Regulation (EU, Euratom) 2018/1046 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 18 July 2018 on the financial rules applicable to the general budget of the Union, amending Regulations (EU) No 1296/2013, (EU) No 1301/2013, (EU) No 1303/2013, (EU) No 1304/2013, (EU) No 1309/2013, (EU) No 1316/2013, (EU) No 223/2014, (EU) No 283/2014, and Decision No 541/2014/EU and repealing Regulation (EU, Euratom) No 966/2012 ('EU Financial Regulation') (OJ L 193, 30.7.2018, p. 1): "**affiliated entities** [are]:

- (a) entities that form a sole beneficiary [(i.e. where an entity is formed of several entities that satisfy the criteria for being awarded a grant, including where the entity is specifically established for the purpose of implementing an action to be financed by a grant)];
- (b) entities that satisfy the eligibility criteria and that do not fall within one of the situations referred to in Article 136(1) and 141(1) and that have a link with the beneficiary, in particular a legal or capital link, which is neither limited to the action nor established for the sole purpose of its implementation".

Regulation 2018/1046, i.e. non-financial resources made available free of charge by third parties.

Fraud — Fraud within the meaning of Article 3 of EU Directive 2017/1371⁵ and Article 1 of the Convention on the protection of the European Communities' financial interests, drawn up by the Council Act of 26 July 1995⁶, as well as any other wrongful or criminal deception intended to result in financial or personal gain.

Irregularities — Any type of breach (regulatory or contractual) which could impact the EU financial interests, including irregularities within the meaning of Article 1(2) of EU Regulation 2988/95⁷.

Grave professional misconduct — Any type of unacceptable or improper behaviour in exercising one's profession, especially by employees, including grave professional misconduct within the meaning of Article 136(1)(c) of EU Financial Regulation 2018/1046.

Applicable EU, international and national law — Any legal acts or other (binding or non-binding) rules and guidance in the area concerned.

Portal — EU Funding & Tenders Portal; electronic portal and exchange system managed by the European Commission and used by itself and other EU institutions, bodies, offices or agencies for the management of their funding programmes (grants, procurements, prizes, etc.).

CHAPTER 2 ACTION

ARTICLE 3 — ACTION

The grant is awarded for the action **101158152 — EVOLVE2CARE** ('action'), as described in Annex 1.

ARTICLE 4 — DURATION AND STARTING DATE

The duration and the starting date of the action are set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 1).

CHAPTER 3 GRANT

ARTICLE 5 — GRANT

5.1 Form of grant

⁵ Directive (EU) 2017/1371 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 5 July 2017 on the fight against fraud to the Union's financial interests by means of criminal law (OJ L 198, 28.7.2017, p. 29).

⁶ OJ C 316, 27.11.1995, p. 48.

⁷ Council Regulation (EC, Euratom) No 2988/95 of 18 December 1995 on the protection of the European Communities financial interests (OJ L 312, 23.12.1995, p. 1).

The grant is an action grant⁸ which takes the form of a lump sum grant for the completion of work packages.

5.2 Maximum grant amount

The maximum grant amount is set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 3) and in the estimated budget (Annex 2).

5.3 Funding rate

Not applicable

5.4 Estimated budget, budget categories and forms of funding

The estimated budget for the action (lump sum breakdown) is set out in Annex 2.

It contains the estimated eligible contributions for the action (lump sum contributions), broken down by participant and work package.

Annex 2 also shows the types of contributions (forms of funding)⁹ to be used for each work package.

5.5 Budget flexibility

Budget flexibility does not apply; changes to the estimated budget (lump sum breakdown) always require an amendment (see Article 39).

Amendments for transfers between *work packages* are moreover possible only if:

- the work packages concerned are not already completed (and declared in a financial statement) and
- the transfers are justified by the technical implementation of the action.

ARTICLE 6 — ELIGIBLE AND INELIGIBLE CONTRIBUTIONS

6.1 and 6.2 General and specific eligibility conditions

Lump sum contributions are eligible ('eligible contributions'), if:

- (a) they are set out in Annex 2 and
- (b) the work packages are completed and the work is properly implemented by the beneficiaries and/or the results are achieved, in accordance with Annex 1 and during in the period set out in Article 4 (with the exception of work/results relating to the submission of the final periodic report, which may be achieved afterwards; see Article 21)

They will be calculated on the basis of the amounts set out in Annex 2.

⁸ For the definition, see Article 180(2)(a) EU Financial Regulation 2018/1046: '**action grant**' means an EU grant to finance "an action intended to help achieve a Union policy objective".

⁹ See Article 125 EU Financial Regulation 2018/1046.

6.3 Ineligible contributions

‘Ineligible contributions’ are:

- (a) lump sum contributions that do not comply with the conditions set out above (see Article 6.1 and 6.2)
- (b) lump sum contributions for activities already funded under other EU grants (or grants awarded by an EU Member State, non-EU country or other body implementing the EU budget), except for the following case:
 - (i) Synergy actions: not applicable
- (c) other:
 - (i) country restrictions for eligible costs: not applicable.

6.4 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary declares lump sum contributions that are ineligible, they will be rejected (see Article 27).

This may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

CHAPTER 4 GRANT IMPLEMENTATION

SECTION 1 CONSORTIUM: BENEFICIARIES, AFFILIATED ENTITIES AND OTHER PARTICIPANTS

ARTICLE 7 — BENEFICIARIES

The beneficiaries, as signatories of the Agreement, are fully responsible towards the granting authority for implementing it and for complying with all its obligations.

They must implement the Agreement to their best abilities, in good faith and in accordance with all the obligations and terms and conditions it sets out.

They must have the appropriate resources to implement the action and implement the action under their own responsibility and in accordance with Article 11. If they rely on affiliated entities or other participants (see Articles 8 and 9), they retain sole responsibility towards the granting authority and the other beneficiaries.

They are jointly responsible for the *technical* implementation of the action. If one of the beneficiaries fails to implement their part of the action, the other beneficiaries must ensure that this part is implemented by someone else (without being entitled to an increase of the maximum grant amount and subject to an amendment; see Article 39). The *financial* responsibility of each beneficiary in case of recoveries is governed by Article 22.

The beneficiaries (and their action) must remain eligible under the EU programme funding the grant

for the entire duration of the action. Lump sum contributions will be eligible only as long as the beneficiary and the action are eligible.

The **internal roles and responsibilities** of the beneficiaries are divided as follows:

(a) Each beneficiary must:

- (i) keep information stored in the Portal Participant Register up to date (see Article 19)
- (ii) inform the granting authority (and the other beneficiaries) immediately of any events or circumstances likely to affect significantly or delay the implementation of the action (see Article 19)
- (iii) submit to the coordinator in good time:
 - the prefinancing guarantees (if required; see Article 23)
 - the financial statements and certificates on the financial statements (CFS): not applicable
 - the contribution to the deliverables and technical reports (see Article 21)
 - any other documents or information required by the granting authority under the Agreement
- (iv) submit via the Portal data and information related to the participation of their affiliated entities.

(b) The coordinator must:

- (i) monitor that the action is implemented properly (see Article 11)
- (ii) act as the intermediary for all communications between the consortium and the granting authority, unless the Agreement or granting authority specifies otherwise, and in particular:
 - submit the prefinancing guarantees to the granting authority (if any)
 - request and review any documents or information required and verify their quality and completeness before passing them on to the granting authority
 - submit the deliverables and reports to the granting authority
 - inform the granting authority about the payments made to the other beneficiaries (report on the distribution of payments; if required, see Articles 22 and 32)
- (iii) distribute the payments received from the granting authority to the other beneficiaries without unjustified delay (see Article 22).

The coordinator may not delegate or subcontract the above-mentioned tasks to any other beneficiary or third party (including affiliated entities).

However, coordinators which are public bodies may delegate the tasks set out in Point (b)(ii) last

indent and (iii) above to entities with ‘authorisation to administer’ which they have created or which are controlled by or affiliated to them. In this case, the coordinator retains sole responsibility for the payments and for compliance with the obligations under the Agreement.

Moreover, coordinators which are ‘sole beneficiaries’¹⁰ (or similar, such as European research infrastructure consortia (ERICs)) may delegate the tasks set out in Point (b)(i) to (iii) above to one of their members. The coordinator retains sole responsibility for compliance with the obligations under the Agreement.

The beneficiaries must have **internal arrangements** regarding their operation and co-ordination, to ensure that the action is implemented properly.

If required by the granting authority (see Data Sheet, Point 1), these arrangements must be set out in a written **consortium agreement** between the beneficiaries, covering for instance:

- the internal organisation of the consortium
- the management of access to the Portal
- different distribution keys for the payments and financial responsibilities in case of recoveries (if any)
- additional rules on rights and obligations related to background and results (see Article 16)
- settlement of internal disputes
- liability, indemnification and confidentiality arrangements between the beneficiaries.

The internal arrangements must not contain any provision contrary to this Agreement.

ARTICLE 8 — AFFILIATED ENTITIES

Not applicable

ARTICLE 9 — OTHER PARTICIPANTS INVOLVED IN THE ACTION

9.1 Associated partners

Not applicable

9.2 Third parties giving in-kind contributions to the action

Other third parties may give in-kind contributions to the action (i.e. personnel, equipment, other goods, works and services, etc. which are free-of-charge) if necessary for the implementation.

Third parties giving in-kind contributions do not implement any action tasks. They may not charge contributions to the action (no lump sum contributions) and their costs are considered entirely covered by the lump sum contributions paid to the beneficiaries.

¹⁰ For the definition, see Article 187(2) EU Financial Regulation 2018/1046: “Where several entities satisfy the criteria for being awarded a grant and together form one entity, that entity may be treated as the **sole beneficiary**, including where it is specifically established for the purpose of implementing the action financed by the grant.”

The third parties and their in-kind contributions should be set out in Annex 1.

9.3 Subcontractors

Subcontractors may participate in the action, if necessary for the implementation.

Subcontractors must implement their action tasks in accordance with Article 11. The beneficiaries' costs for subcontracting are considered entirely covered by the lump sum contributions for implementing the work packages (irrespective of the actual subcontracting costs incurred, if any).

The beneficiaries must ensure that their contractual obligations under Articles 11 (proper implementation), 12 (conflict of interest), 13 (confidentiality and security), 14 (ethics), 17.2 (visibility), 18 (specific rules for carrying out action), 19 (information) and 20 (record-keeping) also apply to the subcontractors.

The beneficiaries must ensure that the bodies mentioned in Article 25 (e.g. granting authority, OLAF, Court of Auditors (ECA), etc.) can exercise their rights also towards the subcontractors.

9.4 Recipients of financial support to third parties

If the action includes providing financial support to third parties (e.g. grants, prizes or similar forms of support), the beneficiaries must ensure that their contractual obligations under Articles 12 (conflict of interest), 13 (confidentiality and security), 14 (ethics), 17.2 (visibility), 18 (specific rules for carrying out action), 19 (information) and 20 (record-keeping) also apply to the third parties receiving the support (recipients).

The beneficiaries must also ensure that the bodies mentioned in Article 25 (e.g. granting authority, OLAF, Court of Auditors (ECA), etc.) can exercise their rights also towards the recipients.

ARTICLE 10 — PARTICIPANTS WITH SPECIAL STATUS

10.1 Non-EU participants

Participants which are established in a non-EU country (if any) undertake to comply with their obligations under the Agreement and:

- to respect general principles (including fundamental rights, values and ethical principles, environmental and labour standards, rules on classified information, intellectual property rights, visibility of funding and protection of personal data)
- for the submission of certificates under Article 24: use qualified external auditors which are independent and comply with comparable standards as those set out in EU Directive 2006/43/EC¹¹
- for the controls under Article 25: allow for checks, reviews, audits and investigations (including on-the-spot checks, visits and inspections) by the bodies mentioned in that Article (e.g. granting authority, OLAF, Court of Auditors (ECA), etc.).

¹¹ Directive 2006/43/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council of 17 May 2006 on statutory audits of annual accounts and consolidated accounts or similar national regulations (OJ L 157, 9.6.2006, p. 87).

Special rules on dispute settlement apply (see Data Sheet, Point 5).

10.2 Participants which are international organisations

Participants which are international organisations (IOs; if any) undertake to comply with their obligations under the Agreement and:

- to respect general principles (including fundamental rights, values and ethical principles, environmental and labour standards, rules on classified information, intellectual property rights, visibility of funding and protection of personal data)
- for the submission of certificates under Article 24: to use either independent public officers or external auditors which comply with comparable standards as those set out in EU Directive 2006/43/EC
- for the controls under Article 25: to allow for the checks, reviews, audits and investigations by the bodies mentioned in that Article, taking into account the specific agreements concluded by them and the EU (if any).

For such participants, nothing in the Agreement will be interpreted as a waiver of their privileges or immunities, as accorded by their constituent documents or international law.

Special rules on applicable law and dispute settlement apply (see Article 43 and Data Sheet, Point 5).

10.3 Pillar-assessed participants

Pillar-assessed participants (if any) may rely on their own systems, rules and procedures, in so far as they have been positively assessed and do not call into question the decision awarding the grant or breach the principle of equal treatment of applicants or beneficiaries.

‘Pillar-assessment’ means a review by the European Commission on the systems, rules and procedures which participants use for managing EU grants (in particular internal control system, accounting system, external audits, financing of third parties, rules on recovery and exclusion, information on recipients and protection of personal data; see Article 154 EU Financial Regulation 2018/1046).

Participants with a positive pillar assessment may rely on their own systems, rules and procedures, in particular for:

- record-keeping (Article 20): may be done in accordance with internal standards, rules and procedures
- currency conversion for financial statements (Article 21): may be done in accordance with usual accounting practices
- guarantees (Article 23): for public law bodies, prefinancing guarantees are not needed
- certificates (Article 24):
 - certificates on the financial statements (CFS): may be provided by their regular internal or external auditors and in accordance with their internal financial regulations and procedures

- certificates on usual accounting practices (CoMUC): are not needed if those practices are covered by an ex-ante assessment

and use the following specific rules, for:

- recoveries (Article 22): in case of financial support to third parties, there will be no recovery if the participant has done everything possible to retrieve the undue amounts from the third party receiving the support (including legal proceedings) and non-recovery is not due to an error or negligence on its part
- checks, reviews, audits and investigations by the EU (Article 25): will be conducted taking into account the rules and procedures specifically agreed between them and the framework agreement (if any)
- impact evaluation (Article 26): will be conducted in accordance with the participant's internal rules and procedures and the framework agreement (if any)
- grant agreement suspension (Article 31): certain costs incurred during grant suspension are eligible (notably, minimum costs necessary for a possible resumption of the action and costs relating to contracts which were entered into before the pre-information letter was received and which could not reasonably be suspended, reallocated or terminated on legal grounds)
- grant agreement termination (Article 32): the final grant amount and final payment will be calculated taking into account also costs relating to contracts due for execution only after termination takes effect, if the contract was entered into before the pre-information letter was received and could not reasonably be terminated on legal grounds
- liability for damages (Article 33.2): the granting authority must be compensated for damage it sustains as a result of the implementation of the action or because the action was not implemented in full compliance with the Agreement only if the damage is due to an infringement of the participant's internal rules and procedures or due to a violation of third parties' rights by the participant or one of its employees or individual for whom the employees are responsible.

Participants whose pillar assessment covers procurement and granting procedures may also do purchases, subcontracting and financial support to third parties (Article 6.2) in accordance with their internal rules and procedures for purchases, subcontracting and financial support.

Participants whose pillar assessment covers data protection rules may rely on their internal standards, rules and procedures for data protection (Article 15).

The participants may however not rely on provisions which would breach the principle of equal treatment of applicants or beneficiaries or call into question the decision awarding the grant, such as in particular:

- eligibility (Article 6)
- consortium roles and set-up (Articles 7-9)
- security and ethics (Articles 13, 14)

- IPR (including background and results, access rights and rights of use), communication, dissemination and visibility (Articles 16 and 17)
- information obligation (Article 19)
- payment, reporting and amendments (Articles 21, 22 and 39)
- rejections, reductions, suspensions and terminations (Articles 27, 28, 29-32)

If the pillar assessment was subject to remedial measures, reliance on the internal systems, rules and procedures is subject to compliance with those remedial measures.

Participants whose assessment has not yet been updated to cover (the new rules on) data protection may rely on their internal systems, rules and procedures, provided that they ensure that personal data is:

- processed lawfully, fairly and in a transparent manner in relation to the data subject
- collected for specified, explicit and legitimate purposes and not further processed in a manner that is incompatible with those purposes
- adequate, relevant and limited to what is necessary in relation to the purposes for which they are processed
- accurate and, where necessary, kept up to date
- kept in a form which permits identification of data subjects for no longer than is necessary for the purposes for which the data is processed and
- processed in a manner that ensures appropriate security of the personal data.

Participants must inform the coordinator without delay of any changes to the systems, rules and procedures that were part of the pillar assessment. The coordinator must immediately inform the granting authority.

Pillar-assessed participants that have also concluded a framework agreement with the EU, may moreover — under the same conditions as those above (i.e. not call into question the decision awarding the grant or breach the principle of equal treatment of applicants or beneficiaries) — rely on provisions set out in that framework agreement.

SECTION 2 RULES FOR CARRYING OUT THE ACTION

ARTICLE 11 — PROPER IMPLEMENTATION OF THE ACTION

11.1 Obligation to properly implement the action

The beneficiaries must implement the action as described in Annex 1 and in compliance with the provisions of the Agreement, the call conditions and all legal obligations under applicable EU, international and national law.

11.2 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary breaches any of its obligations under this Article, the grant may be reduced (see Article 28).

Such breaches may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

ARTICLE 12 — CONFLICT OF INTERESTS

12.1 Conflict of interests

The beneficiaries must take all measures to prevent any situation where the impartial and objective implementation of the Agreement could be compromised for reasons involving family, emotional life, political or national affinity, economic interest or any other direct or indirect interest ('conflict of interests').

They must formally notify the granting authority without delay of any situation constituting or likely to lead to a conflict of interests and immediately take all the necessary steps to rectify this situation.

The granting authority may verify that the measures taken are appropriate and may require additional measures to be taken by a specified deadline.

12.2 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary breaches any of its obligations under this Article, the grant may be reduced (see Article 28) and the grant or the beneficiary may be terminated (see Article 32).

Such breaches may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

ARTICLE 13 — CONFIDENTIALITY AND SECURITY

13.1 Sensitive information

The parties must keep confidential any data, documents or other material (in any form) that is identified as sensitive in writing ('sensitive information') — during the implementation of the action and for at least until the time-limit set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 6).

If a beneficiary requests, the granting authority may agree to keep such information confidential for a longer period.

Unless otherwise agreed between the parties, they may use sensitive information only to implement the Agreement.

The beneficiaries may disclose sensitive information to their personnel or other participants involved in the action only if they:

- (a) need to know it in order to implement the Agreement and
- (b) are bound by an obligation of confidentiality.

The granting authority may disclose sensitive information to its staff and to other EU institutions and bodies.

It may moreover disclose sensitive information to third parties, if:

- (a) this is necessary to implement the Agreement or safeguard the EU financial interests and
- (b) the recipients of the information are bound by an obligation of confidentiality.

The confidentiality obligations no longer apply if:

- (a) the disclosing party agrees to release the other party
- (b) the information becomes publicly available, without breaching any confidentiality obligation
- (c) the disclosure of the sensitive information is required by EU, international or national law.

Specific confidentiality rules (if any) are set out in Annex 5.

13.2 Classified information

The parties must handle classified information in accordance with the applicable EU, international or national law on classified information (in particular, Decision 2015/444¹² and its implementing rules).

Deliverables which contain classified information must be submitted according to special procedures agreed with the granting authority.

Action tasks involving classified information may be subcontracted only after explicit approval (in writing) from the granting authority.

Classified information may not be disclosed to any third party (including participants involved in the action implementation) without prior explicit written approval from the granting authority.

Specific security rules (if any) are set out in Annex 5.

13.3 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary breaches any of its obligations under this Article, the grant may be reduced (see Article 28).

Such breaches may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

ARTICLE 14 — ETHICS AND VALUES

14.1 Ethics

The action must be carried out in line with the highest ethical standards and the applicable EU, international and national law on ethical principles.

Specific ethics rules (if any) are set out in Annex 5.

14.2 Values

The beneficiaries must commit to and ensure the respect of basic EU values (such as respect for

¹² Commission Decision 2015/444/EC, Euratom of 13 March 2015 on the security rules for protecting EU classified information (OJ L 72, 17.3.2015, p. 53).

human dignity, freedom, democracy, equality, the rule of law and human rights, including the rights of minorities).

Specific rules on values (if any) are set out in Annex 5.

14.3 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary breaches any of its obligations under this Article, the grant may be reduced (see Article 28).

Such breaches may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

ARTICLE 15 — DATA PROTECTION

15.1 Data processing by the granting authority

Any personal data under the Agreement will be processed under the responsibility of the data controller of the granting authority in accordance with and for the purposes set out in the Portal Privacy Statement.

For grants where the granting authority is the European Commission, an EU regulatory or executive agency, joint undertaking or other EU body, the processing will be subject to Regulation 2018/1725¹³.

15.2 Data processing by the beneficiaries

The beneficiaries must process personal data under the Agreement in compliance with the applicable EU, international and national law on data protection (in particular, Regulation 2016/679¹⁴).

They must ensure that personal data is:

- processed lawfully, fairly and in a transparent manner in relation to the data subjects
- collected for specified, explicit and legitimate purposes and not further processed in a manner that is incompatible with those purposes
- adequate, relevant and limited to what is necessary in relation to the purposes for which they are processed
- accurate and, where necessary, kept up to date
- kept in a form which permits identification of data subjects for no longer than is necessary for the purposes for which the data is processed and
- processed in a manner that ensures appropriate security of the data.

¹³ Regulation (EU) 2018/1725 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 23 October 2018 on the protection of natural persons with regard to the processing of personal data by the Union institutions, bodies, offices and agencies and on the free movement of such data, and repealing Regulation (EC) No 45/2001 and Decision No 1247/2002/EC (OJ L 295, 21.11.2018, p. 39).

¹⁴ Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 27 April 2016 on the protection of natural persons with regard to the processing of personal data and on the free movement of such data, and repealing Directive 95/46/EC ('GDPR') (OJ L 119, 4.5.2016, p. 1).

The beneficiaries may grant their personnel access to personal data only if it is strictly necessary for implementing, managing and monitoring the Agreement. The beneficiaries must ensure that the personnel is under a confidentiality obligation.

The beneficiaries must inform the persons whose data are transferred to the granting authority and provide them with the Portal Privacy Statement.

15.3 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary breaches any of its obligations under this Article, the grant may be reduced (see Article 28).

Such breaches may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

ARTICLE 16 — INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY RIGHTS (IPR) — BACKGROUND AND RESULTS — ACCESS RIGHTS AND RIGHTS OF USE

16.1 Background and access rights to background

The beneficiaries must give each other and the other participants access to the background identified as needed for implementing the action, subject to any specific rules in Annex 5.

‘Background’ means any data, know-how or information — whatever its form or nature (tangible or intangible), including any rights such as intellectual property rights — that is:

- (a) held by the beneficiaries before they acceded to the Agreement and
- (b) needed to implement the action or exploit the results.

If background is subject to rights of a third party, the beneficiary concerned must ensure that it is able to comply with its obligations under the Agreement.

16.2 Ownership of results

The granting authority does not obtain ownership of the results produced under the action.

‘Results’ means any tangible or intangible effect of the action, such as data, know-how or information, whatever its form or nature, whether or not it can be protected, as well as any rights attached to it, including intellectual property rights.

16.3 Rights of use of the granting authority on materials, documents and information received for policy, information, communication, dissemination and publicity purposes

The granting authority has the right to use non-sensitive information relating to the action and materials and documents received from the beneficiaries (notably summaries for publication, deliverables, as well as any other material, such as pictures or audio-visual material, in paper or electronic form) for policy information, communication, dissemination and publicity purposes — during the action or afterwards.

The right to use the beneficiaries’ materials, documents and information is granted in the form of a royalty-free, non-exclusive and irrevocable licence, which includes the following rights:



- (a) **use for its own purposes** (in particular, making them available to persons working for the granting authority or any other EU service (including institutions, bodies, offices, agencies, etc.) or EU Member State institution or body; copying or reproducing them in whole or in part, in unlimited numbers; and communication through press information services)
- (b) **distribution to the public** (in particular, publication as hard copies and in electronic or digital format, publication on the internet, as a downloadable or non-downloadable file, broadcasting by any channel, public display or presentation, communicating through press information services, or inclusion in widely accessible databases or indexes)
- (c) **editing or redrafting** (including shortening, summarising, inserting other elements (e.g. meta-data, legends, other graphic, visual, audio or text elements), extracting parts (e.g. audio or video files), dividing into parts, use in a compilation)
- (d) **translation**
- (e) **storage** in paper, electronic or other form
- (f) **archiving**, in line with applicable document-management rules
- (g) the right to authorise **third parties** to act on its behalf or sub-license to third parties the modes of use set out in Points (b), (c), (d) and (f), if needed for the information, communication and publicity activity of the granting authority and
- (h) **processing**, analysing, aggregating the materials, documents and information received and **producing derivative works**.

The rights of use are granted for the whole duration of the industrial or intellectual property rights concerned.

If materials or documents are subject to moral rights or third party rights (including intellectual property rights or rights of natural persons on their image and voice), the beneficiaries must ensure that they comply with their obligations under this Agreement (in particular, by obtaining the necessary licences and authorisations from the rights holders concerned).

Where applicable, the granting authority will insert the following information:

“© – [year] – [name of the copyright owner]. All rights reserved. Licensed to the [name of granting authority] under conditions.”

16.4 Specific rules on IPR, results and background

Specific rules regarding intellectual property rights, results and background (if any) are set out in Annex 5.

16.5 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary breaches any of its obligations under this Article, the grant may be reduced (see Article 28).

Such a breach may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

ARTICLE 17 — COMMUNICATION, DISSEMINATION AND VISIBILITY

17.1 Communication — Dissemination — Promoting the action

Unless otherwise agreed with the granting authority, the beneficiaries must promote the action and its results by providing targeted information to multiple audiences (including the media and the public), in accordance with Annex 1 and in a strategic, coherent and effective manner.

Before engaging in a communication or dissemination activity expected to have a major media impact, the beneficiaries must inform the granting authority.

17.2 Visibility — European flag and funding statement

Unless otherwise agreed with the granting authority, communication activities of the beneficiaries related to the action (including media relations, conferences, seminars, information material, such as brochures, leaflets, posters, presentations, etc., in electronic form, via traditional or social media, etc.), dissemination activities and any infrastructure, equipment, vehicles, supplies or major result funded by the grant must acknowledge the EU support and display the European flag (emblem) and funding statement (translated into local languages, where appropriate):



Funded by the
European Union



Co-funded by the
European Union



Funded by the
European Union



Co-funded by the
European Union

The emblem must remain distinct and separate and cannot be modified by adding other visual marks, brands or text.

Apart from the emblem, no other visual identity or logo may be used to highlight the EU support.

When displayed in association with other logos (e.g. of beneficiaries or sponsors), the emblem must be displayed at least as prominently and visibly as the other logos.

For the purposes of their obligations under this Article, the beneficiaries may use the emblem without first obtaining approval from the granting authority. This does not, however, give them the right to

exclusive use. Moreover, they may not appropriate the emblem or any similar trademark or logo, either by registration or by any other means.

17.3 Quality of information — Disclaimer

Any communication or dissemination activity related to the action must use factually accurate information.

Moreover, it must indicate the following disclaimer (translated into local languages where appropriate):

“Funded by the European Union. Views and opinions expressed are however those of the author(s) only and do not necessarily reflect those of the European Union or [name of the granting authority]. Neither the European Union nor the granting authority can be held responsible for them.”

17.4 Specific communication, dissemination and visibility rules

Specific communication, dissemination and visibility rules (if any) are set out in Annex 5.

17.5 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary breaches any of its obligations under this Article, the grant may be reduced (see Article 28).

Such breaches may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

ARTICLE 18 — SPECIFIC RULES FOR CARRYING OUT THE ACTION

18.1 Specific rules for carrying out the action

Specific rules for implementing the action (if any) are set out in Annex 5.

18.2 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary breaches any of its obligations under this Article, the grant may be reduced (see Article 28).

Such a breach may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

SECTION 3 GRANT ADMINISTRATION

ARTICLE 19 — GENERAL INFORMATION OBLIGATIONS

19.1 Information requests

The beneficiaries must provide — during the action or afterwards and in accordance with Article 7 — any information requested in order to verify eligibility of the lump sum contributions declared, proper implementation of the action and compliance with the other obligations under the Agreement.

The information provided must be accurate, precise and complete and in the format requested, including electronic format.

19.2 Participant Register data updates

The beneficiaries must keep — at all times, during the action or afterwards — their information stored in the Portal Participant Register up to date, in particular, their name, address, legal representatives, legal form and organisation type.

19.3 Information about events and circumstances which impact the action

The beneficiaries must immediately inform the granting authority (and the other beneficiaries) of any of the following:

- (a) **events** which are likely to affect or delay the implementation of the action or affect the EU's financial interests, in particular:
 - (i) changes in their legal, financial, technical, organisational or ownership situation (including changes linked to one of the exclusion grounds listed in the declaration of honour signed before grant signature)
 - (ii) linked action information: not applicable
- (b) **circumstances** affecting:
 - (i) the decision to award the grant or
 - (ii) compliance with requirements under the Agreement.

19.4 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary breaches any of its obligations under this Article, the grant may be reduced (see Article 28).

Such breaches may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

ARTICLE 20 — RECORD-KEEPING

20.1 Keeping records and supporting documents

The beneficiaries must — at least until the time-limit set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 6) — keep records and other supporting documents to prove the proper implementation of the action (proper implementation of the work and/or achievement of the results as described in Annex 1) in line with the accepted standards in the respective field (if any); beneficiaries do not need to keep specific records on the actual costs incurred.

The records and supporting documents must be made available upon request (see Article 19) or in the context of checks, reviews, audits or investigations (see Article 25).

If there are on-going checks, reviews, audits, investigations, litigation or other pursuits of claims under the Agreement (including the extension of findings; see Article 25), the beneficiaries must keep these records and other supporting documentation until the end of these procedures.

The beneficiaries must keep the original documents. Digital and digitalised documents are considered

originals if they are authorised by the applicable national law. The granting authority may accept non-original documents if they offer a comparable level of assurance.

20.2 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary breaches any of its obligations under this Article, lump sum contributions insufficiently substantiated will be ineligible (see Article 6) and will be rejected (see Article 27), and the grant may be reduced (see Article 28).

Such breaches may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

ARTICLE 21 — REPORTING

21.1 Continuous reporting

The beneficiaries must continuously report on the progress of the action (e.g. **deliverables, milestones, outputs/outcomes, critical risks, indicators**, etc; if any), in the Portal Continuous Reporting tool and in accordance with the timing and conditions it sets out (as agreed with the granting authority).

Standardised deliverables (e.g. progress reports not linked to payments, reports on cumulative expenditure, special reports, etc; if any) must be submitted using the templates published on the Portal.

21.2 Periodic reporting: Technical reports and financial statements

In addition, the beneficiaries must provide reports to request payments, in accordance with the schedule and modalities set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 4.2):

- for additional prefinancements (if any): **an additional prefinancing report**
- for interim payments (if any) and the final payment: a **periodic report**

The prefinancing and periodic reports include a technical and financial part.

The technical part includes an overview of the action implementation. It must be prepared using the template available in the Portal Periodic Reporting tool.

The financial part of the additional prefinancing report includes a statement on the use of the previous prefinancing payment.

The financial part of the periodic report includes:

- the financial statement (consolidated statement for the consortium)
- the explanation on the use of resources (or detailed cost reporting table): not applicable
- the certificates on the financial statements (CFS): not applicable.

The **financial statement** must contain the lump sum contributions indicated in Annex 2, for the work packages that were completed during the reporting period.

For the last reporting period, the beneficiaries may exceptionally also declare partial lump sum

contributions for work packages that were not completed (e.g. due to force majeure or technical impossibility).

Lump sum contributions which are not declared in a financial statement will not be taken into account by the granting authority.

By signing the financial statement (directly in the Portal Periodic Reporting tool), the coordinator confirms (on behalf of the consortium) that:

- the information provided is complete, reliable and true
- the lump sum contributions declared are eligible (in particular, the work packages have been completed, that the work has been properly implemented and/or the results were achieved in accordance with Annex 1; see Article 6)
- the proper implementation and/or achievement can be substantiated by adequate records and supporting documents (see Article 20) that will be produced upon request (see Article 19) or in the context of checks, reviews, audits and investigations (see Article 25).

In case of recoveries (see Article 22), beneficiaries will be held responsible also for the lump sum contributions declared for their affiliated entities (if any).

21.3 Currency for financial statements and conversion into euros

The financial statements must be drafted in euro.

21.4 Reporting language

The reporting must be in the language of the Agreement, unless otherwise agreed with the granting authority (see Data Sheet, Point 4.2).

21.5 Consequences of non-compliance

If a report submitted does not comply with this Article, the granting authority may suspend the payment deadline (see Article 29) and apply other measures described in Chapter 5.

If the coordinator breaches its reporting obligations, the granting authority may terminate the grant or the coordinator's participation (see Article 32) or apply other measures described in Chapter 5.

ARTICLE 22 — PAYMENTS AND RECOVERIES — CALCULATION OF AMOUNTS DUE

22.1 Payments and payment arrangements

Payments will be made in accordance with the schedule and modalities set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 4.2).

They will be made in euro to the bank account indicated by the coordinator (see Data Sheet, Point 4.2) and must be distributed without unjustified delay (restrictions may apply to distribution of the initial prefinancing payment; see Data Sheet, Point 4.2).

Payments to this bank account will discharge the granting authority from its payment obligation.

The cost of payment transfers will be borne as follows:

- the granting authority bears the cost of transfers charged by its bank
- the beneficiary bears the cost of transfers charged by its bank
- the party causing a repetition of a transfer bears all costs of the repeated transfer.

Payments by the granting authority will be considered to have been carried out on the date when they are debited to its account.

22.2 Recoveries

Recoveries will be made, if — at beneficiary termination, final payment or afterwards — it turns out that the granting authority has paid too much and needs to recover the amounts undue.

Each beneficiary's financial responsibility in case of recovery is in principle limited to their own debt and undue amounts of their affiliated entities.

In case of enforced recoveries (see Article 22.4), affiliated entities will be held liable for repaying debts of their beneficiaries, if required by the granting authority (see Data Sheet, Point 4.4).

22.3 Amounts due

22.3.1 Prefinancing payments

The aim of the prefinancing is to provide the beneficiaries with a float.

It remains the property of the EU until the final payment.

For **initial prefinancings** (if any), the amount due, schedule and modalities are set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 4.2).

For **additional prefinancings** (if any), the amount due, schedule and modalities are also set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 4.2). However, if the statement on the use of the previous prefinancing payment shows that less than 70% was used, the amount set out in the Data Sheet will be reduced by the difference between the 70% threshold and the amount used.

The contribution to the Mutual Insurance Mechanism will be retained from the prefinancing payments (at the rate and in accordance with the modalities set out in the Data Sheet, see Point 4.2) and transferred to the Mechanism.

Prefinancing payments (or parts of them) may be offset (without the beneficiaries' consent) against amounts owed by a beneficiary to the granting authority — up to the amount due to that beneficiary.

For grants where the granting authority is the European Commission or an EU executive agency, offsetting may also be done against amounts owed to other Commission services or executive agencies.

Payments will not be made if the payment deadline or payments are suspended (see Articles 29 and 30).

22.3.2 Amount due at beneficiary termination — Recovery

In case of beneficiary termination, the granting authority will determine the provisional amount due for the beneficiary concerned.

This will be done on the basis of work packages already completed in previous interim payments. Payments for ongoing/not yet completed work packages which the beneficiary was working on before termination (if any) will therefore be made only later on, with the next interim or final payments when those work packages have been completed.

The **amount due** will be calculated in the following step:

Step 1 — Calculation of the total accepted EU contribution

Step 1 — Calculation of the total accepted EU contribution

The granting authority will first calculate the ‘accepted EU contribution’ for the beneficiary, on the basis of the beneficiary’s lump sum contributions for the work packages which were approved in previous interim payments.

After that, the granting authority will take into account grant reductions (if any). The resulting amount is the ‘total accepted EU contribution’ for the beneficiary.

The **balance** is then calculated by deducting the payments received (if any; see report on the distribution of payments in Article 32), from the total accepted EU contribution:

$$\begin{aligned} & \{ \text{total accepted EU contribution for the beneficiary} \\ & \text{minus} \\ & \{ \text{prefinancing and interim payments received (if any)} \} \}. \end{aligned}$$

If the balance is **negative**, it will be **recovered** in accordance with the following procedure:

The granting authority will send a **pre-information letter** to the beneficiary concerned:

- formally notifying the intention to recover, the amount due, the amount to be recovered and the reasons why and
- requesting observations within 30 days of receiving notification.

If no observations are submitted (or the granting authority decides to pursue recovery despite the observations it has received), it will confirm the amount to be recovered and ask this amount to be paid to the coordinator (**confirmation letter**).

If payment is not made to the coordinator by the date specified in the confirmation letter, the granting authority may call on the Mutual Insurance Mechanism to intervene, if continuation of the action is guaranteed and the conditions set out in the rules governing the Mechanism are met.

In this case, it will send a **beneficiary recovery letter**, together with a **debit note** with the terms and date for payment.

The debit note for the beneficiary will include the amount calculated for the affiliated entities which also had to end their participation (if any).

If payment is not made by the date specified in the debit note, the granting authority will **enforce recovery** in accordance with Article 22.4.

22.3.3 Interim payments

Interim payments reimburse the eligible lump sum contributions claimed for work packages implemented during the reporting periods (if any).

Interim payments (if any) will be made in accordance with the schedule and modalities set out the Data Sheet (see Point 4.2).

Payment is subject to the approval of the periodic report and the work packages declared. Their approval does not imply recognition of compliance, authenticity, completeness or correctness of their content.

Incomplete work packages and work packages that have not been delivered or cannot be approved will be rejected (see Article 27).

The **interim payment** will be calculated by the granting authority in the following steps:

Step 1 — Calculation of the total accepted EU contribution

Step 2 — Limit to the interim payment ceiling

Step 1 — Calculation of the total accepted EU contribution

The granting authority will first calculate the ‘accepted EU contribution’ for the action for the reporting period, by calculating the lump sum contributions for the approved work packages.

After that, the granting authority will take into account grant reductions from beneficiary termination (if any). The resulting amount is the ‘total accepted EU contribution’.

Step 2 — Limit to the interim payment ceiling

The resulting amount is then capped to ensure that the total amount of prefinancing and interim payments (if any) does not exceed the interim payment ceiling set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 4.2).

Interim payments (or parts of them) may be offset (without the beneficiaries’ consent) against amounts owed by a beneficiary to the granting authority — up to the amount due to that beneficiary.

For grants where the granting authority is the European Commission or an EU executive agency, offsetting may also be done against amounts owed to other Commission services or executive agencies.

Payments will not be made if the payment deadline or payments are suspended (see Articles 29 and 30).

22.3.4 Final payment — Final grant amount — Revenues and Profit — Recovery

The final payment (payment of the balance) reimburses the remaining eligible lump sum contributions claimed for the implemented work packages (if any).

The final payment will be made in accordance with the schedule and modalities set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 4.2).

Payment is subject to the approval of the final periodic report and the work packages declared. Their approval does not imply recognition of compliance, authenticity, completeness or correctness of their content.

Work packages (or parts of them) that have not been delivered or cannot be approved will be rejected (see Article 27).

The **final grant amount for the action** will be calculated in the following steps:

Step 1 — Calculation of the total accepted EU contribution

Step 2 — Limit to the maximum grant amount

Step 3 — Reduction due to the no-profit rule

Step 1 — Calculation of the total accepted EU contribution

The granting authority will first calculate the ‘accepted EU contribution’ for the action for all reporting periods, by calculating the lump sum contributions for the approved work packages.

After that, the granting authority will take into account grant reductions (if any). The resulting amount is the ‘total accepted EU contribution’.

Step 2 — Limit to the maximum grant amount

Not applicable

Step 3 — Reduction due to the no-profit rule

Not applicable

The **balance** (final payment) is then calculated by deducting the total amount of prefinancing and interim payments already made (if any), from the final grant amount:

$$\begin{aligned} &\{\text{final grant amount} \\ &\text{minus} \\ &\{\text{prefinancing and interim payments made (if any)}\}\}. \end{aligned}$$

If the balance is **positive**, it will be **paid** to the coordinator.

The amount retained for the Mutual Insurance Mechanism (see above) will be released and **paid** to the coordinator (in accordance with the rules governing the Mechanism).

The final payment (or part of it) may be offset (without the beneficiaries’ consent) against amounts owed by a beneficiary to the granting authority — up to the amount due to that beneficiary.

For grants where the granting authority is the European Commission or an EU executive agency, offsetting may also be done against amounts owed to other Commission services or executive agencies.

Payments will not be made if the payment deadline or payments are suspended (see Articles 29 and 30).

If — despite the release of the Mutual Insurance Mechanism contribution — the balance is **negative**, it will be **recovered** in accordance with the following procedure:

The granting authority will send a **pre-information letter** to the coordinator:

- formally notifying the intention to recover, the final grant amount, the amount to be recovered and the reasons why
- requesting a report on the distribution of payments to the beneficiaries within 30 days of receiving notification and
- requesting observations within 30 days of receiving notification.

If no observations are submitted (or the granting authority decides to pursue recovery despite the observations it has received) and the coordinator has submitted the report on the distribution of payments, it will calculate the **share of the debt per beneficiary**, by:

- (a) identifying the beneficiaries for which the amount calculated as follows is negative:

$$\left\{ \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{total accepted EU contribution for the beneficiary} \\ \text{divided by} \\ \text{total accepted EU contribution for the action} \end{array} \right\} \times \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{final grant amount for the action} \end{array} \right\} - \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{prefinancing and interim payments received by the beneficiary (if any)} \end{array} \right\} \right\}$$

and

- (b) dividing the debt:

$$\left\{ \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{amount calculated according to point (a) for the beneficiary concerned} \\ \text{divided by} \\ \text{the sum of the amounts calculated according to point (a) for all the beneficiaries identified according to point (a)} \end{array} \right\} \times \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{the amount to be recovered} \end{array} \right\} \right\}$$

and confirm the amount to be recovered from each beneficiary concerned (**confirmation letter**), together with **debit notes** with the terms and date for payment.

The debit notes for beneficiaries will include the amounts calculated for their affiliated entities (if any).

If the coordinator has not submitted the report on the distribution of payments, the granting authority

will **recover** the full amount from the coordinator (**confirmation letter** and **debit note** with the terms and date for payment).

If payment is not made by the date specified in the debit note, the granting authority will **enforce recovery** in accordance with Article 22.4.

22.3.5 Audit implementation after final payment — Revised final grant amount — Recovery

If — after the final payment (in particular, after checks, reviews, audits or investigations; see Article 25) — the granting authority rejects lump sum contributions (see Article 27) or reduces the grant (see Article 28), it will calculate the **revised final grant amount** for the beneficiary concerned.

The **beneficiary revised final grant amount** will be calculated in the following step:

Step 1 — Calculation of the revised total accepted EU contribution

Step 1 — Calculation of the revised total accepted EU contribution

The granting authority will first calculate the ‘revised accepted EU contribution’ for the beneficiary, by calculating the ‘revised accepted contributions’.

After that, it will take into account grant reductions (if any). The resulting ‘revised total accepted EU contribution’ is the beneficiary revised final grant amount.

If the revised final grant amount is lower than the beneficiary’s final grant amount (i.e. its share in the final grant amount for the action), it will be **recovered** in accordance with the following procedure:

The **beneficiary final grant amount** (i.e. share in the final grant amount for the action) is calculated as follows:

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{total accepted EU contribution for the beneficiary} \\ \text{divided by} \\ \text{total accepted EU contribution for the action} \end{array} \right\} \times \text{final grant amount for the action}$$

The granting authority will send a **pre-information letter** to the beneficiary concerned:

- formally notifying the intention to recover, the amount to be recovered and the reasons why and
- requesting observations within 30 days of receiving notification.

If no observations are submitted (or the granting authority decides to pursue recovery despite the observations it has received), it will confirm the amount to be recovered (**confirmation letter**), together with a **debit note** with the terms and the date for payment.

Recoveries against affiliated entities (if any) will be handled through their beneficiaries.

If payment is not made by the date specified in the debit note, the granting authority will **enforce recovery** in accordance with Article 22.4.

22.4 Enforced recovery

If payment is not made by the date specified in the debit note, the amount due will be recovered:

- (a) by offsetting the amount — without the coordinator or beneficiary's consent — against any amounts owed to the coordinator or beneficiary by the granting authority.

In exceptional circumstances, to safeguard the EU financial interests, the amount may be offset before the payment date specified in the debit note.

For grants where the granting authority is the European Commission or an EU executive agency, debts may also be offset against amounts owed by other Commission services or executive agencies.

- (b) financial guarantee(s): not applicable
- (c) joint and several liability of beneficiaries: not applicable
- (d) by holding affiliated entities jointly and severally liable (if any, see Data Sheet, Point 4.4)
- (e) by taking legal action (see Article 43) or, provided that the granting authority is the European Commission or an EU executive agency, by adopting an enforceable decision under Article 299 of the Treaty on the Functioning of the EU (TFEU) and Article 100(2) of EU Financial Regulation 2018/1046.

If the Mutual Insurance Mechanism was called on by the granting authority to intervene, recovery will be continued in the name of the Mutual Insurance Mechanism. If two debit notes were sent, the second one (in the name of the Mutual Insurance Mechanism) will be considered to replace the first one (in the name of the granting authority). Where the MIM intervened, offsetting, enforceable decisions or any other of the above-mentioned forms of enforced recovery may be used mutatis mutandis.

The amount to be recovered will be increased by **late-payment interest** at the rate set out in Article 23.5, from the day following the payment date in the debit note, up to and including the date the full payment is received.

Partial payments will be first credited against expenses, charges and late-payment interest and then against the principal.

Bank charges incurred in the recovery process will be borne by the beneficiary, unless Directive 2015/2366¹⁵ applies.

For grants where the granting authority is an EU executive agency, enforced recovery by offsetting or enforceable decision will be done by the services of the European Commission (see also Article 43).

22.5 Consequences of non-compliance

22.5.1 If the granting authority does not pay within the payment deadlines (see above), the beneficiaries are entitled to **late-payment interest** at the reference rate applied by the European

¹⁵ Directive (EU) 2015/2366 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 25 November 2015 on payment services in the internal market, amending Directives 2002/65/EC, 2009/110/EC and 2013/36/EU and Regulation (EU) No 1093/2010, and repealing Directive 2007/64/EC (OJ L 337, 23.12.2015, p. 35).

Central Bank (ECB) for its main refinancing operations in euros, plus the percentage specified in the Data Sheet (Point 4.2). The ECB reference rate to be used is the rate in force on the first day of the month in which the payment deadline expires, as published in the C series of the *Official Journal of the European Union*.

If the late-payment interest is lower than or equal to EUR 200, it will be paid to the coordinator only on request submitted within two months of receiving the late payment.

Late-payment interest is not due if all beneficiaries are EU Member States (including regional and local government authorities or other public bodies acting on behalf of a Member State for the purpose of this Agreement).

If payments or the payment deadline are suspended (see Articles 29 and 30), payment will not be considered as late.

Late-payment interest covers the period running from the day following the due date for payment (see above), up to and including the date of payment.

Late-payment interest is not considered for the purposes of calculating the final grant amount.

22.5.2 If the coordinator breaches any of its obligations under this Article, the grant may be reduced (see Article 28) and the grant or the coordinator may be terminated (see Article 32).

Such breaches may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

ARTICLE 23 — GUARANTEES

Not applicable

ARTICLE 24 — CERTIFICATES

Not applicable

ARTICLE 25 — CHECKS, REVIEWS, AUDITS AND INVESTIGATIONS — EXTENSION OF FINDINGS

25.1 Granting authority checks, reviews and audits

25.1.1 Internal checks

The granting authority may — during the action or afterwards — check the proper implementation of the action and compliance with the obligations under the Agreement, including assessing lump sum contributions, deliverables and reports.

25.1.2 Project reviews

The granting authority may carry out reviews on the proper implementation of the action and compliance with the obligations under the Agreement (general project reviews or specific issues reviews).

Such project reviews may be started during the implementation of the action and until the time-limit

set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 6). They will be formally notified to the coordinator or beneficiary concerned and will be considered to start on the date of the notification.

If needed, the granting authority may be assisted by independent, outside experts. If it uses outside experts, the coordinator or beneficiary concerned will be informed and have the right to object on grounds of commercial confidentiality or conflict of interest.

The coordinator or beneficiary concerned must cooperate diligently and provide — within the deadline requested — any information and data in addition to deliverables and reports already submitted. The granting authority may request beneficiaries to provide such information to it directly. Sensitive information and documents will be treated in accordance with Article 13.

The coordinator or beneficiary concerned may be requested to participate in meetings, including with the outside experts.

For **on-the-spot visits**, the beneficiary concerned must allow access to sites and premises (including to the outside experts) and must ensure that information requested is readily available.

Information provided must be accurate, precise and complete and in the format requested, including electronic format.

On the basis of the review findings, a **project review report** will be drawn up.

The granting authority will formally notify the project review report to the coordinator or beneficiary concerned, which has 30 days from receiving notification to make observations.

Project reviews (including project review reports) will be in the language of the Agreement, unless otherwise agreed with the granting authority (see Data Sheet, Point 4.2).

25.1.3 Audits

The granting authority may carry out audits on the proper implementation of the action and compliance with the obligations under the Agreement.

Such audits may be started during the implementation of the action and until the time-limit set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 6). They will be formally notified to the beneficiary concerned and will be considered to start on the date of the notification.

The granting authority may use its own audit service, delegate audits to a centralised service or use external audit firms. If it uses an external firm, the beneficiary concerned will be informed and have the right to object on grounds of commercial confidentiality or conflict of interest.

The beneficiary concerned must cooperate diligently and provide — within the deadline requested — any information (including complete accounts, individual salary statements or other personal data) to verify compliance with the Agreement. Sensitive information and documents will be treated in accordance with Article 13.

For **on-the-spot** visits, the beneficiary concerned must allow access to sites and premises (including for the external audit firm) and must ensure that information requested is readily available.

Information provided must be accurate, precise and complete and in the format requested, including electronic format.

On the basis of the audit findings, a **draft audit report** will be drawn up.

The auditors will formally notify the draft audit report to the beneficiary concerned, which has 30 days from receiving notification to make observations (contradictory audit procedure).

The **final audit report** will take into account observations by the beneficiary concerned and will be formally notified to them.

Audits (including audit reports) will be in the language of the Agreement, unless otherwise agreed with the granting authority (see Data Sheet, Point 4.2).

25.2 European Commission checks, reviews and audits in grants of other granting authorities

Where the granting authority is not the European Commission, the latter has the same rights of checks, reviews and audits as the granting authority.

25.3 Access to records for assessing simplified forms of funding

The beneficiaries must give the European Commission access to their statutory records for the periodic assessment of simplified forms of funding which are used in EU programmes.

25.4 OLAF, EPPO and ECA audits and investigations

The following bodies may also carry out checks, reviews, audits and investigations — during the action or afterwards:

- the European Anti-Fraud Office (OLAF) under Regulations No 883/2013¹⁶ and No 2185/96¹⁷
- the European Public Prosecutor's Office (EPPO) under Regulation 2017/1939
- the European Court of Auditors (ECA) under Article 287 of the Treaty on the Functioning of the EU (TFEU) and Article 257 of EU Financial Regulation 2018/1046.

If requested by these bodies, the beneficiary concerned must provide full, accurate and complete information in the format requested (including complete accounts, individual salary statements or other personal data, including in electronic format) and allow access to sites and premises for on-the-spot visits or inspections — as provided for under these Regulations.

To this end, the beneficiary concerned must keep all relevant information relating to the action, at least until the time-limit set out in the Data Sheet (Point 6) and, in any case, until any ongoing checks, reviews, audits, investigations, litigation or other pursuits of claims have been concluded.

25.5 Consequences of checks, reviews, audits and investigations — Extension of findings

¹⁶ Regulation (EU, Euratom) No 883/2013 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 11 September 2013 concerning investigations conducted by the European Anti-Fraud Office (OLAF) and repealing Regulation (EC) No 1073/1999 of the European Parliament and of the Council and Council Regulation (Euratom) No 1074/1999 (OJ L 248, 18/09/2013, p. 1).

¹⁷ Council Regulation (Euratom, EC) No 2185/96 of 11 November 1996 concerning on-the-spot checks and inspections carried out by the Commission in order to protect the European Communities' financial interests against fraud and other irregularities (OJ L 292, 15/11/1996, p. 2).

25.5.1 Consequences of checks, reviews, audits and investigations in this grant

Findings in checks, reviews, audits or investigations carried out in the context of this grant may lead to rejections (see Article 27), grant reduction (see Article 28) or other measures described in Chapter 5.

Rejections or grant reductions after the final payment will lead to a revised final grant amount (see Article 22).

Findings in checks, reviews, audits or investigations during the action implementation may lead to a request for amendment (see Article 39), to change the description of the action set out in Annex 1.

Checks, reviews, audits or investigations that find systemic or recurrent errors, irregularities, fraud or breach of obligations in any EU grant may also lead to consequences in other EU grants awarded under similar conditions ('extension to other grants').

Moreover, findings arising from an OLAF or EPPO investigation may lead to criminal prosecution under national law.

25.5.2 Extension from other grants

Findings of checks, reviews, audits or investigations in other grants may be extended to this grant, if:

- (a) the beneficiary concerned is found, in other EU grants awarded under similar conditions, to have committed systemic or recurrent errors, irregularities, fraud or breach of obligations that have a material impact on this grant and
- (b) those findings are formally notified to the beneficiary concerned — together with the list of grants affected by the findings — within the time-limit for audits set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 6).

The granting authority will formally notify the beneficiary concerned of the intention to extend the findings and the list of grants affected.

If the extension concerns **rejections of lump sum contributions**: the notification will include:

- (a) an invitation to submit observations on the list of grants affected by the findings
- (b) the request to submit revised financial statements for all grants affected
- (c) the correction rate for extrapolation, established on the basis of the systemic or recurrent errors, to calculate the amounts to be rejected, if the beneficiary concerned:
 - (i) considers that the submission of revised financial statements is not possible or practicable or
 - (ii) does not submit revised financial statements.

If the extension concerns **grant reductions**: the notification will include:

- (a) an invitation to submit observations on the list of grants affected by the findings and
- (b) the **correction rate for extrapolation**, established on the basis of the systemic or recurrent errors and the principle of proportionality.

The beneficiary concerned has **60 days** from receiving notification to submit observations, revised financial statements or to propose a duly substantiated **alternative correction method/rate**.

On the basis of this, the granting authority will analyse the impact and decide on the implementation (i.e. start rejection or grant reduction procedures, either on the basis of the revised financial statements or the announced/alternative method/rate or a mix of those; see Articles 27 and 28).

25.6 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary breaches any of its obligations under this Article, lump sum contributions insufficiently substantiated will be ineligible (see Article 6) and will be rejected (see Article 27), and the grant may be reduced (see Article 28).

Such breaches may also lead to other measures described in Chapter 5.

ARTICLE 26 — IMPACT EVALUATIONS

26.1 Impact evaluation

The granting authority may carry out impact evaluations of the action, measured against the objectives and indicators of the EU programme funding the grant.

Such evaluations may be started during implementation of the action and until the time-limit set out in the Data Sheet (see Point 6). They will be formally notified to the coordinator or beneficiaries and will be considered to start on the date of the notification.

If needed, the granting authority may be assisted by independent outside experts.

The coordinator or beneficiaries must provide any information relevant to evaluate the impact of the action, including information in electronic format.

26.2 Consequences of non-compliance

If a beneficiary breaches any of its obligations under this Article, the granting authority may apply the measures described in Chapter 5.

CHAPTER 5 CONSEQUENCES OF NON-COMPLIANCE

SECTION 1 REJECTIONS AND GRANT REDUCTION

ARTICLE 27 — REJECTION OF CONTRIBUTIONS

27.1 Conditions

The granting authority will — at interim payment, final payment or afterwards — reject any lump sum contributions which are ineligible (see Article 6), in particular following checks, reviews, audits or investigations (see Article 25).

The rejection may also be based on the extension of findings from other grants to this grant (see Article 25).

Ineligible lump sum contributions will be rejected.

27.2 Procedure

If the rejection does not lead to a recovery, the granting authority will formally notify the coordinator or beneficiary concerned of the rejection, the amounts and the reasons why. The coordinator or beneficiary concerned may — within 30 days of receiving notification — submit observations if it disagrees with the rejection (payment review procedure).

If the rejection leads to a recovery, the granting authority will follow the contradictory procedure with pre-information letter set out in Article 22.

27.3 Effects

If the granting authority rejects lump sum contributions, it will deduct them from the lump sum contributions declared and then calculate the amount due (and, if needed, make a recovery; see Article 22).

ARTICLE 28 — GRANT REDUCTION

28.1 Conditions

The granting authority may — at beneficiary termination, final payment or afterwards — reduce the grant for a beneficiary, if:

- (a) the beneficiary (or a person having powers of representation, decision-making or control, or person essential for the award/implementation of the grant) has committed:
 - (i) substantial errors, irregularities or fraud or
 - (ii) serious breach of obligations under this Agreement or during its award (including improper implementation of the action, non-compliance with the call conditions, submission of false information, failure to provide required information, breach of ethics or security rules (if applicable), etc.), or
- (b) the beneficiary (or a person having powers of representation, decision-making or control, or person essential for the award/implementation of the grant) has committed — in other EU grants awarded to it under similar conditions — systemic or recurrent errors, irregularities, fraud or serious breach of obligations that have a material impact on this grant (extension of findings; see Article 25.5).

The amount of the reduction will be calculated for each beneficiary concerned and proportionate to the seriousness and the duration of the errors, irregularities or fraud or breach of obligations, by applying an individual reduction rate to their accepted EU contribution.

28.2 Procedure

If the grant reduction does not lead to a recovery, the granting authority will formally notify the

coordinator or beneficiary concerned of the reduction, the amount to be reduced and the reasons why. The coordinator or beneficiary concerned may — within 30 days of receiving notification — submit observations if it disagrees with the reduction (payment review procedure).

If the grant reduction leads to a recovery, the granting authority will follow the contradictory procedure with pre-information letter set out in Article 22.

28.3 Effects

If the granting authority reduces the grant, it will deduct the reduction and then calculate the amount due (and, if needed, make a recovery; see Article 22).

SECTION 2 — SUSPENSION AND TERMINATION

ARTICLE 29 — PAYMENT DEADLINE SUSPENSION

29.1 Conditions

The granting authority may — at any moment — suspend the payment deadline if a payment cannot be processed because:

- (a) the required report (see Article 21) has not been submitted or is not complete or additional information is needed
- (b) there are doubts about the amount to be paid (e.g. ongoing extension procedure, queries about eligibility, need for a grant reduction, etc.) and additional checks, reviews, audits or investigations are necessary, or
- (c) there are other issues affecting the EU financial interests.

29.2 Procedure

The granting authority will formally notify the coordinator of the suspension and the reasons why.

The suspension will **take effect** the day the notification is sent.

If the conditions for suspending the payment deadline are no longer met, the suspension will be **lifted** — and the remaining time to pay (see Data Sheet, Point 4.2) will resume.

If the suspension exceeds two months, the coordinator may request the granting authority to confirm if the suspension will continue.

If the payment deadline has been suspended due to the non-compliance of the report and the revised report is not submitted (or was submitted but is also rejected), the granting authority may also terminate the grant or the participation of the coordinator (see Article 32).

ARTICLE 30 — PAYMENT SUSPENSION

30.1 Conditions

The granting authority may — at any moment — suspend payments, in whole or in part for one or more beneficiaries, if:

- (a) a beneficiary (or a person having powers of representation, decision-making or control, or person essential for the award/implementation of the grant) has committed or is suspected of having committed:
 - (i) substantial errors, irregularities or fraud or
 - (ii) serious breach of obligations under this Agreement or during its award (including improper implementation of the action, non-compliance with the call conditions, submission of false information, failure to provide required information, breach of ethics or security rules (if applicable), etc.), or
- (b) a beneficiary (or a person having powers of representation, decision-making or control, or person essential for the award/implementation of the grant) has committed — in other EU grants awarded to it under similar conditions — systemic or recurrent errors, irregularities, fraud or serious breach of obligations that have a material impact on this grant (extension of findings; see Article 25.5).

If payments are suspended for one or more beneficiaries, the granting authority will make partial payment(s) for the part(s) not suspended. If suspension concerns the final payment, the payment (or recovery) of the remaining amount after suspension is lifted will be considered to be the payment that closes the action.

30.2 Procedure

Before suspending payments, the granting authority will send a **pre-information letter** to the beneficiary concerned:

- formally notifying the intention to suspend payments and the reasons why and
- requesting observations within 30 days of receiving notification.

If the granting authority does not receive observations or decides to pursue the procedure despite the observations it has received, it will confirm the suspension (**confirmation letter**). Otherwise, it will formally notify that the procedure is discontinued.

At the end of the suspension procedure, the granting authority will also inform the coordinator.

The suspension will **take effect** the day after the confirmation notification is sent.

If the conditions for resuming payments are met, the suspension will be **lifted**. The granting authority will formally notify the beneficiary concerned (and the coordinator) and set the suspension end date.

During the suspension, no prefinancing will be paid to the beneficiaries concerned. For interim payments, the periodic reports for all reporting periods except the last one (see Article 21) must not contain any financial statements from the beneficiary concerned (or its affiliated entities). The coordinator must include them in the next periodic report after the suspension is lifted or — if suspension is not lifted before the end of the action — in the last periodic report.

ARTICLE 31 — GRANT AGREEMENT SUSPENSION

31.1 Consortium-requested GA suspension

31.1.1 Conditions and procedure

The beneficiaries may request the suspension of the grant or any part of it, if exceptional circumstances — in particular *force majeure* (see Article 35) — make implementation impossible or excessively difficult.

The coordinator must submit a request for **amendment** (see Article 39), with:

- the reasons why
- the date the suspension takes effect; this date may be before the date of the submission of the amendment request and
- the expected date of resumption.

The suspension will **take effect** on the day specified in the amendment.

Once circumstances allow for implementation to resume, the coordinator must immediately request another **amendment** of the Agreement to set the suspension end date, the resumption date (one day after suspension end date), extend the duration and make other changes necessary to adapt the action to the new situation (see Article 39) — unless the grant has been terminated (see Article 32). The suspension will be **lifted** with effect from the suspension end date set out in the amendment. This date may be before the date of the submission of the amendment request.

During the suspension, no prefinancing will be paid. Moreover, no work may be done. Ongoing work packages must be interrupted and no new work packages may be started.

31.2 EU-initiated GA suspension

31.2.1 Conditions

The granting authority may suspend the grant or any part of it, if:

- (a) a beneficiary (or a person having powers of representation, decision-making or control, or person essential for the award/implementation of the grant) has committed or is suspected of having committed:
 - (i) substantial errors, irregularities or fraud or
 - (ii) serious breach of obligations under this Agreement or during its award (including improper implementation of the action, non-compliance with the call conditions, submission of false information, failure to provide required information, breach of ethics or security rules (if applicable), etc.), or
- (b) a beneficiary (or a person having powers of representation, decision-making or control, or person essential for the award/implementation of the grant) has committed — in other EU grants awarded to it under similar conditions — systemic or recurrent errors, irregularities, fraud or serious breach of obligations that have a material impact on this grant (extension of findings; see Article 25.5)
- (c) other:

- (i) linked action issues: not applicable
- (ii) the action has lost its scientific or technological relevance, for EIC Accelerator actions: the action has lost its economic relevance, for challenge-based EIC Pathfinder actions and Horizon Europe Missions: the action has lost its relevance as part of the Portfolio for which it has been initially selected

31.2.2 Procedure

Before suspending the grant, the granting authority will send a **pre-information letter** to the coordinator:

- formally notifying the intention to suspend the grant and the reasons why and
- requesting observations within 30 days of receiving notification.

If the granting authority does not receive observations or decides to pursue the procedure despite the observations it has received, it will confirm the suspension (**confirmation letter**). Otherwise, it will formally notify that the procedure is discontinued.

The suspension will **take effect** the day after the confirmation notification is sent (or on a later date specified in the notification).

Once the conditions for resuming implementation of the action are met, the granting authority will formally notify the coordinator a **lifting of suspension letter**, in which it will set the suspension end date and invite the coordinator to request an amendment of the Agreement to set the resumption date (one day after suspension end date), extend the duration and make other changes necessary to adapt the action to the new situation (see Article 39) — unless the grant has been terminated (see Article 32). The suspension will be **lifted** with effect from the suspension end date set out in the lifting of suspension letter. This date may be before the date on which the letter is sent.

During the suspension, no prefinancing will be paid. Moreover, no work may be done. Ongoing work packages must be interrupted and no new work packages may be started.

The beneficiaries may not claim damages due to suspension by the granting authority (see Article 33).

Grant suspension does not affect the granting authority's right to terminate the grant or a beneficiary (see Article 32) or reduce the grant (see Article 28).

ARTICLE 32 — GRANT AGREEMENT OR BENEFICIARY TERMINATION

32.1 Consortium-requested GA termination

32.1.1 Conditions and procedure

The beneficiaries may request the termination of the grant.

The coordinator must submit a request for **amendment** (see Article 39), with:

- the reasons why
- the date the consortium ends work on the action ('end of work date') and

- the date the termination takes effect ('termination date'); this date must be after the date of the submission of the amendment request.

The termination will **take effect** on the termination date specified in the amendment.

If no reasons are given or if the granting authority considers the reasons do not justify termination, it may consider the grant terminated improperly.

32.1.2 Effects

The coordinator must — within 60 days from when termination takes effect — submit a **periodic report** (for the open reporting period until termination).

The granting authority will calculate the final grant amount and final payment on the basis of the report submitted and taking into account the lump sum contributions for activities implemented before the end of work date (see Article 22). Partial lump sum contributions for work packages that were not completed (e.g. due to technical reasons) may exceptionally be taken into account.

If the granting authority does not receive the report within the deadline, only lump sum contributions which are included in an approved periodic report will be taken into account (no contributions if no periodic report was ever approved).

Improper termination may lead to a grant reduction (see Article 28).

After termination, the beneficiaries' obligations (in particular Articles 13 (confidentiality and security), 16 (IPR), 17 (communication, dissemination and visibility), 21 (reporting), 25 (checks, reviews, audits and investigations), 26 (impact evaluation), 27 (rejections), 28 (grant reduction) and 42 (assignment of claims)) continue to apply.

32.2 Consortium-requested beneficiary termination

32.2.1 Conditions and procedure

The coordinator may request the termination of the participation of one or more beneficiaries, on request of the beneficiary concerned or on behalf of the other beneficiaries.

The coordinator must submit a request for **amendment** (see Article 39), with:

- the reasons why
- the opinion of the beneficiary concerned (or proof that this opinion has been requested in writing)
- the date the beneficiary ends work on the action ('end of work date')
- the date the termination takes effect ('termination date'); this date must be after the date of the submission of the amendment request.

If the termination concerns the coordinator and is done without its agreement, the amendment request must be submitted by another beneficiary (acting on behalf of the consortium).

The termination will **take effect** on the termination date specified in the amendment.

If no information is given or if the granting authority considers that the reasons do not justify termination, it may consider the beneficiary to have been terminated improperly.

32.2.2 Effects

The coordinator must — within 60 days from when termination takes effect — submit:

- (i) a **report on the distribution of payments** to the beneficiary concerned
- (ii) a **termination report** from the beneficiary concerned, for the open reporting period until termination, containing an overview of the progress of the work
- (iii) a second **request for amendment** (see Article 39) with other amendments needed (e.g. reallocation of the tasks and the estimated budget of the terminated beneficiary; addition of a new beneficiary to replace the terminated beneficiary; change of coordinator, etc.).

The granting authority will calculate the amount due to the beneficiary on the basis of the reports submitted in previous interim payments (i.e. beneficiary's lump sum contributions for completed and approved work packages).

Lump sum contributions for ongoing/not yet completed work packages will have to be included in the periodic report for the next reporting periods when those work packages have been completed.

If the granting authority does not receive the report on the distribution of payments within the deadline, it will consider that:

- the coordinator did not distribute any payment to the beneficiary concerned and that
- the beneficiary concerned must not repay any amount to the coordinator.

If the second request for amendment is accepted by the granting authority, the Agreement is **amended** to introduce the necessary changes (see Article 39).

If the second request for amendment is rejected by the granting authority (because it calls into question the decision awarding the grant or breaches the principle of equal treatment of applicants), the grant may be terminated (see Article 32).

Improper termination may lead to a reduction of the grant (see Article 31) or grant termination (see Article 32).

After termination, the concerned beneficiary's obligations (in particular Articles 13 (confidentiality and security), 16 (IPR), 17 (communication, dissemination and visibility), 21 (reporting), 25 (checks, reviews, audits and investigations), 26 (impact evaluation), 27 (rejections), 28 (grant reduction) and 42 (assignment of claims)) continue to apply.

32.3 EU-initiated GA or beneficiary termination

32.3.1 Conditions

The granting authority may terminate the grant or the participation of one or more beneficiaries, if:

- (a) one or more beneficiaries do not accede to the Agreement (see Article 40)

- (b) a change to the action or the legal, financial, technical, organisational or ownership situation of a beneficiary is likely to substantially affect the implementation of the action or calls into question the decision to award the grant (including changes linked to one of the exclusion grounds listed in the declaration of honour)
- (c) following termination of one or more beneficiaries, the necessary changes to the Agreement (and their impact on the action) would call into question the decision awarding the grant or breach the principle of equal treatment of applicants
- (d) implementation of the action has become impossible or the changes necessary for its continuation would call into question the decision awarding the grant or breach the principle of equal treatment of applicants
- (e) a beneficiary (or person with unlimited liability for its debts) is subject to bankruptcy proceedings or similar (including insolvency, winding-up, administration by a liquidator or court, arrangement with creditors, suspension of business activities, etc.)
- (f) a beneficiary (or person with unlimited liability for its debts) is in breach of social security or tax obligations
- (g) a beneficiary (or person having powers of representation, decision-making or control, or person essential for the award/implementation of the grant) has been found guilty of grave professional misconduct
- (h) a beneficiary (or person having powers of representation, decision-making or control, or person essential for the award/implementation of the grant) has committed fraud, corruption, or is involved in a criminal organisation, money laundering, terrorism-related crimes (including terrorism financing), child labour or human trafficking
- (i) a beneficiary (or person having powers of representation, decision-making or control, or person essential for the award/implementation of the grant) was created under a different jurisdiction with the intent to circumvent fiscal, social or other legal obligations in the country of origin (or created another entity with this purpose)
- (j) a beneficiary (or person having powers of representation, decision-making or control, or person essential for the award/implementation of the grant) has committed:
 - (i) substantial errors, irregularities or fraud or
 - (ii) serious breach of obligations under this Agreement or during its award (including improper implementation of the action, non-compliance with the call conditions, submission of false information, failure to provide required information, breach of ethics or security rules (if applicable), etc.)
- (k) a beneficiary (or person having powers of representation, decision-making or control, or person essential for the award/implementation of the grant) has committed — in other EU grants awarded to it under similar conditions — systemic or recurrent errors, irregularities, fraud or serious breach of obligations that have a material impact on this grant (extension of findings; see Article 25.5)
- (l) despite a specific request by the granting authority, a beneficiary does not request — through the coordinator — an amendment to the Agreement to end the participation of one of its

affiliated entities or associated partners that is in one of the situations under points (d), (f), (e), (g), (h), (i) or (j) and to reallocate its tasks, or

(m) other:

- (i) linked action issues: not applicable
- (ii) the action has lost its scientific or technological relevance, for EIC Accelerator actions: the action has lost its economic relevance, for challenge-based EIC Pathfinder actions and Horizon Europe Missions: the action has lost its relevance as part of the Portfolio for which it has been initially selected

32.3.2 Procedure

Before terminating the grant or participation of one or more beneficiaries, the granting authority will send a **pre-information letter** to the coordinator or beneficiary concerned:

- formally notifying the intention to terminate and the reasons why and
- requesting observations within 30 days of receiving notification.

If the granting authority does not receive observations or decides to pursue the procedure despite the observations it has received, it will confirm the termination and the date it will take effect (**confirmation letter**). Otherwise, it will formally notify that the procedure is discontinued.

For beneficiary terminations, the granting authority will — at the end of the procedure — also inform the coordinator.

The termination will **take effect** the day after the confirmation notification is sent (or on a later date specified in the notification; ‘termination date’).

32.3.3 Effects

(a) for **GA termination**:

The coordinator must — within 60 days from when termination takes effect — submit a **periodic report** (for the last open reporting period until termination).

The granting authority will calculate the final grant amount and final payment on the basis of the report submitted and taking into account the lump sum contributions for activities implemented before termination takes effect (see Article 22). Partial lump sum contributions for work packages that were not completed (e.g. due to technical reasons) may exceptionally be taken into account.

If the grant is terminated for breach of the obligation to submit reports, the coordinator may not submit any report after termination.

If the granting authority does not receive the report within the deadline, only lump sum contributions which are included in an approved periodic report will be taken into account (no contributions if no periodic report was ever approved).

Termination does not affect the granting authority’s right to reduce the grant (see Article 28) or to impose administrative sanctions (see Article 34).

The beneficiaries may not claim damages due to termination by the granting authority (see Article 33).

After termination, the beneficiaries' obligations (in particular Articles 13 (confidentiality and security), 16 (IPR), 17 (communication, dissemination and visibility), 21 (reporting), 25 (checks, reviews, audits and investigations), 26 (impact evaluation), 27 (rejections), 28 (grant reduction) and 42 (assignment of claims)) continue to apply.

(b) for beneficiary termination:

The coordinator must — within 60 days from when termination takes effect — submit:

- (i) a **report on the distribution of payments** to the beneficiary concerned
- (ii) a **termination report** from the beneficiary concerned, for the open reporting period until termination, containing an overview of the progress of the work
- (iii) a **request for amendment** (see Article 39) with any amendments needed (e.g. reallocation of the tasks and the estimated budget of the terminated beneficiary; addition of a new beneficiary to replace the terminated beneficiary; change of coordinator, etc.).

The granting authority will calculate the amount due to the beneficiary on the basis of the reports submitted in previous interim payments (i.e. beneficiary's lump sum contributions for completed and approved work packages).

Lump sum contributions for ongoing/not yet completed work packages will have to be included in the periodic report for the next reporting periods when those work packages have been completed.

If the granting authority does not receive the report on the distribution of payments within the deadline, it will consider that:

- the coordinator did not distribute any payment to the beneficiary concerned and that
- the beneficiary concerned must not repay any amount to the coordinator.

If the request for amendment is accepted by the granting authority, the Agreement is **amended** to introduce the necessary changes (see Article 39).

If the request for amendment is rejected by the granting authority (because it calls into question the decision awarding the grant or breaches the principle of equal treatment of applicants), the grant may be terminated (see Article 32).

After termination, the concerned beneficiary's obligations (in particular Articles 13 (confidentiality and security), 16 (IPR), 17 (communication, dissemination and visibility), 21 (reporting), 25 (checks, reviews, audits and investigations), 26 (impact evaluation), 27 (rejections), 28 (grant reduction) and 42 (assignment of claims)) continue to apply.

SECTION 3 OTHER CONSEQUENCES: DAMAGES AND ADMINISTRATIVE SANCTIONS

ARTICLE 33 — DAMAGES

33.1 Liability of the granting authority

The granting authority cannot be held liable for any damage caused to the beneficiaries or to third parties as a consequence of the implementation of the Agreement, including for gross negligence.

The granting authority cannot be held liable for any damage caused by any of the beneficiaries or other participants involved in the action, as a consequence of the implementation of the Agreement.

33.2 Liability of the beneficiaries

The beneficiaries must compensate the granting authority for any damage it sustains as a result of the implementation of the action or because the action was not implemented in full compliance with the Agreement, provided that it was caused by gross negligence or wilful act.

The liability does not extend to indirect or consequential losses or similar damage (such as loss of profit, loss of revenue or loss of contracts), provided such damage was not caused by wilful act or by a breach of confidentiality.

ARTICLE 34 — ADMINISTRATIVE SANCTIONS AND OTHER MEASURES

Nothing in this Agreement may be construed as preventing the adoption of administrative sanctions (i.e. exclusion from EU award procedures and/or financial penalties) or other public law measures, in addition or as an alternative to the contractual measures provided under this Agreement (see, for instance, Articles 135 to 145 EU Financial Regulation 2018/1046 and Articles 4 and 7 of Regulation 2988/95¹⁸).

SECTION 4 FORCE MAJEURE

ARTICLE 35 — FORCE MAJEURE

A party prevented by force majeure from fulfilling its obligations under the Agreement cannot be considered in breach of them.

‘Force majeure’ means any situation or event that:

- prevents either party from fulfilling their obligations under the Agreement,
- was unforeseeable, exceptional situation and beyond the parties’ control,
- was not due to error or negligence on their part (or on the part of other participants involved in the action), and
- proves to be inevitable in spite of exercising all due diligence.

Any situation constituting force majeure must be formally notified to the other party without delay, stating the nature, likely duration and foreseeable effects.

¹⁸ Council Regulation (EC, Euratom) No 2988/95 of 18 December 1995 on the protection of the European Communities financial interests (OJ L 312, 23.12.1995, p. 1).

The parties must immediately take all the necessary steps to limit any damage due to force majeure and do their best to resume implementation of the action as soon as possible.

CHAPTER 6 FINAL PROVISIONS

ARTICLE 36 — COMMUNICATION BETWEEN THE PARTIES

36.1 Forms and means of communication — Electronic management

EU grants are managed fully electronically through the EU Funding & Tenders Portal ('Portal').

All communications must be made electronically through the Portal in accordance with the Portal Terms and Conditions and using the forms and templates provided there (except if explicitly instructed otherwise by the granting authority).

Communications must be made in writing and clearly identify the grant agreement (project number and acronym).

Communications must be made by persons authorised according to the Portal Terms and Conditions. For naming the authorised persons, each beneficiary must have designated — before the signature of this Agreement — a 'legal entity appointed representative (LEAR)'. The role and tasks of the LEAR are stipulated in their appointment letter (see Portal Terms and Conditions).

If the electronic exchange system is temporarily unavailable, instructions will be given on the Portal.

36.2 Date of communication

The sending date for communications made through the Portal will be the date and time of sending, as indicated by the time logs.

The receiving date for communications made through the Portal will be the date and time the communication is accessed, as indicated by the time logs. Formal notifications that have not been accessed within 10 days after sending, will be considered to have been accessed (see Portal Terms and Conditions).

If a communication is exceptionally made on paper (by e-mail or postal service), general principles apply (i.e. date of sending/receipt). Formal notifications by registered post with proof of delivery will be considered to have been received either on the delivery date registered by the postal service or the deadline for collection at the post office.

If the electronic exchange system is temporarily unavailable, the sending party cannot be considered in breach of its obligation to send a communication within a specified deadline.

36.3 Addresses for communication

The Portal can be accessed via the Europa website.

The address for paper communications to the granting authority (if exceptionally allowed) is the official mailing address indicated on its website.

For beneficiaries, it is the legal address specified in the Portal Participant Register.

ARTICLE 37 — INTERPRETATION OF THE AGREEMENT

The provisions in the Data Sheet take precedence over the rest of the Terms and Conditions of the Agreement.

Annex 5 takes precedence over the Terms and Conditions.

The Terms and Conditions take precedence over the Annexes other than Annex 5.

Annex 2 takes precedence over Annex 1.

ARTICLE 38 — CALCULATION OF PERIODS AND DEADLINES

In accordance with Regulation No 1182/71¹⁹, periods expressed in days, months or years are calculated from the moment the triggering event occurs.

The day during which that event occurs is not considered as falling within the period.

‘Days’ means calendar days, not working days.

ARTICLE 39 — AMENDMENTS

39.1 Conditions

The Agreement may be amended, unless the amendment entails changes to the Agreement which would call into question the decision awarding the grant or breach the principle of equal treatment of applicants.

Amendments may be requested by any of the parties.

39.2 Procedure

The party requesting an amendment must submit a request for amendment signed directly in the Portal Amendment tool.

The coordinator submits and receives requests for amendment on behalf of the beneficiaries (see Annex 3). If a change of coordinator is requested without its agreement, the submission must be done by another beneficiary (acting on behalf of the other beneficiaries).

The request for amendment must include:

- the reasons why
- the appropriate supporting documents and
- for a change of coordinator without its agreement: the opinion of the coordinator (or proof that this opinion has been requested in writing).

The granting authority may request additional information.

¹⁹ Regulation (EEC, Euratom) No 1182/71 of the Council of 3 June 1971 determining the rules applicable to periods, dates and time-limits (OJ L 124, 8/6/1971, p. 1).

If the party receiving the request agrees, it must sign the amendment in the tool within 45 days of receiving notification (or any additional information the granting authority has requested). If it does not agree, it must formally notify its disagreement within the same deadline. The deadline may be extended, if necessary for the assessment of the request. If no notification is received within the deadline, the request is considered to have been rejected.

An amendment **enters into force** on the day of the signature of the receiving party.

An amendment **takes effect** on the date of entry into force or other date specified in the amendment.

ARTICLE 40 — ACCESSION AND ADDITION OF NEW BENEFICIARIES

40.1 Accession of the beneficiaries mentioned in the Preamble

The beneficiaries which are not coordinator must accede to the grant by signing the accession form (see Annex 3) directly in the Portal Grant Preparation tool, within 30 days after the entry into force of the Agreement (see Article 44).

They will assume the rights and obligations under the Agreement with effect from the date of its entry into force (see Article 44).

If a beneficiary does not accede to the grant within the above deadline, the coordinator must — within 30 days — request an amendment (see Article 39) to terminate the beneficiary and make any changes necessary to ensure proper implementation of the action. This does not affect the granting authority's right to terminate the grant (see Article 32).

40.2 Addition of new beneficiaries

In justified cases, the beneficiaries may request the addition of a new beneficiary.

For this purpose, the coordinator must submit a request for amendment in accordance with Article 39. It must include an accession form (see Annex 3) signed by the new beneficiary directly in the Portal Amendment tool.

New beneficiaries will assume the rights and obligations under the Agreement with effect from the date of their accession specified in the accession form (see Annex 3).

Additions are also possible in mono-beneficiary grants.

ARTICLE 41 — TRANSFER OF THE AGREEMENT

In justified cases, the beneficiary of a mono-beneficiary grant may request the transfer of the grant to a new beneficiary, provided that this would not call into question the decision awarding the grant or breach the principle of equal treatment of applicants.

The beneficiary must submit a request for **amendment** (see Article 39), with

- the reasons why
- the accession form (see Annex 3) signed by the new beneficiary directly in the Portal Amendment tool and

- additional supporting documents (if required by the granting authority).

The new beneficiary will assume the rights and obligations under the Agreement with effect from the date of accession specified in the accession form (see Annex 3).

ARTICLE 42 — ASSIGNMENTS OF CLAIMS FOR PAYMENT AGAINST THE GRANTING AUTHORITY

The beneficiaries may not assign any of their claims for payment against the granting authority to any third party, except if expressly approved in writing by the granting authority on the basis of a reasoned, written request by the coordinator (on behalf of the beneficiary concerned).

If the granting authority has not accepted the assignment or if the terms of it are not observed, the assignment will have no effect on it.

In no circumstances will an assignment release the beneficiaries from their obligations towards the granting authority.

ARTICLE 43 — APPLICABLE LAW AND SETTLEMENT OF DISPUTES

43.1 Applicable law

The Agreement is governed by the applicable EU law, supplemented if necessary by the law of Belgium.

Special rules may apply for beneficiaries which are international organisations (if any; see Data Sheet, Point 5).

43.2 Dispute settlement

If a dispute concerns the interpretation, application or validity of the Agreement, the parties must bring action before the EU General Court — or, on appeal, the EU Court of Justice — under Article 272 of the Treaty on the Functioning of the EU (TFEU).

For non-EU beneficiaries (if any), such disputes must be brought before the courts of Brussels, Belgium — unless an international agreement provides for the enforceability of EU court judgements.

For beneficiaries with arbitration as special dispute settlement forum (if any; see Data Sheet, Point 5), the dispute will — in the absence of an amicable settlement — be settled in accordance with the Rules for Arbitration published on the Portal.

If a dispute concerns administrative sanctions, offsetting or an enforceable decision under Article 299 TFEU (see Articles 22 and 34), the beneficiaries must bring action before the General Court — or, on appeal, the Court of Justice — under Article 263 TFEU.

For grants where the granting authority is an EU executive agency (see Preamble), actions against offsetting and enforceable decisions must be brought against the European Commission (not against the granting authority; see also Article 22).

ARTICLE 44 — ENTRY INTO FORCE

The Agreement will enter into force on the day of signature by the granting authority or the coordinator, depending on which is later.

SIGNATURES

For the coordinator

Kyriakos Yakinthos with ECAS id nlaopoth signed in the Participant Portal on 17/05/2024 at 08:28:47 (transaction id SigId-15428-OzRzjGJlAqjpoedFAoyGOesziD1XtAQPC4tm32PO2Y3AwiOIjldHn42WYg8izYBwOI7J8ieGpkKdzG7mSwWDg1S-yntOf97TTHq5dFosMotCJW-cUpVkakoj80Lfih7xfm7iQaKQzSKpIgCyH2YSyostAybuU7LNUV8JnK3HrwEcuY9ZRRrpHO0ycmGrYqmbZcj7W). Timestamp by third party at 2024.05.17 08:28:52 CEST

For the granting authority

Signed by Gerald CULTOT with ECAS id cultoge as an authorised representative on 17-05-2024 12:43:32 (transaction id SigId-20833-spRzMWpI5SI1aMANQFhedozygufts79YTyuawTAMAcXkuPBQ0xUELGE75nf4UuzPzqMZ6uWb0uS8PYOYYBiyXsO-yntOf97TTHq5dFosMotCJW-QGizazPv0yZUJTkBMzwrSiIs4fu78Fu4zpQgLS1k2pPpzUcZiMejswlzbthnWO03SUL49a2I5uaBxmglKpiPaQW) 2024.05.17 12:43:36 CEST



ANNEX 1



Horizon Europe (HORIZON)

Description of the action (DoA)

Part A

Part B

DESCRIPTION OF THE ACTION (PART A)

COVER PAGE

Part A of the Description of the Action (DoA) must be completed directly on the Portal Grant Preparation screens.

PROJECT	
Grant Preparation (General Information screen) — Enter the info.	
Project number:	101158152
Project name:	Engaging the Value Of Living Labs to Innovate Care And Regulatory Environments
Project acronym:	EVOLVE2CARE
Call:	HORIZON-EIE-2023-CONNECT-02
Topic:	HORIZON-EIE-2023-CONNECT-02-01
Type of action:	HORIZON-CSA
Service:	EISMEA/I/01
Project starting date:	fixed date: 1 October 2024
Project duration:	24 months

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PROJECT SUMMARY

Project summary

Grant Preparation (General Information screen) — Provide an overall description of your project (including context and overall objectives, planned activities and main achievements, and expected results and impacts (on target groups, change procedures, capacities, innovation etc)). This summary should give readers a clear idea of what your project is about.

Use the project summary from your proposal.

Charting a course for a more resilient and patient-centric healthcare future depends on continuous development and delivery of innovation to the market. EVOLVE2CARE focuses on HealthTech experimentation practice frameworks, standardizing and enhancing the symbiotic relationship between living labs and innovators in the context of the Transitional Care sector. Challenges ranging from an aging population to complexity of medical conditions and regulatory frameworks, bring a growing recognition of the importance of experimentation practices. By subjecting innovations to real-world scenarios, experimentation uncovers complexities, ethical considerations, interoperability challenges, and unforeseen barriers that controlled environments may not reveal. By harnessing the power of Living Labs – real-world environments involving users and stakeholders – EVOLVE2CARE will provide innovators with access to services for testing/validating research and products. EVOLVE2CARE focuses on three Use Cases (Hospital Discharge Management, Homecare Monitoring Solutions, Aging Population & Care Transitions), engaging stakeholders from across the value chain to examine complexities, barriers and enablers that regulatory frameworks pose to the development and commercialization of healthcare innovations. Recognizing the cross-disciplinary nature of healthcare, we will engage with EIT KICs and their beneficiaries. We will provide a scalable, collaborative experimentation space (the AccelUP marketplace), to aggregate Living Labs, innovators, researchers, regulators, investors, and other pertinent stakeholders. Trainings workshops, and reports will increase knowledge and disseminate findings to our stakeholders. The project partners encompass vast expertise and networks covering the development/commercialization of innovation in transitional care. The project advisory board consists of C-Level Experts in Healthcare/Pharma, Living Labs, Startups, EIT programs and Regulatory issues.

LIST OF PARTICIPANTS

PARTICIPANTS

Grant Preparation (Beneficiaries screen) — Enter the info.

Number	Role	Short name	Legal name	Country	PIC
1	COO	AUTH	ARISTOTELIO PANEPISTIMIO THESSALONIKIS	EL	999895692
2	BEN	ENoLL IVZW	EUROPEAN NETWORK OF LIVING LABS IVZW	BE	984556306
3	BEN	AV	ANTHOLOGY VENTURES JSC	BG	895312523
4	BEN	SPLORO	SPLOROTECH SL	ES	890190147
5	BEN	VILABS	VILABS (CY) LTD	CY	917943205

LIST OF WORK PACKAGES

Work packages						
Grant Preparation (Work Packages screen) — Enter the info.						
Work Package No	Work Package name	Lead Beneficiary	Effort (Person-Months)	Start Month	End Month	Deliverables
WP1	EVOLVE2CARE experimentation space framework	1 - AUTH	24.50	1	24	D1.1 – Roadmap on navigating the complexities of enabling innovative technologies in transitional care D1.2 – Stakeholder Needs Analysis and KPI framework D1.3 – EVOVLE2CARE Action Plan D1.4 – Roadmap on navigating the complexities of enabling innovative technologies in transitional care - Final D1.5 – Stakeholder Needs Analysis and KPI framework - Final D1.6 – EVOVLE2CARE Action Plan - Final
WP2	Matching AccelUP Experimentation Space and Services with Innovators and Researchers	1 - AUTH	66.50	2	24	D2.1 – AccelUP Experimentation Space infrastructure D2.2 – LLs, Innovators and Researchers Scouting and selection Report D2.3 – Training Program for Living Labs D2.4 – Training Program for Innovators/ Researchers D2.5 – AccelUP Experimentation Space infrastructure - Final
WP3	Set Up of AccelUP experimentation Space and Services Execution, Lessons Learnt and Best practices	3 - AV	54.50	12	24	D3.1 – Monitoring and Evaluation of the experimentation services D3.2 – Lessons Learnt and Policy Recommendations Report

Work packages						
<i>Grant Preparation (Work Packages screen) — Enter the info.</i>						
Work Package No	Work Package name	Lead Beneficiary	Effort (Person-Months)	Start Month	End Month	Deliverables
						D3.3 – Standardization, Scalability, Replicability and Business Model D3.4 – Commercialization Potential of Innovations
WP4	EVOLVE2CARE's People-Centric Experimentation Ecosystem Outreach, Sustainability and Clustering	5 - VILABS	90.80	1	24	D4.1 – Dissemination, Communication and Outreach Strategy and Materials D4.2 – Exploitation and IPR Management D4.3 – Clustering with EIT KICs projects and relevant initiatives D4.4 – Dissemination, Communication and Outreach Strategy and Materials - Final
WP5	Project Coordination and Management	1 - AUTH	25.60	1	24	D5.1 – Project Management Handbook D5.2 – Interim Reports D5.3 – Technical, IPR and Innovation Management D5.4 – Project Management Handbook - Final D5.5 – Interim Reports - Final D5.6 – Technical, IPR and Innovation Management - Final
WP6	Ethics requirements	1 - AUTH	0.00	1	24	D6.1 – OEI - Requirement No. 1

Work package WP1 – EVOLVE2CARE experimentation space framework

Work Package Number	WP1	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Work Package Name	EVOLVE2CARE experimentation space framework		
Start Month	1	End Month	24

Objectives

The main goal of WP1, led by AUTH is to design a scalable experimentation space. The specific objectives are:

- Identify drivers and barriers for the development of innovations
- Define the specific requirements of the various stakeholders who can impact or be impacted from the outcomes of experiments.
- Design EVOLVE2CARE's experimentation space capitalizing on AccelUP
- Define the Use Cases reflecting solutions in the transitional care sector
- Design an appropriate KPI framework for measuring experimental performance

Description

T1.1. Drivers and Barriers for the development of innovations [M1-M4, M19-M24] | Leader: Sploro | Partners involved: ALL

Sploro will initiate a comprehensive research phase spanning Months 1-4. This will involve gathering data through literature reviews, stakeholder interviews, and surveys to identify the key drivers and barriers that potentially influence the development of innovative technologies in transitional care. T1.1 will also concentrate on legal, regulatory, fiscal, technical, and operational challenges that could hinder innovation. Sploro will lead the effort in synthesizing this information, working closely with all partners to ensure a comprehensive understanding of the barriers. Regular virtual meetings will be scheduled to ensure that all partners are aligned and to discuss preliminary findings. During the second phase, from Month 19- 24, the focus will shift to analyzing the key finding after the execution of the Use Cases within the LLs. Finally, both phases will culminate in the creation of a detailed final report that integrates the findings on both drivers and barriers. This report will be developed by Sploro but will incorporate contributions and insights from all partners. It aims to serve as a foundational document that provides a roadmap for navigating the complexities of enabling innovative technologies in transitional care. The final report will be disseminated to all stakeholders and will also be made publicly available for broader impact. The work done under Task 1.1 will be reported in deliverable D1.1 due by month M4 (interim), and M24 (Final).

T1.2: Definition of Stakeholders' requirements and KPI framework [M1-M6, M15-M19] | Leader: AUTH | Partners involved: ALL

T1.2 will investigate the specific requirements for each of the key stakeholders involved in EVOLVE2CARE. Researchers and innovators may have requirements related to experimental validity, pricing, IP protection, user engagement, data accessibility, and access to well-equipped labs that can support their research aims. Regulators and policymakers' requirements may include support for the innovation eco-system, impact evaluation, and alignment with policy objectives. Users' and participants' needs may differ in terms of benefits, informed consent, data privacy, ethical treatment, and feedback methods. Infrastructure maintenance, user recruitment, data management, technical support, and networking and collaborations can be all important for LLs operators. Based on the stakeholder requirements and the UCs specification (T1.3), a global framework for the EVOLVE2CARE evaluation and impact assessment in terms of technical, economic, environmental, and social aspects, will be defined. In addition, UC-specific KPIs (based on T1.3 results) will be introduced to address the specific needs of the stakeholders involved in each UC experimentations e.g., reduction in medication errors during transition (UC1), patient adherence to remote monitoring (UC2), improved mobility and independence of elderly patients (UC3). Additionally, considering ethical considerations and data privacy in the selected experiments, it is paramount to include KPIs that ensure the well-being and privacy of patients and caregivers. T1.2 KPI repository, will be suited to assess a wide set of experiments related to HealthTech in the transitional care domain. T1.2 outcomes will be reported by AUTH in D1.2 by M6 (initial version before the experimentation starts), and M19 (final version).

T1.3. Specification of Use Cases, Marketplace Architecture and Action Plan [M1-M9, M17-M19] | Leader: AUTH | Partners involved: ALL

In T1.3 the Use Cases already identified at the proposal stage i.e., a) Management of Hospital Discharge, b) Home Care Monitoring, c) Aging population and care transition, will be further specified in terms of their objectives, the key stakeholders that should be involved in the experimenting processes of related technologies, and the experimentation

framework required to satisfy each UC goals. The details will be valuable in the onboarding process of innovators and LLs, and the design and execution of experiments in T3.1. Based on the stakeholders' requirements (T1.2) and the Use Case definition, AUTH, with the collaboration of all partners, will specify the digital tools that will be integrated into AccelUP to ensure that stakeholder's requirements are met. Such best practices tools will include profiling techniques for matching innovators with LLs, knowledge exchange and collaborative tools for innovators/researcher, stakeholders, and regulators, lessons learnt and best practices diffusion mechanisms, as well as user engagement solutions. T1.3 will deliver an Action Plan for a) aligning the experimentation spaces of LLs to render them ready to address efficiently stakeholder specific needs and lay down appropriate experimentation practices and b) setting up the AccelUP marketplace of experimentation spaces that can strengthen and connect the innovation ecosystems around EU. T1.3 outcomes will be reported in D1.3 by M9 (first version) and M19 (final version, after the experimentations have started and more info are available).

Work package WP2 – Matching AccelUP Experimentation Space and Services with Innovators and Researchers

Work Package Number	WP2	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Work Package Name	Matching AccelUP Experimentation Space and Services with Innovators and Researchers		
Start Month	2	End Month	24

Objectives

The main goal of WP2, led by AUTH, is to design a scalable experimentation space. The specific objectives are:

- Develop the AccelUP experimentation space
- Onboard LLs and innovators/researchers
- Design tailored programs for LLs to increase their capacities to support the commercialization of innovations
- Design tailored programs for innovators/researchers to increase their knowledge and capacities in leveraging LLs environments and commercializing innovations

Description

T2.1. EVOLVE2CARE Experimentation Space infrastructure [M7-M24] | Leader: AUTH | Partners involved: ALL
This task entails the progressive development of the AccelUP software infrastructure. The primary focus during M7-M12 revolves around enhancing the functionalities associated with the onboarding process for Living Labs who are integral to the project. This includes refining the mechanisms for LLs to create their profiles and become visible on the AccelUP platform, as well as streamlining the onboarding procedures for stakeholders. Furthermore, efforts are directed towards establishing robust channels for knowledge sharing and the exchange of Good Practices among LLs. In the subsequent phase, spanning from M12-M24, the task shifts towards the advancement of the bidding process within AccelUP. This process enhancement draws insights from feedback collected from Task 1.2, concerning stakeholders' requirements, and Task 2.2, centered around the matching process, which is executed within the validated Sploro platform. The acquired insights from the matching process inform and refine the bidding process functionality of AccelUP, ensuring alignment with the evolving needs of the project's stakeholders and contributors. Task 2.1 outcomes on Accelup advancement will be reported in D2.1 on M12 and the platform will be refined based on lessons learnt by M24.

T2.2. LLs, Innovators and Researchers Scouting and selection [M2-M12] Leader: Sploro | Partners involved: ALL
The ultimate aim of T2.2 is for Innovators to benefit from Living Labs, who will to be paid with project vouchers to open their facilities and services to Innovators around EU for the purpose of conducting experiments. T2.2 will be segmented into three main phases: call preparation, call publication, and selection of Living Labs and Innovators. There will be two Open Calls specifically designed to attract: a) Innovators who wish to test their innovations, and b) Living Labs who will provide access to their services. In the call preparation phase, Sploro, as the task leader, will draft the call document that outlines the criteria, objectives, and expectations for the Living Labs and Innovators. This document will be subject to review and approval by all partners to ensure that it aligns with the project's overall goals and objectives. For the publication phase, the call targeting innovators/researchers will be published under the Sploro Open Call platform, similar to other projects like Ventures Thrive, NGI Sargasso, Spade, Women TechEU, Empowomen TechEU, and PQ React projects. A dedicated email helpline, FAQ sections on the project website, and informational webinars will help the diffusion of relevant information to interested innovators. Recruitment efforts will systematically

target top-tier innovators and researchers, academic societies, accelerators/incubators, and professional networks, and utilizing the appropriate communications channels (social media etc.). Sploro will lead the proposal evaluation process for innovators, involving a review committee made up of representatives from all partner organizations. The committee will assess the proposals based on predefined criteria such as innovation potential, feasibility, and alignment with project objectives. The shortlisted projects will be also reviewed for ethics issues by the External Ethics expert that will be contracted by the consortium (T5.2). The pool of Living Labs will be recruited through the AccelUP platform. Lessons learnt from the recruitment of innovators, based on a proved methodology provided by Sploro, will be embedded in the AccelUP platform, for future use. A full, standardized inventory of the LL's services, resources, and capabilities will be gathered, and profiles will be created for each lab for easy reference and comparison on AccelUP. The emphasis will be on making it clear that the selected Living Labs will be paid to lease their facilities to innovators. We aim to have a cohort totalling 30 LLs (certified by ENOLL) from at least 10 member states. After successful evaluation and selection, innovators/researchers will be matched with those Living Labs. Upon completion of the matching process, Sploro will prepare agreements with the selected Living Labs, outlining the terms for opening their facilities to innovators. All partners will review and provide input on these agreements before they are finalized. As soon as both LLs and innovators are onboarded, they will be familiarized with the collaboration's objectives, and provided with necessary resources and communication channels. T2.2 outcomes will be reported by Sploro in D2.2 due by M14.

T2.3. Training Program for Living Labs [M4-M14] | Leader: ENOLL | Partners involved: ALL

A comprehensive and multifaceted training program designed to help Living Labs support innovators in assessing experimental outcomes and commercializing their research results will be designed in T2.3. This training is aimed at Living Labs who do not yet have an established pattern of service provision that generates income. The trainings will increase the capacities of Living Lab professionals to expand their offerings to a wider audience and leverage their resources, to become sustainable operating entities. LL staff will be equipped with new methods to help innovators navigate the complex process of bringing a technology from the research stage to the market. The training objectives include: a) an overview of the innovation landscape, emphasizing the role of Living Labs in the innovation process, their potential benefits, and their contribution to societal and economic growth; b) learn effective operational methodologies, user engagement strategies, data collection techniques, project management, and quality assurance; c) learn how to offer guidance on ethical considerations, data privacy, intellectual property, and legal frameworks to ensure that Living Labs operate responsibly and compliantly; d) focus on communication, collaboration, and networking skills to help Living Lab teams build strong relationships with innovators, stakeholders, and partners; e) understand the certification process and requirements to obtain status as a Certified Living Lab; f) define relevant metrics, measuring impact, and evaluating the success of innovation projects within the context of real-world deployment; g) learn how to engage with startups and businesses effectively utilizing the AccelUP platform, and understanding the researcher's needs, and aligning services to support their innovation goals; h) engage with regulators to promote authentic findings tested in real word environments and accelerate regulatory changes to facilitate innovations' faster market reach in cases where the regulatory environment is lagging behind technological developments; i) build a sustainable ecosystem by fostering systematic collaborations with academia, industries, local communities, policy makers and regulators. This task will include the preparation of the training material, and the organization and delivery of the training program to LLs. The call for LLs to participate to the training will be published through ENOLL's network of LLs and through the networks of all the partners. The call for the training, designed by ENOLL, will be open to any LL interested in participating (and not restricted to the LLs selected in T2.2). The trainings will be conducted virtually, they will be recorded and will be publicly available through the AccelUP platform, for future use. T2.3 outcomes will be reported in D2.3 in M14.

T2.4 Training Program for Innovators and Researchers [M4-M14] | Leader: AV | Partners involved: ALL

A tailored program to the needs and expertise levels of the participants, whether they are novice researchers or experienced innovators will be designed in T2.4. The aim of the program is to equip participants with the knowledge, skills, and strategies necessary to effectively leverage living labs for their research and innovation projects. The training objectives include: a) Provide an overview of Living Labs, their purpose, benefits, and how they facilitate innovation and real-world testing; b) Train innovators on how to identify and frame challenges that can be addressed through innovation and tested in Living Labs; c) Teach design thinking principles and techniques for generating creative and user-centered ideas that can lead to innovative solutions; d) Train innovators on effective data collection methods, analysis techniques, and how to extract meaningful insights from the experiments; e) Help innovators understand the importance of prototyping, testing, and iterative development within the context of Living Lab experiments; f) Assist innovators in developing a viable business model around their innovation, considering market needs, revenue streams, and scalability; g) Provide guidance on how to create compelling pitches, presentations, and business plans to attract investors, partners, and customers; h) Offer insights into protecting intellectual property, navigating legal considerations, and establishing agreements when collaborating with Living Labs. The call for researchers/innovators to participate will be published through AV, AUTH and Sploro's networks of innovators, researchers, and startups. The call for the training will be open to any researcher interested in participating (and not restricted to those selected in T2.2). The trainings will be conducted

virtually, they will be recorded and will be publicly available through the AccelUP platform (for the registered users), for future use. T2.4 outcomes will be reported by AV in D2.4 due by M14.

Work package WP3 – Set Up of AccelUP experimentation Space and Services Execution, Lessons Learnt and Best practices

Work Package Number	WP3	Lead Beneficiary	3 - AV
Work Package Name	Set Up of AccelUP experimentation Space and Services Execution, Lessons Learnt and Best practices		
Start Month	12	End Month	24

Objectives

WP3, led by AV, main objective is to successfully execute the Use Case experimentation process via subcontracted LLs. The specific objectives are:

- Execute subcontracting services, during which innovations in the transitional care sector will be tested in the participating LL infrastructures.
- Monitor, evaluate, and provide feedback on the execution of HealthTechUse Cases in the transitional care sector
- Deliver online sessions for knowledge sharing, exchanging of best practices and provide policy recommendations
- Develop a sustainable Business Model for AccelUP, and analyze the platform's scalability and replicability
- Assess the commercialization potential of the innovative solutions proposed by the researchers through the application process
- Evaluate the investment readiness of the accepted innovations (Use Cases) prior to, and following, their engagement with the LLs

Description

T3.1. Use Case Execution of Experimentation Services, Monitoring and Evaluation [M12 – M24] | Leader: AUTH | Partners involved: ALL

T3.1 is primarily focused on the execution, monitoring, and evaluation of the experimentation services as well as the matching process facilitated through the AccelUP platform, connecting LLs with innovators and researchers. Utilizing the KPI framework (T1.2) it will assess the experimentation results in terms of the pre-defined goals set between the innovators and the LLs. It will also establish a feedback mechanism for both LLs and innovators during the execution of experiments and provide input on the matching process, enabling an iterative refinement of the AccelUP bidding process based on this feedback. Additionally, this task will create reporting tools to comprehensively document various aspects of the process undertaken by each innovator at the LL (see T3.3). These reporting tools will be constructed using the VITALISE Harmonization framework (available at wiki.livinglab-harmonization.com) as a foundational reference, incorporating details on the harmonized services provided by LLs to researchers and innovators. Furthermore, the reporting will encompass insights into the effectiveness of the AccelUP matching and onboarding processes, offering suggestions for optimizing the platform's operation. T3.1 will be reported in deliverable D3.1 in M24.

T3.2. Knowledge sharing, exchange of best practices, and policy recommendations [M13-M24] | Leader: ENOLL | Partners involved: ALL

T3.2 aims to: a) to examine regulatory enablers and inhibitors that influence the process of commercializing transitional care HealthTech innovations in the three identified Use Cases, b) to understand the ameliorative role that experimentation frameworks such as living labs, can play in addressing such regulatory issues, and c) to assist policy makers in their access to data from such experimentation frameworks. To execute this, EnOLL will compile insights and data gathered from the project's earlier phases and organize two knowledge sharing workshops involving policy makers, industry experts, and project partners. These interactive sessions will focus on sharing best practices, discussing potential policy recommendations, and exploring what could feasibly be implemented. They will also be a gateway to increasing the presence of Key Opinion Leaders and policy professionals within the AccelUP community and leveraging their expertise for the overall value of the platform. The findings from these sessions will be synthesized into a comprehensive report aimed at guiding policy makers in enabling and promoting transformative innovation effectively. T3.2 outcomes will be reported by ENOLL in D3.2 due by M24.

T3.3. AccelUP Standardization, Scalability, Replicability, and Sustainable Business Model, [M13-M24] | Leader: AV | Partners involved: ALL

T3.3 aims to foster the adoption and growth of AccelUP by implementing a carefully designed approach to standardization, sustainable business modelling and active engagement with various stakeholders to ensure replicability and scalability. T3.3 will develop standardized templates for Living Labs to create listings of their services including information on the type of lab (e.g., urban, rural, virtual), available infrastructure, user demographics, and any specific research capabilities. It will promote the standardization of pricing models to ensure transparency through a clear breakdown of costs for different services. Quality assurance will be established involving user feedback, and adherence to ethical and privacy standards. Established protocols for data sharing and privacy to protect both users and researchers, while ensure compliance with relevant data protection regulations will be applied. T3.3 will also develop a guideline to maintain consistency and ethical standards across different Living Labs (beyond the LLs in the health sector). To ensure the AccelUP can become a sustainable commercial product, a business plan will be created including extensive financial modeling to foresee a path to profitability. Revenue forecasting with the addition of various services and utilization of different pricing strategies will demonstrate which features to introduce in the next iterations of the platform. The plan will also explore core issues in corporate management, including the potential for different forms of corporate status such as for-profit, non-profit, public benefit etc. The potential for investment will be analyzed and different valuation scenarios created. T3.3 outcomes will be reported by AV in D3.3 due by M24.

T3.4 Evaluation and advancement of the commercialization potential for Innovators/Researchers [M14-M24] | Leader: AV | Partners involved: ALL

In T3.4 EVOLVE2CARE targets innovators from TRL 4-7 who will benefit greatly from the use of the LLs to validate their product or service. In addition to performing a holistic assessment of the commercialization potential of all the innovations which are submitted to the project, EVOLVE2CARE will extend the value of the LL experimentation process that some innovators receive by providing further services to shorten their time to market. First, AV will evaluate each of the innovators' selected by the Open Call, using the Innovation Radar and KTH tools to measure the innovation and commercialization levels of the innovations they wish to test in the LLs, along with the regulatory challenges they perceive to be significant. This will generate an overview of the type and status of HealthTech researchers that we have reached and who desire to access LLs, as well as an understanding of the possible barriers they face offering insight for T1.1. A feedback report will be sent to innovators explaining the results of the evaluation. An interview will be conducted with each innovator before the experimentation period, starts, and each innovator will propose a set of goals to reach during the experimentation period at the LL, focused on the following 3 areas: a) product validation, b) market validation, c) compliance with the regulatory landscape. These pre-defined goals will be used to assess the overall value of the project to their commercialization progress. A final interview will be conducted with each innovator at the end of their residency to check the goal achievements, and a cumulative report will be generated with findings. T3.4 outcomes will be reported by AV in D3.5 on M24.

Work package WP4 – EVOLVE2CARE's People-Centric Experimentation Ecosystem Outreach, Sustainability and Clustering

Work Package Number	WP4	Lead Beneficiary	5 - VILABS
Work Package Name	EVOLVE2CARE's People-Centric Experimentation Ecosystem Outreach, Sustainability and Clustering		
Start Month	1	End Month	24

Objectives

The objectives of WP4, led by VILABS will be to:

- Raise awareness and maximise the visibility of EVOLVE2CARE achievements among the key target groups;
- Design and develop communication, dissemination and exploitation strategy, activities and materials;
- Disseminate the open call and the various results, reports, and findings generated by the project
- Publicise the trainings, webinars, and other online public activities
- Plan and verify the potential of all exploitable outcomes during and after project's end;
- Build and engage a community of stakeholders around EVOLVE2CARE
- Establish synergies with relevant clusters, projects and initiatives;
- Co-design exploitation plans and sustainable business models for the project results and a market and business plan for the project's main tangible outcome.

Description

T4.1. EVOLVE2CARE Dissemination, Communication and Outreach for the Open Calls [M1-M24]

Leader: VILABS | Partners involved: ALL

With the aim to raise awareness and maximise the visibility of the project and its outcomes, a detailed plan will be developed on M3 and updated throughout the project to coordinate the overall relevant activities. An initial structure of the plan and its content (including strategy, goals, objectives, activities, targets, guidelines, material, etc.) is foreseen as described in Section 2.2. Several well-tailored measures are: (i) development of the EVOLVE2CARE identity (e.g., logo, graphic design package) and materials (e.g., templates, leaflets, brochures etc.) (M2), (ii) development of the web portal (M2), (iii) establishment of active social media presence (M2), (iv) promotional videos (M3 and every 3 months), (v) monthly newsletters, ad-hoc press releases and publications in scientific journals and the “Open Research Europe” Platform, following and promoting Open Science, and (vi) participation in external national and EU level conferences and (online and physical) events that are of high interest and relevance. Available European Commission Tools, such as ‘Horizon Magazine’, “Open Research Europe”, the “Horizon Results Booster” and “Horizon Results Platform”, will accompany the activities of this task and support the effective dissemination of the EVOLVE2CARE. T4.1 will also support the outreach of the EVOLVE2CARE open calls, trainings, knowledge sharing sessions, and final event. For that reason, early in the project EVOLVE2CARE consortium will set up and sustain an active community of stakeholders that will support the project’s activities and will potentially get involved in the open calls. The proper engagement of stakeholders to the open calls will be secured as: (a) it will be based on the existing, wide networks, projects and clusters, that the consortium partners are involved; and (b) tailored messages will be formulated for each stakeholder category. T4.1 outcomes will be reported by VILABS in D4.1 due by M3 and updated by M24.

T4.2. Exploitation and IPR of AccelUP [M1-M24] Task leader: VILABS | Partners involved: ALL

T4.2 aims to ensure the exploitation, sustainability, and impact of EVOLVE2CARE results and stimulate their adoption and effective uptake across Europe and beyond. The first action is the development of an exploitation strategy and a plan to further utilise the projects’ tangible and intangible Key Exploitable Results (AccelUP) and the use of knowledge produced, along with relevant IPR provisions. AccelUP exploitation plan and sustainable business models (T3.3) will be co-designed, along with Business, Finance and Market Access plans. All partners will contribute to this task and the EVOLVE2CARE stakeholders’ community will validate the applicability and relevance of the overall work (through webinars and interviews). This task will also implement innovation management activities, towards ensuring that an effective innovation cycle is in place to support the development of an innovative services/product. The work done under Task 4.2 will be reported in D4.2 due by M24.

T4.3. Clustering with EIT KICs [M12-M24] | Leader: ENOLL | Partners involved: ALL

Since the transitional care sector is interdisciplinary, EVOLVE2CARE will engage with EIT KICs, including Health, Mobility, and Digital, all of which have direct bearing on our 3 Use Cases a) hospital discharge management, b) home care monitoring, and c) aging population and care transitions) EIT KICs are ideal sources to understand the impact of regulation on the commercialization and innovation process, as they include a wide range of involved beneficiaries. In addition, many of their stakeholders could benefit from the EVOLVE2CARE framework and activities. We will seek to develop a strategic relationship with the various levels of management, within individual programs (such as RIS) and across services, in order to a) familiarize them and their beneficiaries with the full spectrum of LL capabilities, b) encourage their involvement with the AccelUp platform, c) leverage their knowledge regarding the regulatory continuum in each sector. ENOLL will engage in detailed stakeholder research within the EIT KICs and the individual projects – soliciting input from startups, researchers, administrators, and other involved parties such as mentors and service providers - regarding the regulatory landscape and how it impacts our selected use cases of transitional care innovation in each sector. For example, a digital solution for the monitoring and management of asthma is potentially affected by regulatory developments in areas such as Health, Climate, Data Protection, and Smart Cities. EIT KICs are ideal sources to provide the perspectives necessary for a complete understanding of the regulatory picture. T4.3 will include an analytical report, produced by ENOLL and drawing on all the research and feedback that is carried out in the project, identifying and comparing regulatory issues in each sector as they relate to transitional care innovation. This report will be disseminated to all stakeholder groups, including KICs and associated projects, at a final event, organized by ENOLL, with the aim of assisting policymakers at a pan-European level. T4.3 outcomes will be reported by ENOLL in D4.3 due by M24.

Work package WP5 – Project Coordination and Management

Work Package Number	WP5	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Work Package Name	Project Coordination and Management		

Start Month	1	End Month	24
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Objectives

The main goal of WP5 led by AUTH is to ensure a successful execution of the project. Specific objectives are to:

- Coordinate and manage the overall project implementation.
- Comply with the legal, contractual, financial, and reporting requirements of Horizon Europe and EC.
- Ensure the delivery of the project on time and within the budget, fostering the flow of information between participants and WPs and provide the communication with the EC
- Elaborate the technical, IPR, and innovation management
- Comply with technical, IPR the data management plan.

Description

T5.1. Project Coordination and financial management [M1-M24] | Leader: AUTH | Partners involved: ALL.

AUTH will assure that the orientation of the consortium activities matches the vision of EVOLVE2CARE. Partners will receive a project management handbook (PMH) that includes guidelines and templates for financial reporting, standards for deliverables and reports to the EC, steps to ensure timely reporting, a plan and calendar for payment procedures, etc., to effectively support project management. Internal communication procedures will also be established. Every 6 months (M7, M13), an interim summary report will be elaborated to keep on track the project activities & progress, WP, tasks and milestones status, project expenditures, update on project KPIs and lessons learned of respective period (with respective proposals for improvement). Deviations and corrective actions will also be reported. A specialized financial reporting tool called "Kronis" will be provided to all partners, by Sploro, for transparent and efficient financial management. Kronis will allow for real-time budget tracking, expenditure categorization, and automated report generation, ensuring that the project remains financially accountable and compliant with EU regulations. Every 6 months, an interim summary report will be elaborated to keep on track the project activities & progress, WP, tasks and milestones status, project expenditures, update on project KPIs and lessons learned of respective period (with respective proposals for improvement). Deviations and corrective actions will also be reported. Interim Reports will be delivered by AUTH in D5.2. AUTH will deliver the PMH in D5.1 due by M4 (initial version) and M24 (final version).

T5.2. Technical, and Innovation Management [M1-M24] | Leader: AV | Partners involved: ALL

T5.2 will perform technical and experimentation coordination to ensure that any technological advancements in the experimentation of products in the transitional care sector within EVOLVE2CARE, are aligned with evolving market needs. An external Advisory Board will be also established early during the project (M6) – initial high profile members are already onboarded (see 3.2.1.2), to facilitate an interdisciplinary support and advising channel regarding a) the utilization of various experimentation spaces i.e., Living Labs through the AccelUP platform, b) the acceleration of research iterations based on real-life documentation, and c) the systematic diffusion of results to the relevant policy makers and regulatory bodies. The Advisory Board will include members from the research community, the LLs, regulatory bodies, and corporates. AV will continuously monitor the experiments taking place under the various Use Cases, and will also standardize agreements regarding intellectual property rights (feeding T4.2), ensuring that innovators and researchers retain ownership of their innovations and with an eye on maintaining project high innovation potential of research results and greater impact. This task will be also responsible for creating the Ethics Advisory Board with at least 50% external experts. AUTH will also identify and contract an external Ethics Expert that will perform the final ethics check for the shortlisted projects. AV will report T5.2 outcomes in D5.3 due in M24.

T5.3. Quality, Risk, and Data Management Plan [M1-M24] Leader: Sploro | Partners involved: ALL

Led by Sploro in collaboration with all project partners, this task aims to establish a robust framework for quality assurance, risk management and a data management framework. To maintain the highest quality standards, the project will develop and implement operating procedures and quality guidelines that will be disseminated to all partners. Regular audits and quality checks will be conducted to ensure compliance with these standards and to identify areas for improvement. Deliverables and completion of milestones will be monitored. A comprehensive risk assessment will be carried out at the outset and at various stages throughout the project. This will involve identifying potential risks related to project execution, financial management, and compliance, among others. Contingency plans will be developed for each identified risk, and a risk register will be maintained and regularly updated. T5.3 will analyze the main elements of the data management policy to be used throughout the EVOLVE2CARE project by the project partners, regarding all datasets generated by the project. A Data Management Plan (DMP) will be elaborated considering the “Guidelines on FAIR Data Management in H2020”, and will be a live document. By integrating these elements into a cohesive Quality, Risk and Data Management strategy, the project aims to ensure a structured, accountable, and transparent framework

that aligns with EU standards and contributes to the project's overall success. T5.3 outcomes will be delivered by Sploro in D5.1 on a first version by M4 and updates will be reported in the final version in M24.

Work package WP6 – Ethics requirements

Work Package Number	WP6	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Work Package Name	Ethics requirements		
Start Month	1	End Month	24

Objectives
The objective is to ensure compliance with the 'ethics requirements' set out in this work package.

Description
This work package sets out the 'ethics requirements' that the project must comply with.

STAFF EFFORT

Staff effort per participant							
Grant Preparation (Work packages - Effort screen) — Enter the info.							
Participant	WP1	WP2	WP3	WP4	WP5	WP6	Total Person-Months
1 - AUTH	11.00	27.00	17.50	7.00	11.00		73.50
2 - ENoLL IVZW	1.00	4.00	6.00	4.00	2.00		17.00
3 - AV	9.50	14.50	27.50	17.80	3.00		72.30
4 - SPLOORO	2.00	19.00	2.00	2.00	2.00		27.00
5 - VILABS	1.00	2.00	1.50	60.00	7.60		72.10
Total Person-Months	24.50	66.50	54.50	90.80	25.60	0.00	261.90

LIST OF DELIVERABLES

Deliverables <i>Grant Preparation (Deliverables screen) — Enter the info.</i> <i>The labels used mean:</i> <i>Public — fully open (🚩 automatically posted online)</i> <i>Sensitive — limited under the conditions of the Grant Agreement</i> <i>EU classified —RESTREINT-UE/EU-RESTRICTED, CONFIDENTIEL-UE/EU-CONFIDENTIAL, SECRET-UE/EU-SECRET under Decision 2015/444</i>						
Deliverable No	Deliverable Name	Work Package No	Lead Beneficiary	Type	Dissemination Level	Due Date (month)
D1.1	Roadmap on navigating the complexities of enabling innovative technologies in transitional care	WP1	4 - SPLORO	R — Document, report	PU - Public	4
D1.2	Stakeholder Needs Analysis and KPI framework	WP1	1 - AUTH	R — Document, report	PU - Public	6
D1.3	EVOVLE2CARE Action Plan	WP1	1 - AUTH	R — Document, report	PU - Public	9
D1.4	Roadmap on navigating the complexities of enabling innovative technologies in transitional care - Final	WP1	4 - SPLORO	R — Document, report	PU - Public	24
D1.5	Stakeholder Needs Analysis and KPI framework - Final	WP1	1 - AUTH	R — Document, report	PU - Public	19
D1.6	EVOVLE2CARE Action Plan - Final	WP1	1 - AUTH	R — Document, report	PU - Public	19
D2.1	AccelUP Experimentation Space infrastructure	WP2	1 - AUTH	OTHER	PU - Public	12
D2.2	LLs, Innovators and Researchers Scouting and selection Report	WP2	4 - SPLORO	R — Document, report	PU - Public	12
D2.3	Training Program for Living Labs	WP2	2 - ENoLL IVZW	OTHER	PU - Public	14

Deliverables <i>Grant Preparation (Deliverables screen) — Enter the info.</i> <i>The labels used mean:</i> <i>Public — fully open (🚩 automatically posted online)</i> <i>Sensitive — limited under the conditions of the Grant Agreement</i> <i>EU classified — RESTREINT-UE/EU-RESTRICTED, CONFIDENTIEL-UE/EU-CONFIDENTIAL, SECRET-UE/EU-SECRET under Decision 2015/444</i>						
Deliverable No	Deliverable Name	Work Package No	Lead Beneficiary	Type	Dissemination Level	Due Date (month)
D2.4	Training Program for Innovators/ Researchers	WP2	3 - AV	OTHER	PU - Public	14
D2.5	AccelUP Experimentation Space infrastructure - Final	WP2	1 - AUTH	OTHER	PU - Public	24
D3.1	Monitoring and Evaluation of the experimentation services	WP3	1 - AUTH	R — Document, report	PU - Public	24
D3.2	Lessons Learnt and Policy Recommendations Report	WP3	2 - ENoLL IVZW	R — Document, report	PU - Public	24
D3.3	Standardization, Scalability, Replicability and Business Model	WP3	3 - AV	R — Document, report	PU - Public	24
D3.4	Commercialization Potential of Innovations	WP3	3 - AV	R — Document, report	PU - Public	24
D4.1	Dissemination, Communication and Outreach Strategy and Materials	WP4	5 - VILABS	DEC — Websites, patent filings, videos, etc	PU - Public	3
D4.2	Exploitation and IPR Management	WP4	5 - VILABS	R — Document, report	PU - Public	24
D4.3	Clustering with EIT KICs projects and relevant initiatives	WP4	2 - ENoLL IVZW	R — Document, report	PU - Public	24
D4.4	Dissemination, Communication and Outreach Strategy and Materials - Final	WP4	5 - VILABS	R — Document, report	PU - Public	24
D5.1	Project Management Handbook	WP5	1 - AUTH	DMP — Data Management Plan	PU - Public	4

Deliverables

Grant Preparation (Deliverables screen) — Enter the info.

The labels used mean:

Public — fully open (🚩 automatically posted online)

Sensitive — limited under the conditions of the Grant Agreement

EU classified — RESTREINT-UE/EU-RESTRICTED, CONFIDENTIEL-UE/EU-CONFIDENTIAL, SECRET-UE/EU-SECRET under Decision [2015/444](#)

Deliverable No	Deliverable Name	Work Package No	Lead Beneficiary	Type	Dissemination Level	Due Date (month)
D5.2	Interim Reports	WP5	1 - AUTH	R — Document, report	PU - Public	7
D5.3	Technical, IPR and Innovation Management	WP5	3 - AV	R — Document, report	PU - Public	4
D5.4	Project Management Handbook - Final	WP5	1 - AUTH	R — Document, report	PU - Public	24
D5.5	Interim Reports - Final	WP5	1 - AUTH	R — Document, report	PU - Public	13
D5.6	Technical, IPR and Innovation Management - Final	WP5	3 - AV	R — Document, report	PU - Public	24
D6.1	OEI - Requirement No. 1	WP6	1 - AUTH	ETHICS	SEN - Sensitive	16

Deliverable D1.1 – Roadmap on navigating the complexities of enabling innovative technologies in transitional care

Deliverable Number	D1.1	Lead Beneficiary	4 - SPLORO
Deliverable Name	Roadmap on navigating the complexities of enabling innovative technologies in transitional care		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	4	Work Package No	WP1

Description
Includes the results from survey questionnaires and interviews on enablers and barriers of innovations in transitional care (M4). The roadmap will be updated based on UCs execution findings by M24 in D1.4.

Deliverable D1.2 – Stakeholder Needs Analysis and KPI framework

Deliverable Number	D1.2	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Deliverable Name	Stakeholder Needs Analysis and KPI framework		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	6	Work Package No	WP1

Description
Includes the stakeholder needs analysis and the definition of KPIs for assessing experimentation practices

Deliverable D1.3 – EVOVLE2CARE Action Plan

Deliverable Number	D1.3	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Deliverable Name	EVOVLE2CARE Action Plan		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	9	Work Package No	WP1

Description
Includes the definition of UCs for the experimentations, the technical specifications of AccelUP, and plan of implementation including delivery of best practices and other value-add content.

Deliverable D1.4 – Roadmap on navigating the complexities of enabling innovative technologies in transitional care - Final

Deliverable Number	D1.4	Lead Beneficiary	4 - SPLORO
Deliverable Name	Roadmap on navigating the complexities of enabling innovative technologies in transitional care - Final		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	24	Work Package No	WP1

Description			
Includes the results from survey questionnaires and interviews on enablers and barriers of innovations in transitional care (M4). The roadmap will be updated based on UCs execution findings by M24. Updated version of D1.1.			

Deliverable D1.5 – Stakeholder Needs Analysis and KPI framework - Final

Deliverable Number	D1.5	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Deliverable Name	Stakeholder Needs Analysis and KPI framework - Final		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	19	Work Package No	WP1

Description			
Includes the stakeholder needs analysis and the definition of KPIs for assessing experimentation practices. Updated version of D1.2.			

Deliverable D1.6 – EVOVLE2CARE Action Plan - Final

Deliverable Number	D1.6	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Deliverable Name	EVOVLE2CARE Action Plan - Final		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	19	Work Package No	WP1

Description			
Includes the definition of UCs for the experimentations, the technical specifications of AccelUP, and plan of implementation including delivery of best practices and other value-add content. Updated version of D1.3.			

Deliverable D2.1 – AccelUP Experimentation Space infrastructure

Deliverable Number	D2.1	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Deliverable Name	AccelUP Experimentation Space infrastructure		
Type	OTHER	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	12	Work Package No	WP2

Description			
Includes all the technical advancements of the digital modules of AccelUP.			

Deliverable D2.2 – LLs, Innovators and Researchers Scouting and selection Report

Deliverable Number	D2.2	Lead Beneficiary	4 - SPLORO
Deliverable Name	LLs, Innovators and Researchers Scouting and selection Report		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	12	Work Package No	WP2

Description	
Report providing information about the scouting, selection, and matchmaking process of LLs, Innovators/Researchers.	

Deliverable D2.3 – Training Program for Living Labs

Deliverable Number	D2.3	Lead Beneficiary	2 - ENoLL IVZW
Deliverable Name	Training Program for Living Labs		
Type	OTHER	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	14	Work Package No	WP2

Description	
Includes the training material in M8, the call expression of interest in M10, and the recorded videos of the virtual training to LLs in M14.	

Deliverable D2.4 – Training Program for Innovators/Researchers

Deliverable Number	D2.4	Lead Beneficiary	3 - AV
Deliverable Name	Training Program for Innovators/Researchers		
Type	OTHER	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	14	Work Package No	WP2

Description	
Includes the training material in M8, the call for expression of interest in M10, and the recorded videos of the virtual training to researchers in M14	

Deliverable D2.5 – AccelUP Experimentation Space infrastructure - Final

Deliverable Number	D2.5	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Deliverable Name	AccelUP Experimentation Space infrastructure - Final		
Type	OTHER	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	24	Work Package No	WP2

Description	
Includes all the technical advancements of the digital modules of AccelUP. Updated version of D2.1.	

Deliverable D3.1 – Monitoring and Evaluation of the experimentation services

Deliverable Number	D3.1	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Deliverable Name	Monitoring and Evaluation of the experimentation services		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	24	Work Package No	WP3

Description
Report on the execution of the use cases and the evaluation of the matching process. It also includes the standardization of reporting tools to inform various stakeholders on the experimentation results

Deliverable D3.2 – Lessons Learnt and Policy Recommendations Report

Deliverable Number	D3.2	Lead Beneficiary	2 - ENoLL IVZW
Deliverable Name	Lessons Learnt and Policy Recommendations Report		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	24	Work Package No	WP3

Description
Report on the recommendations for policy makers based on key lessons learnt and the exchange of best practices.

Deliverable D3.3 – Standardization, Scalability, Replicability and Business Model

Deliverable Number	D3.3	Lead Beneficiary	3 - AV
Deliverable Name	Standardization, Scalability, Replicability and Business Model		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	24	Work Package No	WP3

Description
Report on the standardization measures that support the replicability of AccelUP, enabling LLs in other sectors join the platform, and an analytic Business Model facilitating AccelUP scalability

Deliverable D3.4 – Commercialization Potential of Innovations

Deliverable Number	D3.4	Lead Beneficiary	3 - AV
Deliverable Name	Commercialization Potential of Innovations		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	24	Work Package No	WP3

Description
Report on the findings from the examination of the commercialization potential of all the innovations submitted under the open call for innovators, and the evaluation of the services provided to enhance the commercialization process for those who are selected.

Deliverable D4.1 – Dissemination, Communication and Outreach Strategy and Materials

Deliverable Number	D4.1	Lead Beneficiary	5 - VILABS
Deliverable Name	Dissemination, Communication and Outreach Strategy and Materials		

Type	DEC — Websites, patent filings, videos, etc	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	3	Work Package No	WP4

Description
Report that includes all measures and activities for disseminating and communicating the project and reaching out to target audiences.

Deliverable D4.2 – Exploitation and IPR Management

Deliverable Number	D4.2	Lead Beneficiary	5 - VILABS
Deliverable Name	Exploitation and IPR Management		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	24	Work Package No	WP4

Description
Report that includes exploitation measures and activities for EVOLVE2CARE.

Deliverable D4.3 – Clustering with EIT KICs projects and relevant initiatives

Deliverable Number	D4.3	Lead Beneficiary	2 - ENoLL IVZW
Deliverable Name	Clustering with EIT KICs projects and relevant initiatives		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	24	Work Package No	WP4

Description
Report on the strategic relationships established between EVOLVE2CARE and AccelUP with EIT KIC and other EU initiatives

Deliverable D4.4 – Dissemination, Communication and Outreach Strategy and Materials - Final

Deliverable Number	D4.4	Lead Beneficiary	5 - VILABS
Deliverable Name	Dissemination, Communication and Outreach Strategy and Materials - Final		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	24	Work Package No	WP4

Description
Report that includes all measures and activities for disseminating and communicating the project and reaching out to target audiences. Updated version of D4.1.

Deliverable D5.1 – Project Management Handbook

Deliverable Number	D5.1	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Deliverable Name	Project Management Handbook		
Type	DMP — Data Management Plan	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	4	Work Package No	WP5

Description
Project management handbook based on the Horizon Europe regulations to be used internally by the consortium determining organisational aspects and reporting. The Handbook will include quality assessment, risk mitigation and data management plan.

Deliverable D5.2 – Interim Reports

Deliverable Number	D5.2	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Deliverable Name	Interim Reports		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	7	Work Package No	WP5

Description
6 month-update on project activities & progress.

Deliverable D5.3 – Technical, IPR and Innovation Management

Deliverable Number	D5.3	Lead Beneficiary	3 - AV
Deliverable Name	Technical, IPR and Innovation Management		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	4	Work Package No	WP5

Description
Report on innovation management issues, Advisory Board activities, and standardization agreements of IPs derived from the experiments through AccelUP

Deliverable D5.4 – Project Management Handbook - Final

Deliverable Number	D5.4	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Deliverable Name	Project Management Handbook - Final		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	24	Work Package No	WP5

Description
Project management handbook based on the Horizon Europe regulations to be used internally by the consortium

determining organisational aspects and reporting. The Handbook will include quality assessment, risk mitigation and data management plan. Updated version of D5.1.

Deliverable D5.5 – Interim Reports - Final

Deliverable Number	D5.5	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Deliverable Name	Interim Reports - Final		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	13	Work Package No	WP5

Description

6 month-update on project activities & progress. Updated version of D5.2.

Deliverable D5.6 – Technical, IPR and Innovation Management - Final

Deliverable Number	D5.6	Lead Beneficiary	3 - AV
Deliverable Name	Technical, IPR and Innovation Management - Final		
Type	R — Document, report	Dissemination Level	PU - Public
Due Date (month)	24	Work Package No	WP5

Description

Report on innovation management issues, Advisory Board activities, and standardization agreements of IPs derived from the experiments through AccelUP. Updated version of D5.3.

Deliverable D6.1 – OEI - Requirement No. 1

Deliverable Number	D6.1	Lead Beneficiary	1 - AUTH
Deliverable Name	OEI - Requirement No. 1		
Type	ETHICS	Dissemination Level	SEN - Sensitive
Due Date (month)	16	Work Package No	WP6

Description

Report on implementing ethics requirements

LIST OF MILESTONES

Milestones					
Grant Preparation (Milestones screen) — Enter the info.					
Milestone No	Milestone Name	Work Package No	Lead Beneficiary	Means of Verification	Due Date (month)
1	Holistic ACCELUP architectural blueprints, functional specifications, and integration roadmap available (first version)	WP1	1 - AUTH	D1.3(v1)	9
2	AccelUP platform up and running to onboard Living Labs	WP2	1 - AUTH	D2.1(v1)	12
3	Innovators and LLs onboarded on the AccelUP	WP2	4 - SPLORO	D2.2	12

LIST OF CRITICAL RISKS

Critical risks & risk management strategy			
Grant Preparation (Critical Risks screen) — Enter the info.			
Risk number	Description	Work Package No(s)	Proposed Mitigation Measures
1	Low participation in the open calls	WP2	Participation in open calls will be checked by the platform organizer. If ideas are not well received, countries, regions, or domains can be targeted surgically with actions.
2	The subcontracting funds for LLs to provide services to the innovators are not spent	WP3	The remaining money from the subcontracted experimentation services will be used if lower participation prevents them from being fully utilized. It is possible to define alternative activities that produce value and make investments in them
3	High number of support requests from participants	WP2	We'll employ a prioritization system. Additionally, the Q&A method will enable the grouping of similar queries and the reduction of responses.

Critical risks & risk management strategy <i>Grant Preparation (Critical Risks screen) — Enter the info.</i>			
Risk number	Description	Work Package No(s)	Proposed Mitigation Measures
4	Difficulties to find evaluators	WP2	The partners have access to a solid network of professionals from prior projects. A few already participate in the external advisory board; others will be welcomed.
5	Solutions need to be scalable and replicable	WP2	To evaluate and guarantee the potential for scalability and replication of the EVOLVE2CARE we will use specialized tools and procedures. Support, such as workshops and webinars, will be used to educate participants about the advantages of the EVOVLE2CARE platform (AccelUP) capabilities.
6	Experimentation Deployment risks due to low data availability or low stakeholder engagement	WP2	The availability of data has already been examined, and it is anticipated to be partially resolved at the LL selection level (Phase2). Early in the project's lifecycle, EVOVLE2CARE will work with the potential stakeholders and end users to identify their needs and ways to approach and engage them.
7	Incomplete & improper project development due to the size and complexity of use-case tests	WP1	All of the members of EVOVLE2CARE have extensive backgrounds in both large-scale research initiatives and the development and functional synchronization of extremely complex systems. Early on in the project, the Action Plan will be made accessible, concretizing the use cases and architectural design of AccelUP in a logical and practically viable way (WP1).
8	Experimentations do not reach the desired impact metrics.	WP3	AUTH and AV will regularly revise the achievement of the innovators to avoid deviations. Major issues will be communicated to the coordination team to propose alternative actions to effectively achieve what they commit.
9	Feedback is not used to improve the services	WP3, WP4	Feedback channels will be watched to make sure no action is left behind. We'll offer and carry out a framework for consortium and target audiences awareness.
10	Services are not utilised by the innovators in order to conduct experiments in Living Labs	WP3, WP4	The list of services offered by LLs is not all-inclusive. The consortium has promised to be flexible and to add or remove services in response to the requests or needs of the innovators by engaging more LLs that provide complementary services.
11	Low engagement with the innovators	WP4, WP2	Partners have a network of potential innovators at their disposal, and customized tools and messages will be developed for each target stakeholder and region.
12	Low engagement of stakeholders	WP3, WP4, WP1	Partners already have a network of prospective stakeholders, and each target stakeholder, such as investors or corporations, will have unique tools and messages.

Annex 1 to the Grant Agreement (Description of the Action) - Part B

History of changes

Annex I Version date: 2024-03-04		
Part A		
Section	Original	Change
Table 3.1.c	D4.2 Exploitation and IPR Management	Syntax error corrected
Task 5.2		Added information about the creation of an Ethics Advisory Board and contracting an External Ethics Expert
Task 2.2		Added the following “The shortlisted projects will be also reviewed for ethics issues by the External Ethics expert that will be contracted by the consortium (T5.2).”
Table 3.1.c	Some deliverables had two submission dates	New deliverables were added with the indication of “final” in the deliverable name to match the final submission date
Part B		
Section	Original	Change
3.1.2 Detailed Description of Work		Table 3.1h: ‘Purchase costs’ items (travel and subsistence, equipment and other goods, works and services)
3.1.2 Detailed Description of Work		Table 3.1i: ‘Other costs categories’ items (e.g. internally invoiced goods and services) was added
3.1.2 Detailed Description of Work		Table 3.1j: ‘In-kind contributions’ provided by third parties was added
4 Ethics Self-assessment		4 Ethics Self-assessment section was added with information included in the proposal Part A
3.2.1.3 Ethics Advisory Board	The Ethics Advisory Board was not included	Added information for the creation of an Ethics Advisory Board based on the Evaluation Summary Comments
1.2.1 Phase 2 (p.9)		Added information about the work performed by the external ethics expert

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Engaging the Value Of Living Labs to Innovate Care And Regulatory Environments

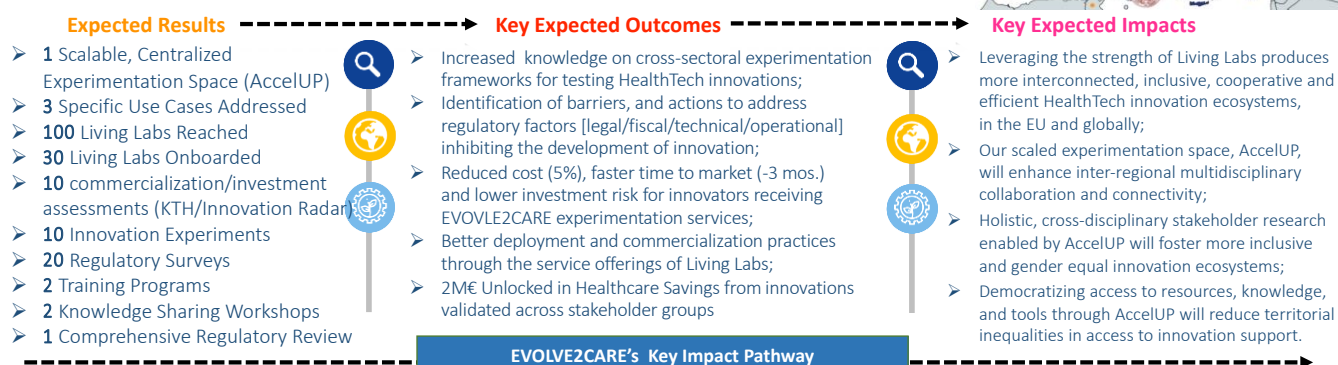
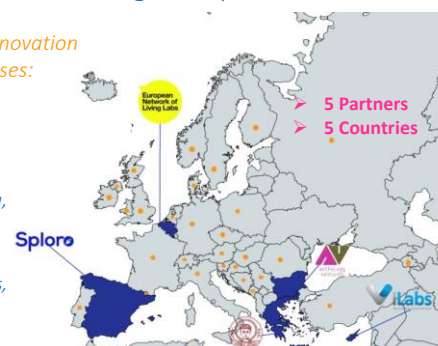
Evolve2Care

EVOLVE2CARE will reveal inhibitors to HealthTech innovation in the Transitional Care sector, focusing on 3 Use Cases:

Hospital Discharge Management: Secure Health Information Systems, medication & treatment plans, information transfer between facilities, and more.

Home Care Monitoring Solutions: Remote monitoring, IoT wearables, mobile health apps, telehealth, etc.

Aging Population & Care Transitions: Technology and devices such as voice assistants, engagement platforms, and tools to address mobility, cognitive decline, and family caregiver issues.



1 EXCELLENCE

In the rapidly evolving landscape of healthcare, the need for innovative and effective solutions has never been more pressing. As the sector grapples with challenges ranging from an aging population to the increasing complexity of medical conditions, there is a growing recognition of the importance of experimentation practices. These practices, rooted in evidence-based methodologies, offer a pathway to not only understand but also address the multifaceted issues facing healthcare today. Central to this paradigm shift is the concept of 'living labs' - real-world environments where users and stakeholders are actively involved and eventually lead innovations. Living labs (LLs), with their emphasis on user-centric design and iterative testing, have emerged as a key resource for the development and validation of innovative products, services, and solutions, particularly in the realm of HealthTech. Encompassing a range of technological innovations from wearable devices to telemedicine platforms, HealthTech has revolutionized the way care is delivered and received across the healthcare spectrum, becoming an enabler and a lever to assist the full range of care-provision. This is particularly true in transitional care, which focuses on maintaining continuity as patients move between different stages and settings of care and relies upon a vast array of data and information gathered and exchanged between devices, systems, and word-of-mouth. Experimentation in transitional care is indispensable for developing specific technologies or innovative solutions that address the intricate and multifaceted nature of healthcare transitions. By subjecting these technologies to real-world scenarios, experimentation uncovers

complexities, ethical considerations, interoperability challenges, and unforeseen barriers that controlled environments may not reveal. This process enables iterative refinement, customization, and validation of solutions to match diverse patient needs, ensure regulatory compliance, and address stakeholder concerns.

EVOLVE2CARE delves into the intricacies of experimentation practices frameworks, with a keen focus on standardizing and enhancing the symbiotic relationship between living labs and HealthTech in the context of transitional care. Through EVOLVE2CARE, we aim to create an ecosystem and a framework meticulously designed to facilitate, nurture, and amplify opportunities for experimentation, leading not only to valuable insights but also the flourishing of novel ideas and advancements for innovators, researchers, regulators, and other pertinent stakeholders. By developing a framework that provides a common approach for practices, EVOLVE2CARE will provide Living Labs with a market-centric paradigm and tool that can expand the scope and value of their reach as experimentation spaces, breaking down the silos which can occur amongst small local or regional networks. Charting a course for a more responsive, resilient, and patient-centric healthcare future, depends on continuous innovation and delivery of innovation to the market. Experimentation in the context of transitional care serves as a critical bridge between conceptual ideas and practical implementation, by facing key challenges in the domain:

Challenge #1 (Technology): Transitional care technologies often need to integrate with existing healthcare systems and electronic health records. Achieving interoperability can be technically challenging, requiring seamless data exchange while adhering to standardized formats.

When assessments vary across different healthcare settings, such as hospitals, rehabilitation centres, and home care, there is a risk of information gaps and miscommunication hindering the patient's transition and rehabilitation progress. Living labs offer a dynamic and controlled environment for testing, refining, and optimizing HealthTech solutions' integration with existing healthcare systems and electronic health records (EHRs). Through these collaborative partnerships, Living Labs facilitate the dialogue within the stakeholder chain, allowing innovators to uncover technological and/or systemic roadblocks to interoperability, and build more technically robust and harmonized solutions.

Challenge #2 (Corporate): Experimentation in complex ecosystems, such as transitional care that involves a complex network of stakeholders, requires substantial resources, especially when there are inconsistent assessment practices.

In Living Lab environments standardized assessment tools and protocols can be tested with a diverse range of stakeholders, helping HealthTech providers benchmark their performance against industry and regulatory standards. This collaborative approach among healthcare providers, policymakers, researchers, and technology developers ensure that assessment practices align with the goals of transitional care and are consistent across the ecosystem.

Challenge #3 (Societal): Engaging patients in experimentation can be challenging due to factors such as variations in techno-literacy and access to technology, ethical concerns, and fear of change. Furthermore, healthcare practices and patient behaviors can vary based on cultural, socio-economic, and regional factors. Designing technologies that align with these nuances is crucial for successful experimentation and adoption.

Living Labs can offer a real-life experimentation environment where both patients and caregivers can be actively engaged in the care process in a trustful environment, ensuring they understand the assessment data, treatment options and care plans, and that any health devices are accessible and easy to use. This requires empowering populations to self-manage their rehabilitation journey through health innovations, improve well-being and attenuate health resource burden.

Challenge #4 (Regulatory): HealthTech innovations are subject to a complex web of regulations, which can vary from country to country. Depending on the risk level and intended use, health devices may fall under different regulatory categories, each with its own set of requirements. Navigating these regulations, which can vary across jurisdictions, poses a significant challenge to innovators and researchers aiming to conduct experiments and trials.

Standardization can provide a common framework for compliance and help streamline the regulatory process. Early discussions based on real-life experimental results with regulatory agencies can help align HealthTech development with regulatory expectations and reduce potential roadblocks. Multidisciplinary teams brought together in a Living Lab environment can include professionals from engineering, regulatory affairs, quality assurance, legal, and clinical areas to ensure a holistic approach to compliance. Strong data privacy and security measures, including encryption, secure data storage, user authentication, and compliance with data protection regulations like GDPR can be promoted.

EVOLVE2CARE Solution

EVOLVE2CARE leverages a diverse marketplace of multiple experimentation spaces around Europe, known as Living Labs, and their associated infrastructures and networks. The primary objective is to address delays in development, sales, and adoption of solutions which stem from the rapid rate of innovation in HealthTech. Such delays can be caused by market forces, or by slower responses from regulatory frameworks. This asynchronicity can lead to uncertainty for manufacturers and delays in getting products to market. By uniting and actively engaging end-

users, decision makers, regulators, innovators, and other relevant stakeholders along the entire continuum of care, early in the experimentation process, EVOLVE2CARE aims to practically assess the real-time implications of regulatory and other challenges that arise during the testing of innovative HealthTech solutions. Focusing on transitional care, EVOLVE2CARE will test innovative products for 3 pre-identified Use Cases (UCs) i.e., a) management of hospital discharge, b) home care monitoring, c) aging population and care transitions, within the Living Lab environments. We will provide innovators with access to certified Living Labs (based on recently published certification criteria¹), each chosen for their resources that match needs relating to prototype development for the use cases. Pairing innovators with Living Labs enhances the relevance, feasibility, and impact of research outcomes. Simultaneously, we will actively engage stakeholders to generate further insights that can remove barriers to innovation, ultimately accelerating the development of improved transitional care solutions based on authentic evidence regarding the effectiveness of new products and services. EVOLVE2CARE will be a strategic project for the Health and Wellbeing working group of the European Network of Living Labs (ENoLL) as new services will be designed and delivered to the large living labs ecosystem.

1.1 OBJECTIVES AND AMBITION

EVOLVE2CARE aims to design a market-centric experimentation framework that effectively utilizes Living Lab infrastructures and networks such as end-users, practitioners, corporate entities (such as hospitals, insurers), policy makers, investors, innovators, regulators, and other stakeholders to identify and ameliorate the constraints on innovation & commercialization posed by issues such as regulatory or market that act as barriers or gatekeepers in the transitional care sector.

What are the Specific Needs (SN) that triggered this project?

EVOLVE2CARE will realize its ambition from different interlinked perspectives (technological, social, economic, financial) reflected in **4 Key Objectives (KOs)**. Each KO is aimed at resolving a **Specific Need (SN)** with a major impact on transitional care, deriving from relevant guidelines and roadmaps, and in line with the Call's scope. The KOs follow the SMART principles i.e., they are: **Specific** – linked to SNs and deliverables; **Measurable** – linked with EVOLVE2CARE expected results and outcomes; **Achievable** – they reflect relevant expertise of partners; **Relevant** – directly linked to the scope of the topic and the work programme and the Strategic Plan², and **Time-Related** – linked with specific WP/Tasks and time bounds.

[SN1]: Development of HealthTech Evaluation and Experimentation Processes in the realm of transitional care

Without harmonized experimentation support services, there may be variations in how HealthTech innovations are evaluated and tested. Limited proof of evidence of a technology's efficacy and safety can impact the quality and reliability of the technologies being introduced to the market, potentially putting patients at risk.

KO#1. Foster user-centric research and support technology upscaling (Linked with Challenge #2, #3)

Relation to the WP: *"Increase knowledge on experimentation frameworks for testing innovations"; "Provide services for testing innovative solutions [...]"; "[...] development of best practices between stakeholders that have been actively engaged in testing and experimentation processes"*

Indicators

Training Programs increasing knowledge on experimentation frameworks: 2
Living Labs participating in trainings: 20
Living Labs engaged in user centric knowledge and experimentation activities: 40
Services for testing innovations: 10
Action Plans: 1

EVOLVE2CARE will capitalize on pan-European Living Labs to promote harmonized LL's experimentation support services (10 LL services will be tested) that make it easier for prototypes or cutting-edge HealthTech innovations to be assessed and improved after obtaining social and market input. EVOLVE2CARE will map LL's standardised services and infrastructure and will design an Action Plan (including best practices for standardization) for the realization of a marketplace of experimentation spaces i.e., Living Labs, that can streamline user-centric approaches, methodologies, and best practices used in their real-life environments for testing disruptive innovations in the HealthTech sector, and with a focus in the transitional care industry. Such approaches could accelerate time to market, lower investment risk and reduce experimentation costs. Two training programs aimed at LLs, and innovators to increase the knowledge and utilization of LL experimentation services will be designed and delivered.

¹ Vervoort, K., Konstantinidis, E., Santonen, T., Petsani, D., Servais, D., de Boer, D., Spagnoli, F., Onur, O., Bertolin, J., Trousse, B., Desole, M., & Bamidis, P. (2022). Harmonizing the evaluation of living labs: a standardized evaluation framework. In ISPI Innovation Conference 2022.

² The Strategic plan 2021-2024: https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/document/cd8a3cf4-2661-439e-b8c5-08e8846e8a1d_en

(1) Promoting an open strategic autonomy by leading the development of key digital, enabling and emerging technologies, sectors and value chains; (2) Restoring Europe's ecosystems and biodiversity and managing sustainably natural resources; (3) Making Europe the first digitally enabled circular, climate-neutral and sustainable economy; (4) Creating a more resilient, inclusive and democratic European society. (4) Link between policy priorities and project results

[SN2]: Regulatory, financial, technological and operations aspects hinder the deployment of HealthTech innovations

HealthTech innovations need to comply with various regulations and standards related to healthcare, data privacy, security, and more. Lack of regulatory clarity creates uncertainty about how HealthTech innovations should be governed and approved, especially when they do not fit neatly into existing regulatory frameworks. Solutions may require substantial financial investment, and reimbursement models may not be well-suited to new HealthTech solutions, making it difficult for companies to generate revenue from their innovations. HealthTech innovations need to interface with existing healthcare systems and technologies, which can be challenging due to the lack of interoperability standards. HealthTech solutions also need to seamlessly fit into the daily routines of healthcare providers and overcome the resistance to adopting new technologies due to established practices and workflows.

KO#2. Enable deployment and commercialization (Linked with Challenge #1, #4)

Relation to the WP: *“Facilitate the **deployment** and potential **commercialisation** of new innovative solutions” [...] disruptive technologies could potentially render regulations obsolete or be perceived as a barrier that hampers the deployment of emerging technologies.”; “Identify **legal, regulatory, fiscal, technical, and operational** pre-requisites or barriers for different use-cases which hamper the development of innovation*

Indicators

innovations tested: 10
countries covered: 20
organizations to inform: 20
stakeholders researched: >50

EVOLVE2CARE will determine the prerequisites or barriers that, in the case of various HealthTech experimentation use-cases, such as **a)** the management of hospital discharge, **b)** home care monitoring, **c)** aging population and care transitions, might prevent the growth of innovation in the transitional care sector in terms of law, regulation, finances, technology, and operations. By researching various stakeholders across EU, it will recognize obstacles to the development and market entry of HealthTech innovations in the transitional care sector and will ease the deployment and potential commercialization of new innovative solutions (at least 10 innovations will be tested) by promoting experimentation environments conducive to innovation (KO#3). To maximize its impact and geographical reach, EVOLVE2CARE will adopt targeted dissemination and communication campaigns and impactful outreach alongside with assisting innovators with their exploitation activities (WP4).

[SN3]: Lack of systemic stakeholder engagement and coordinated regulatory action in the HealthTech industry

Lack of coordination between healthcare providers, patients, community, regulatory authorities, and investors create non-supportive environments for efficient patient-centred plans and reintegration. Poorly executed transitions can potentially result in readmissions, adverse events, patients' dissatisfaction, low quality of life or even death³.

KO#3. Demonstrate pan-European testing by fostering coordination and regulatory action (Linked to Challenge #1, #4)

Relation to the WP: *“Identify areas where the **multi-sectoral** and/or emerging nature of some innovations requires **coordinated action by innovators and regulators**”; “Explore areas where the **European supervisory authority** exists, and pan-European testing might be desirable”; “by **establishing** a regulatory sandbox, **living lab** or, test bed”; “[...]applicants should **closely cooperate with innovators** who have identified fields where the deployment of innovation is hampered.*

Indicators

supervisory authorities reached: 5
countries covered: 20
areas identified: 3 Use Cases
experimentation spaces: 1 centralized (AccelUp) covering multiples experimentation spaces i.e., LLs
Regulators reached: 10

EVOLVE2CARE, capitalising on the results of a previously H2020 funded project, VITALISE, (GA#101007990) will set up a diverse marketplace, AccelUP, including experimentation spaces, such as Living Labs, and other members of the healthcare stakeholder chain such as innovators, regulators, investors, and multipliers, by advancing the AccelUP platform (see §1.2.1). AccelUP will aggregate and promote opportunities for pan-European experimentation of HealthTech innovations. It will match innovators/researchers with LLs to utilise LL's infrastructure and support services for testing innovations. Researchers and innovators will be invited to validate their HealthTech solutions in the participating LLs through a concrete methodology already validated by Sploro, via an online mechanism, which will be finally incorporated with the AccelUP. Ultimately, such a coordinated demonstration activity of matching innovators with experimentation spaces can overcome many legal, regulatory, fiscal, technical, and operational obstacles and accelerate the transition to more personalized healthcare systems enabled by technological innovations. With a comprehensive exploitation strategy (WP4) and standardised mechanisms through the online platform (i.e., reports, engagement and exchange of relevant stakeholders, best practice-based approaches, and guidelines), EVOLVE2CARE will help European supervisory authorities to improve regulatory frameworks to actively and timely promote innovation in the healthcare industry. LLs in the

³ M. D. Naylor, L. AccelUP. Aiken, E. T. Kurtzman, D. M. Olds, and K. B. Hirschman, “The care span: The importance of transitional care in achieving health reform,” *Health Affairs*, 2011.

health sector will be engaged for participating in the experimentation activities through an open call reaching out through ENOLL network and beyond.

[SN4]: Need to facilitate knowledge sharing and collaborations

Lack of established and standardised mechanisms for knowledge sharing, collecting feedback from users and stakeholders and use of this feedback for iterating and improving HealthTech solutions can hinder the development of innovations and their commercialization process. Without an effective feedback loop, innovators might miss opportunities to enhance features, fix issues, and optimize usability based on real-world usage.

KO#4. Encourage knowledge sharing and Collaborations

Relation to the WP: “Proposals may build on or seek collaboration with existing projects of EIT KICs in the area of innovation testing[...].”	Indicators # KICs/projects/ EU initiatives reached: 7 # Living Labs reached: 100 # Multipliers reached: 20 # RTOs reached: 20 # Knowledge sharing workshops: 2
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EVOLVE2CARE will develop strategies for effective communication and knowledge sharing among legal, regulatory, fiscal, and operational entities. Through the AccelUP platform, stakeholders can systematically identify and share obstacles, gaps, or potential conflicts that may develop because of the experimentation of multi-sectoral HealthTech innovations in the transitional care industry and proceed to the development of solutions that are more aligned with the needs of the healthcare ecosystem, ultimately driving greater adoption and success in the market. EVOLVE2CARE through AccelUP will enhance the development of best practices among stakeholders actively involved in testing and experimentation of HealthTech innovations. It will facilitate collaboration, by systematically exchanging lessons learned, and will promote a culture of sharing common knowledge assets. Through AccelUP policy makers can recognise and support transformative innovation by utilizing LLs collective knowledge on research agendas. EVOLVE2CARE will engage with EU initiatives (i.e., European Innovation Partnership on Active and Healthy Ageing, PERISCOPE, EU Joint Action on Patient Safety and Quality of Care (PaSQ), European Human Biomonitoring Framework, HEPA Europe, EU Health Coalition, Innovative Health Initiative (IHI) and capitalising on the existing pan-European network of LLs through ENOLL will seek collaboration with existing projects of EIT KICs i.e., ProHeart, CareMetric, DigiPrevent).

1.2 COORDINATION, SUPPORT MEASURES AND METHODOLOGY

1.2.1 EVOLVE2CARE Overall Methodology underpinning the work

Three interconnected phases underpin the foundation of the EVOLVE2CARE methodological approach.

Phase 1: Definition of Stakeholder Requirements and EVOLVE2CARE Experimentation Space Architecture

(linked to KO#1, WP1): Phase 1 focuses on defining the specific requirements of the various stakeholders who are impacted by, or can impact, the process of validating HealthTech solutions in the transitional care industry. These

conclusions will advance the development of EVOLVE2CARE’s experimentation framework, utilizing AccelUP, which is a centralized marketplace platform where innovators (researchers, SMEs, startups, corporates) who utilize LL services can find and connect with suitable Labs and will form the central operational framework.

Stakeholders Requirements: Stakeholders that can impact or be impacted by outcomes of experiments include: **a) Innovators and Researchers** (academics, startups & SMEs) who design and execute experiments and processes leading to products and services; **b) Customers and Users (individuals, practitioners, large entities such as hospitals, insurers, care homes, etc., and public bodies)** who can validate the design, purchasing and use of new offerings in the transitional care sector leading to improvements in customer experience; **c) Investors (public and private)** whose decisions to proceed with financing are influenced by the relative positive or negative outcomes of experimentation; **d) Regulators and Compliance Bodies** who determine the design and execution of regulatory frameworks in healthcare that govern the use or development of innovative products and services; and **e) Public and Society**, who can influence public perceptions on new HealthTech offerings or regulations when ethical dilemmas, data privacy concerns or societal implications arise

Figure 1 EVOLVE2CARE methodological phases

Utilizing existing Living Lab infrastructure and experimentation services applying various experimentation frameworks:

EVOLVE2CARE will engage (for its demonstration activities in WP3) existing certified Living Labs, via the ENOLL network and throughout the project. In Phase 1, we will map the standardized experimentation support services, methods, sharable databases, and infrastructure of Health-sector LLs, based on their capacity to develop and implement experimentation frameworks that are sensitive to the diverse interests and impacts of our target stakeholders. As **cross-disciplinary collaborative environments**, **Living Labs** should provide access to stakeholders from various fields such as academia, business, and the medical community who can work together to co-create, test, and validate innovative solutions in real-world settings. LLs selected should: **a) utilize user-centric approaches** ensuring that the needs, preferences, and concerns of customers and users are considered, leading to innovations that better meet their requirements, **b) allow stakeholders to observe how innovations function in authentic environments**, which is particularly beneficial for innovators, investors, decision-makers, and regulators, **c) facilitate interaction between stakeholders and the innovation being tested** allowing for quick adjustments of the experimentation framework based on feedback and changing needs, **d) implement established protocols for ethical and legal compliance** ensuring that experiments are conducted in a responsible and lawful manner, **e) help demonstrate the potential impact of innovations** to decision makers and regulators offering tangible outcomes, and **f) encourage a culture of learning from failures**, which is essential for refining experimentation frameworks.

Capitalizing on previously funded outcomes: EVOLVE2CARE will capitalize on AccelUP, a key result derived from a previously funded EU project VITALISE⁴, currently in an early “proof of concept” phase. AccelUP is designed as a centralized marketplace platform where innovators (researchers, SMEs, startups, corporates) who utilize LL services can find and connect with suitable Labs for running experiments. The platform is designed to provide information about each Lab’s capabilities, expertise, past projects, and available resources, while providing a bidding mechanism to ensure competitive pricing and service offerings between innovators and Living Labs. This bidding function is key to fostering a market-oriented approach to the provision of experimentation services and allowing individual Living Labs to maximize the potential of their assets and resources. As institutions, Living Labs tend to be ‘localized’ in their approach to service provision, because they are physical spaces with distinct cohorts (or “Panels”) of engaged stakeholders. As an online “borderless” environment, AccelUP provides a means to expand the scope and value of those local resources belonging to each Living Lab by encouraging networking, knowledge sharing and commercial activities that are crucial to facilitating innovation, extending the breadth of each Living Lab’s involvement beyond their present reach. Once limited to an audience in their local or regional areas, AccelUP provides Living Labs with the opportunity to connect with stakeholders from across the globe. The platform’s intermediation functionality will be greatly advanced within EVOLVE2CARE, allowing stakeholders – including policymakers, investors, advocates and more – to engage in the innovation process via sharing of best practices, knowledge bases and resources, while encouraging an overall “network effect” amongst all members of the value chain that can lead to growth in participation, jobs, and common development frameworks.

EVOLVE2CARE’s Marketplace of Experimentation Spaces Architecture: During Phase 1, the specifications of AccelUP will be defined and an Action Plan will be created on how the initial conceptual framework will be expanded to establish the set of core principles and standards that all participating Living Labs must adhere to, to participate to a Pan-European digital experimentation marketplace. These standards shall cover ethical considerations, data privacy, participant engagement, transparency, experimentation methods, databases, and other key aspects of experimentation. The types of services and experimentation packages that Living Labs can offer will be standardised i.e., service packages will include details about the scope of experiments, available resources, data collection methods, and expected outcomes. Transparent pricing models will be established to enable informed decisions of innovators and researchers. The process for qualifying and verifying the capabilities of Living Labs before they join the marketplace is already conducted by ENOLL and is based on specific certification criteria. This involves evaluating their expertise, infrastructure, track record, and adherence to established standards. Collaboration tools on the platform that will facilitate communication, project management, and data sharing between organizations and Living Labs will be implemented to ensure seamless interaction throughout the experimentation process. Feedback and Reviews will be enabled so users of Living Labs’ services can engage to maintain quality standards and assist others in selecting the right lab for their needs. A mechanism for continuous improvement within the marketplace that regularly assesses the platform’s effectiveness, quality, and overall experience will be identified and established. Standardized Reporting for experiment outcomes will be enabled to make it easier for organizations to compare results across different Living Labs and derive meaningful insights. To encourage knowledge sharing and collaboration among participating Living Labs, webinars, workshops, and conferences to share best practices, case studies, and research findings will be planned. Finally, the advanced AccelUP framework will include a governance structure that oversees the operations of the marketplace, enforces standards, resolves disputes, and ensures the

⁴ <https://vitalise-project.eu/> (GA 101007990)



marketplace's integrity. The main outcome of this process will be EVOLVE2CARE's experimentation space Action Plan. Figure 1 depicts the exploration of stakeholder requirements and the design of EVOLVE2CARE's experimentation space AccelUP.

Phase 2: EVOLVE2CARE Experimentation space modules & services development (linked to KO#X, WP2):

Phase 2 includes the actual development of the AccelUP marketplace modules and services (as defined in T1.4), which are necessary to set up the functionality of EVOLVE2CARE's experimentation space and the matching of innovators and researchers in the transitional care sector to use LLs services from the AccelUP marketplace.

Development of AccelUP Architectural modules: The AccelUP architectural modules encapsulate the advancements of all the core digital tools for matching innovators with LLs with the aim to test and validate innovations and provide mechanisms to identify and communicate the regulatory implications involved when testing and commercializing HealthTech solutions in the transitional care sector. AccelUP will add new algorithms and profiling techniques to match innovators and Living Labs based on their respective goals, expertise, and interests. This personalized matching will increase the likelihood of successful collaborations. Since innovators frequently need specialised resources, tools, equipment, or expertise only found in Living Labs, AccelUP will standardise the disclosure of clear information about the resources each Living Lab offers, assisting innovators in making informed decisions. By facilitating efficient partnerships, AccelUP can accelerate the experimentation process. Innovators will be able to quickly access Living Lab facilities, test their ideas, and receive real-time feedback, leading to faster iteration cycles. The platform will encourage knowledge exchange between innovators, regulators and other stakeholders and Living Labs. Stakeholders will be able to learn from the Living Labs' experiences, best practices, lessons learnt and insights, contributing to more effective experimentation and alignment of regulatory frameworks based on real-life environment results. Additionally, by using AccelUP, innovators can increase their visibility inside the ecosystem of the platform, luring new collaborators, investors, and partners. Collaboration between innovators from many fields and Living Labs with various specializations will be encouraged by AccelUP. Such interdisciplinary collaboration can provide unanticipated synergies and ground-breaking ideas. Finally, AccelUP will compile information on the results of collaboration, examples of success, and challenges faced by innovators and Living Labs. The analysis of this data will be published to provide insightful information for increasing collaborations and refining relevant regulatory frameworks. The platform's success can contribute to the growth of the innovation ecosystem, attracting innovators, LLs, and stakeholders to participate and contribute to experimentation practices.

Onboarding LLs onto the AccelUP platform: Initially, EVOLVE2CARE, will engage LLs in the Health sector through a call for expression of interest published to all ENOLL members and beyond. LLs selected will be onboarded to the AccelUP marketplace publishing their services, infrastructures, and access to data, following a standardized process described in the Action Plan derived during Phase 1 (see T1.3).

Onboarding Innovators and Researchers in the transitional care sector: The call for innovators and researchers will target transitional care solutions that are being developed by startups, established companies, research institutions or individual entrepreneurs. Proposals will be chosen in a competitive evaluation process and successful applicants will be matched with appropriate LLs from the AccelUP marketplace. This pairing of innovators and Living Labs will allow EVOLVE2CARE to provide specific use-cases of regulatory impact on the development of HealthTech products and services, by observing the process in real-time. EVOLVE2CARE will engage with the innovators to determine what practical measures are taken to ameliorate or account for regulatory issues which arise, including workarounds, adaptations, and modifications. This empirical data can be a valuable resource for policy makers and innovators alike, by contributing to the current understanding and future formulations of Healthcare regulations. To recruit a suitable pool of innovators, clear and compelling messages will be crafted, including explanations on how LLs can accelerate innovation, provide real-world validation, and offer access to diverse user perspectives.

Use Cases (UCs): The transitional care domain has distinct challenges that can be mitigated through the application of innovative HealthTech solutions. Some specific Use Cases (UCs) that will be used as a starting point for experimentation of HealthTech solutions during EVOLVE2CARE are:

UC#1: Management of Hospital discharge - Manage medication and information transfer from hospital to the next stage of care (e.g., rehabilitation, home, nursing home). This UC can leverage on Electronic Health Records (EHRs) that can be used to maintain a patient's medical history, including medication lists and treatment plans as well as Health Information Exchange systems to facilitate the secure exchange of information between healthcare organizations. It also includes medication management applications and telehealth for post-discharge follow-ups. Technologies utilizing machine learning and predictive analytics can be also included in this UC to identify patients at risk of readmission and allow for timely interventions.

UC#2 Home care monitoring - Enable remote monitoring, data sharing, and effective communication between patients and healthcare providers. The home care monitoring is enhanced through remote monitoring devices such as wearables, smartwatches and IoT devices that can collect and transmit vital signs, activity data, and medication



adherence information to healthcare providers in real-time. These are accompanied by mobile health apps that can provide functionalities for self-monitoring and symptom tracking, video conferencing for teleconsultation and access to educational resources. The collected data can be leveraged by Artificial Intelligence applications to detect anomalies and provide early warnings of health issues.

UC#3 Aging Population and Care Transitions: considering mobility issues, cognitive decline, and family involvement to create accessible and intuitive technologies. This UC will include interventions targeted at Aging population like voice assistants, cognitive assistive technologies that can help with memory support, medication reminders and navigation as well as family engagement platforms that keep family members and informal caregivers informed and connected to the patient. All the applications should provide intuitive and accessible user interfaces, to ensure ease of use and minimize frustration.

Eligibility Criteria: Eligibility criteria for innovators to be selected will be a) the innovation potential, b) alignment with LL services and cost structures, c) scalability, and d) societal impact. Application requirements and processes, deadlines and the services offered by LLs and their corresponding costs will be defined.

Application Tools & Communication methods: Application forms, templates, and guidelines for innovators to fill out will be developed ensuring the process is transparent, competitive, user-friendly and captures essential information. HealthTech in transitional care is by default interdisciplinary, encompassing a wide range of specializations and technologies with cross-sectoral relevance. Multiple marketing channels i.e., social media, newsletters, industry forums and partnerships with various organizations i.e., EIT Health, Digital, Mobility and other KICs, Innovation Radar, Accelerator Assembly, and relevant professional/academic societies and advocacy groups will be utilised for outreach. Each of the EVOLVE2CARE partners has extensive networks in different relevant stakeholder areas (innovators, investors, start-ups, corporates, etc.) that will be mobilized to recruit applicants and spread the word. Online sessions will be organized to provide potential applicants with more insights into LL services, the application process, and the benefits of participating. Contact information for inquiries and assistance to potential applicants will be offered. The review and selection process will involve evaluating each application against the predefined criteria, who will make the final decision on the most promising projects. These results will be harmonized to account for any significant difference in the evaluation scores. The consortium will also identify and contract one external ethics expert that will review the short-listed projects for ethics issues, require clarifications from the applicants (if needed) and provide a written opinion on the ethics issues involved in these projects as an ethics report submitted to the consortium identifying any potential threats or changes. This report will be submitted to the EC during the ethics check (M16). Once the selection process is completed, the successful innovators will be announced through various channels showcasing the LL services they will be using. Selected innovators will work closely with EVOLVE2CARE partners to facilitate a smooth onboarding process.

Tailored training program to address the needs of LLs and innovators/researchers: Two training courses will be designed and implemented by ENOLL and AV, targeting an extended audience as participants. The first training program will target LLs, including those which do not participate in the subcontracting services of EVOLVE2CARE but have an interest in increasing their capacities in supporting innovators but also learn from successes or failures. The second training program will be tailored to the needs of innovators/researchers aimed at increasing their capacities in making the most out of real-life experimentations environments and enhance their commercialization potential. Both trainings will create a supportive ecosystem that fosters effective collaboration, successful experimentation, and the potential commercialization of innovative solutions (see T2.3 & T2.4).

Testing and Validation of the matchmaking process between LLs and innovators/researchers: EVOLVE2CARE consortium includes SPLORO, which offers existing matchmaking services between innovators, investors, and various stakeholders through a tested and validated functional digital tool. SPLORO will provide the functional methodology and the assessment baseline for the matchmaking process between Living Labs and Innovators. Sploro's methodology is currently being utilised among US, Canadian and EU research entities for the NGI Sargasso programme⁵. The application of the methodology for matching innovators with LLs will give useful insight on how to design and implement the bidding process for attracting the right LLs in a research and experimentation project within the AccelUP platform.

Phase 3: Implementation of Experimentation Services and Space - AccelUP (linked to KO#2,3, and WP3)

Phase 3 includes the execution of the experimentation services, during which HealthTech innovations in the transitional care sector will be tested in LL infrastructures identified in Phase 2. This phase includes the execution of each experiment for the Use Case identified, in realistic environments as well as the monitoring and evaluation of the experimentation process. The innovators who have been chosen and matched with a LL will be given access to the agreed-upon resources of the particular LL. The matched LLs will be offered payment vouchers by EVOLVE2CARE on behalf of the innovators to compensate for the experimentation services they will provide. An

⁵ <https://ngisargasso.eu>

amount of 50.000 euros has been set aside in the budget to cover these costs, and EVOLVE2CARE anticipates that this funding will cover between 10-12 separate innovation experimentation instances of the predefined Use Cases. A mechanism for both parties i.e., a) LLs, and b) innovators, to provide feedback on the matching process will be established to refine the AccelUP platform process for future collaborations that will be achieved through a bidding process. Ongoing support and assistance to both parties during the collaboration will be offered by EVOLVE2CARE partners to address any challenges that arise and ensure a positive experience for everyone involved, while also informing and refining the design of the bidding process in the experimentation space of the AccelUP platform. Lessons learnt and best practices will be reported according to the standardised process defined in the Action Plan (T1.3) of AccelUP, along with the main research findings and reports on experiments, best practices, and explanations of the use case. Two knowledge sharing workshops will be held during the annual Open Living Lab Days, organized by ENOLL. In addition to showcasing the results of the project, these two workshops will gather stakeholders that have been engaged during the experimentation process and beyond and highlight the benefits of utilizing AccelUP.

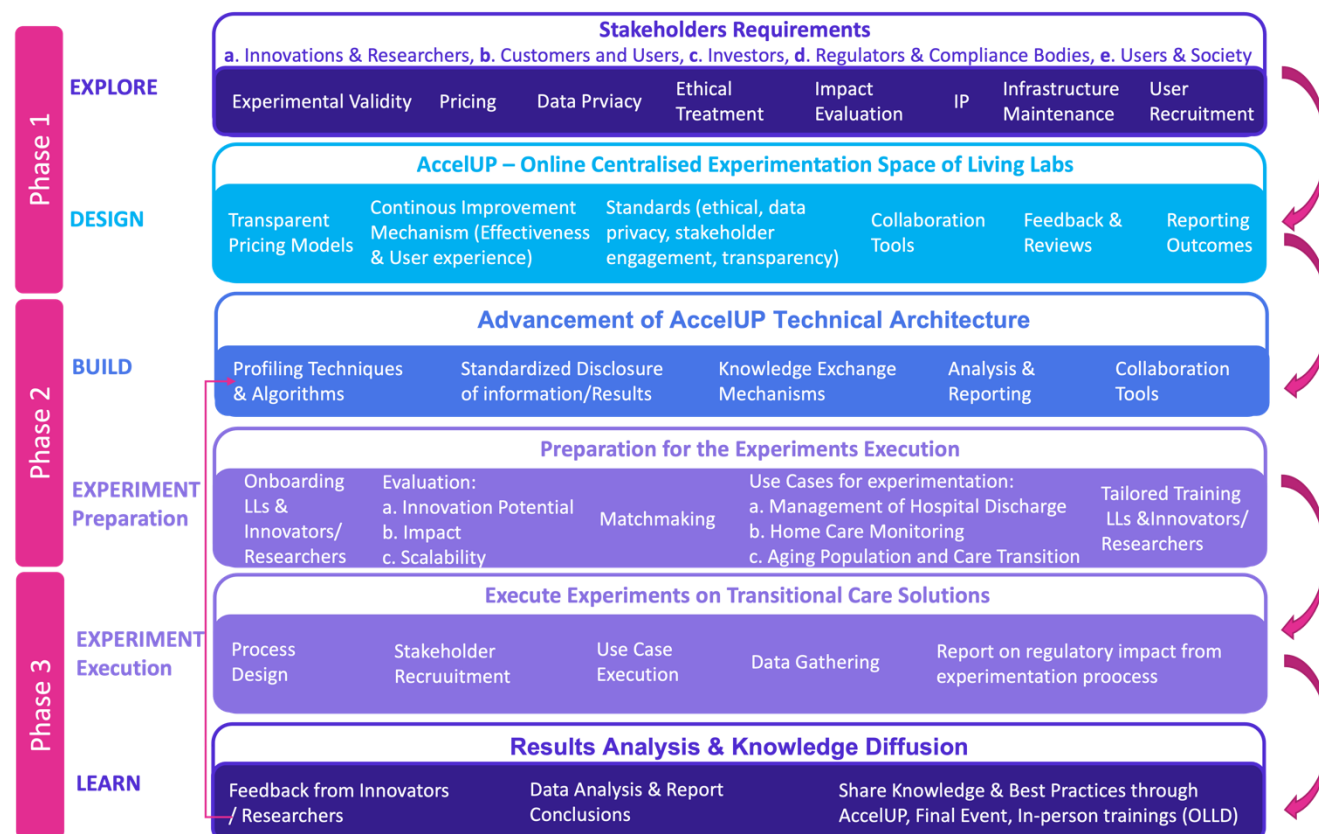


Figure 2 EVOLVE2CARE Methodological Phases

All phases above are supported by horizontal activities, namely **Communication, Dissemination and Exploitation activities (WP4 – linked with KO#2,4)** and **Project Coordination and Management (WP5)**.

1.2.2 Do not significant harm

EVOLVE2CARE is fully compliant with the *Do No Significant Harm (DNSH) Principle* since its activities (carried out during the course of the project, including the use of the funding via financial support to third parties envisioned in the project), do not significantly harm any of the six environmental objectives set out in Articles 9 and 17 of the EU Sustainable Finance Taxonomy Regulation⁶.

1.2.3 Appropriateness of open science practices implementation

Given the nature of EVOLVE2CARE, a pure orientation to openly share research data or other research processes are not a core element of this project. Coordination and support actions are not research initiatives per se. Nevertheless, we foresee concrete measures and actions which help us to embrace the “open” movement as such, in an aim to promote openness, transparency and the results attained by the project.

- **Open access to publications produced in the context of the project by Innovators/Researchers:** We realise that our training programme or the outcomes of the experimentations may involve the generation of scientific

⁶[] REGULATION (EU) 2020/852 OF THE EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT AND OF THE COUNCIL, of 18 June 2020 on the establishment of a framework to facilitate sustainable investment, and amending Regulation, (EU) 2019/2088, Official Journal of the European Union, L 198/13, 22.6.2020



publications by the researchers/ innovators involved via an online repository, like Zenodo. The open access to research data article (Annex 5. Article 17) also applies. These actions will enhance EVOLVE2CARE impact.

- Moreover, **public deliverables and presentation materials**, for which this is appropriate, will be published on Zenodo under a Creative Commons license to facilitate sharing without restrictions.

1.2.4 Research data management and management of other research outputs

Research data management is understood at two levels: (1) EVOLVE2CARE as a project and (2) the selected LLs participating by providing their services in the experimentation Use Cases and innovators/researchers wishing to test their solutions and participate in the training programs.

Regarding the first, the project itself is not performing activities related to research. Nevertheless, EVOLVE2CARE will carry out data collection, including personal data and metadata (in context of the internal personal data of the consortium partners but especially the personal data of the innovators/researcher applying to our open calls and joining our public events). EVOLVE2CARE will perform a data management needs assessment and release a data management plan (D5.3). All processing of personal data will be conducted in accordance with the provisions of the GDPR. Analysis data that will be collected and/or generated by the project will be made public. In addition, and to promote transparency and the good use of EU-funding, EVOLVE2CARE will publish an **Open Dataset with the beneficiaries of our open calls** including their basic data (non-personal) and the experimentation results as a result of their participation in the open calls and their collaborations with the LLs. This dataset will be made available at ZENODO.

Regarding the selected experimentation instances of the use cases carried out by the innovators/researchers within the Living Labs, the sub-contracting agreements (T3.1) will include the rules related to publication of results and research data management by Horizon Europe. The results of the research performed by the innovators/researchers in the context will be shared with the scientific community, commercial players, civil society, policymakers and regulators. They must also take action to use their project results for commercial purposes, to tackle societal problems or in policymaking ('exploitation').

EVOLVE2CARE will recommend the selected explorers to use the different various free-of-charge services to support the dissemination activities such as:

- Open Research Europe platform:** An open access, publishing platform for scientific papers for Horizon 2020 and Horizon Europe beneficiaries, including open peer review and article revision.
- Horizon Results platform:** A platform for showcasing research results, finding collaboration opportunities and getting inspired by the results of others.
- Horizon Results Booster:** Free consulting services including a portfolio dissemination and exploitation strategy, business plan development and go-to-market support.
- Innovation Radar:** An initiative that identifies high-potential innovations, based on a data-driven methodology, and assists EU-funded researchers and innovators in reaching the market with their innovation.

2 IMPACT

2.1 PROJECT PATHWAYS TOWARDS IMPACT

2.1.1 How the project results are expected to make a difference in terms of impact

EXPECTED OUTCOME #1

Increase knowledge on experimentation frameworks for testing innovations

Increasing knowledge on experimentation frameworks for testing innovations in the realm of healthcare necessitates a holistic strategy with clear objectives. We begin by pinpointing the specific challenges in transitional care and the potential of HealthTech to address them, while also identifying gaps in current regulatory frameworks. A collaborative approach is the cornerstone of this endeavour, combining focused intelligence gathering from all stakeholder groups with initial findings from Living Labs own experience. From this first stage we move to strengthen partnerships between innovators, regulators, healthcare providers, and patients, in order to collectively research and test new HealthTech solutions in real-world settings. Living Labs, with their diverse environments and demographics, serve as the ideal platform for such collaborative endeavours. The overall scheme of our project presents a clear step-by-step process to make this happen, from a requisites' gathering in phase 1, to training programs and the development of experimentation services in Phase 2, to an actual experimentation suite in Phase 3 that will significantly enable us to increase knowledge on experimentation frameworks for testing innovations under the transitional care domain in LLs' real-life environments.

Target group: Innovators/researchers, RTOs, regulators, SMEs, startups, standardisation specialists

Scale: 10 Reports on experimentation findings including regulatory barriers; 10 innovators benefited from the experimentation services; 2 Tailored Training Programs including workshops and webinars (1 for LLs and 1 for Innovators); 30 LLs and 18 innovators benefited from the trainings

Significance: ENoLL's network is comprised of +480 members⁷ all over the world, including 260 Living Labs of which +45 focused on Health/Wellbeing, 48 on the environment, and +50 dealing with social innovation & inclusion. Assuming 5% of the overall network – comprised of LLs as well as other innovation and strategic partners - will be interested to collaborate with EVOLVE2CARE is an achievable figure. In addition, we will conduct extensive outreach to non-affiliated Living Labs in fields related to our project such as mobility and smart cities, as well as multipliers such as incubators, accelerators, and tech parks, allowing us to attract 50 innovators with intent to test in LLs.

EXPECTED OUTCOME #2

Provide services for testing innovative solutions leading to technology upscaling, reducing cost, accelerating time to the market, and reducing investment risks

Through Phase 1, we focus on understanding the diverse needs of stakeholders. For instance, in Task 1.2, defining specific requirements of stakeholders allows for the solutions that are developed not only being innovative but also tailored to real-world needs. The Living Labs (LLs) play a pivotal role here, offering a unique environment for co-creation, testing, and validation of solutions in real-world settings. This approach not only accelerates the time to market but also ensures that the solutions are robust and relevant. In Phase 2, we delve deeper into the practicalities of innovation, emphasizing the advancement of the AccelUP software infrastructure. By refining this centralized marketplace, we ensure that innovators can easily connect with suitable labs at scale, thereby reducing costs and streamlining the development process. Furthermore, Task 2.2 focuses on scouting and selecting the right innovators and researchers, ensuring that the most promising and impactful solutions are brought to the forefront. In Phase 3 we focus on the actual execution of experimentation services. By testing innovations in real-world settings and gathering feedback, we not only reduce investment risks but also ensure that the solutions are ready for scaling and commercialization. This hands-on approach, combined with the insights and feedback mechanisms established in tasks like 3.2, ensures that the innovations are not only technologically advanced but also market-ready and cost-effective.

Target group: LLs, innovators/researchers/startups/SMEs

Scale: 30 innovators submit application (50 innovators show intention by opening applications on the platform), 10 innovators selected, 10 Services provided.

Impact: For 10 innovators: reducing by 3 months the time to market, and/or lowering development costs of products/services by 5%; For 10 innovators: improved investment and commercialization pathways resulting from the activities performed, assessed in the beginning and in the end of the experimentation process.

Significance: We will use the classical funnel method utilised in inbound marketing strategies. From demonstrated interest of 50 innovators (EO#1), we will move to performing 10 actual innovation experiments with significant reduction in time to market, thanks to EVOLVE2CARE. In our experience running acceleration programmes and accelerators (i.e., Ventures Thrive, NGI Sargasso) advancing a third of the overall portfolio to last stages is a common practice that allows focusing on top-performing innovations. This can provide a useful roadmap for larger outcomes utilizing the enhanced AccelUp marketplace once EVOLVE2CARE has concluded.

EXPECTED OUTCOME #3

Enhance knowledge sharing and development of best practices between stakeholders that have been actively engaged in testing and experimentation processes

To foster enhanced knowledge sharing and best practices among stakeholders, we've established the AccelUP platform. This centralized hub facilitates collaboration, allowing innovators, researchers, and other stakeholders to connect, share insights, and access suitable labs and experimentation spaces. Tailored training programs will be hosted, to equip both Living Labs and innovators with essential skills, from understanding innovation ecosystems to effective commercialization strategies. Furthermore, we will organize knowledge-sharing sessions, including webinars and workshops, where best practices and research findings will be discussed. Coupled with feedback mechanisms post-experimentation, these initiatives ensure continuous learning, refinement of methodologies, and the promotion of innovation in health and transitional care. In the Open Living Lab Days findings from the research, trainings, best practices, and experimentation activities will be communicated in knowledge sharing sessions.

⁷ <https://enoll.org/about-us/>

Target group: Innovators, RTOs, national authorities, SMEs, startups, standardisation bodies, NGOs

Scale: 2 Knowledge sharing workshops; Reaching from across Europe and beyond, 100 Living Labs, 20 RTOs, 20 Multipliers (accelerators, incubators, tech parks), and 50 innovators/researchers/SMEs/startups willing to experiment their innovations within the identified LLs. Reaching 10 regulators to participate in the knowledge exchange/dissemination activities.

Significance: Research and knowledge is often siloed by discipline; our collaborative and cross-sectoral approach will ensure that a holistic view of Transitional Care issues is generated and shared between all members of the stakeholder chain. Project partners have extensive experience in designing and delivering training programs events, and research related to innovation, commercialization, experimentation.

EXPECTED OUTCOME #4

Facilitate the deployment and potential commercialisation of new innovative solutions

In essence, by combining targeted training with the tangible benefits of Living Labs, EVOLVE2CARE ensures that innovative solutions are not only developed but are also ready for deployment and commercialisation in the real world. This holistic approach significantly increases the chances of success and market adoption for these innovations. The path to deploying and commercialising new innovative solutions is multifaceted, and EVOLVE2CARE has strategically positioned itself to streamline this journey. One of the primary avenues is through our tailored training programs. In tasks like T2.3 and T2.4, we've designed comprehensive training modules for both Living Labs (LLs) and innovators/researchers. These programs delve into essential topics such as understanding innovation ecosystems, best practices in LL operations, effective collaboration skills, and even sector-specific training. For innovators, the training emphasizes the role of LLs, along with design thinking, prototyping, business model development, finances, investment, and pitching. By equipping both LLs and innovators with these skills, we ensure that the innovations are not only technically sound but also closer to market-readiness. Access to Living Labs is another cornerstone of our strategy. Living Labs, as highlighted in Phase 1, offer a unique environment where innovations can be tested, refined, and validated in real-world settings. This hands-on approach ensures that the solutions are not only theoretically viable but also practically impactful. By allowing innovators to engage with real users, gather feedback, and iterate in real-time, we drastically reduce the time and resources typically required to refine a product or service.

Target group: innovators/researchers, startups, healthcare end-users, SMEs

Scale: 10 solutions validated, unlocking forecasted savings of 2M€ for the system

Significance: A recent McKinsey study found that the healthcare industry was in the bottom three of 20 sectors in digital advancement globally. HealthTech is expected to unlock \$230b globally⁸ with a CAGR of 16.1%. Considering a global population of 150M of startups⁹ of which a 13% is working on HealthTech (according to StartupBlink), we can assume a value generated of 2M€ by our innovators as an achievable objective.

EXPECTED OUTCOME #5

Identify areas where the multi-sectoral and/or emerging nature of some innovations requires coordinated action by innovators and regulators;

Within the framework of the project, we have chosen to concentrate on transitional care as a sub-sector of the health field. Specifically, we will focus on innovative solutions as Use Cases (UCs) in three areas: **a)** hospital discharge management, **b)** home care monitoring, and **c)** aging population and care transitions. These areas, inherently intertwined with multiple industries like technology, pharmaceuticals, and finance, present unique challenges and opportunities, as innovations span a wide range, from wearable health tech devices to sophisticated telemedicine platforms, and from AI-driven diagnostic tools to IoT-enabled patient monitoring systems. Recognizing the intricate nature of these sectors, we emphasize the importance of a coordinated approach between innovators and regulators. The emerging solutions in transitional care promise not only improved patient outcomes and streamlined processes but also bring forth challenges related to data privacy, ethical considerations, and standardization. The iterative experimentation process that will be performed in the LLs provides an opportunity to study in real time the regulatory hurdles or enablers that innovators face as they develop new products and services. Our aim is to work collaboratively with regulators and encourage them to engage early in the validation process along with innovators and users. This can ensure that the solutions not only meet but exceed the highest standards of care, safety, and compliance, and that regulations and policy decisions reflect the complexity of human

⁸ Digital health tech expected to unlock \$230bn globally. 7/7/22 at Edge. Link [here](#).

⁹ Startups disrupting industries and changing the world—and doing it all at scale. 20/9/2022 at Microsoft CEE Multi-Country News Center. Link [here](#)

experience observed in real time. By doing so, we are paving the way for a future where innovation and regulation harmoniously coexist, driving positive change in the healthcare landscape.

Target group: Innovators/researchers, policymakers, healthcare systems, technology providers

Scale: 3 areas/Use Cases that require coordinated action by innovators and regulators in the transitional care sector

Significance: EVOLVE2CARE has deliberately chosen 3 Use Case in the transitional care sector due to the high probability of regulatory issues associated with each. The project will spotlight opportunities for regulatory action in each sector.

EXPECTED OUTCOME #6

Identify legal, regulatory, fiscal, technical, and operational pre-requisites or barriers for different use-cases which hamper the development of innovation;

To effectively identify the myriad of legal, regulatory, fiscal, technical, and operational prerequisites or barriers that obstruct innovation, we employ a two-pronged strategy. Firstly, we conduct a rigorous task-driven analysis, focusing on our three Use Cases (a) hospital discharge management, b) home care monitoring, and c) aging population and care transitions). This analysis, under the umbrella of "Drivers and Barriers for the development of Healthtech innovations", provides a holistic view of the current challenges, revealing the intricate factors that might deter innovators from realizing their full potential in each area. Secondly, our methodology emphasizes direct engagement with stakeholders. By interacting with a spectrum of participants, from innovators and researchers to regulators and the general public, we glean first hand insights into the real-world manifestations of these barriers. This feedback, coupled with our observations from Living Labs, offers a unique vantage point, enabling us to understand and subsequently address the multifaceted challenges that impede the growth of innovation.

Target group: Innovators and entrepreneurs, policy makers, industry experts, investors

Scale: Interact with at least **20** different organisations from at least **10** different countries to provide information and feedback regarding pre-requisites, barriers or enablers to innovative products and services in the 3 UCs.

Significance: Soliciting feedback from across the EU and engaging with an increased number of external stakeholders will provide a wide perspective of knowledge to base our conclusions upon.

EXPECTED OUTCOME #7

Explore areas where the European supervisory authority exists and pan-European testing might be desirable.

We can approach this two-fold: (1) Identification and Analysis: Leveraging our expertise in health, transitional care, and multi-sectoral innovations, we'll delve deep into the European landscape to pinpoint sectors overseen by a European supervisory authority. Our approach will be data-driven, utilizing insights from our previous tasks and methodologies to discern areas where pan-European regulations are prevalent or necessary. By understanding the intricacies of these sectors, especially in health and transitional care, we can identify where pan-European testing is not just desirable but essential for innovation and progress. (2) Engagement and Collaboration: Building on our commitment to knowledge sharing and stakeholder collaboration, we'll initiate dialogues with member states, industry leaders, and the European supervisory authority. Through workshops and forums, we'll discuss the potential of pan-European testing in the identified areas, drawing from real-life examples and use-cases from our tasks. By fostering this collaborative environment, we aim to bridge the gap between innovators and regulators, ensuring that pan-European testing aligns with the needs of the industry while upholding regulatory standards.

Target group: Supervisory authorities, industry, member state representatives

Scale: Reaching at least 5 supervisory authorities from 10 different MS expanding to at least 20 in the second year.

Significance: Covering 20 countries out of the 27 in the EU and possibly expanding to associated member states will provide us full coverage to maximise our impact in regulatory alignment.

2.1.2 Wider impacts specified in the work programme

EXPECTED Impact#1

Interconnected, inclusive, and more efficient innovation ecosystems across the EU that draw on the existing strengths of European, national, regional, and local ecosystems and engage new, less well-represented stakeholders and less advanced innovation territories, including rural areas, to set, undertake, and achieve collective ambitions tackling challenges for the benefit of society, including green, digital, and social transitions, and advancing the European Research Area and the New European Innovation Agenda;

In response to the overarching vision of fostering interconnected, inclusive, and efficient innovation ecosystems across the EU, our project resonates deeply with this tripartite mission: **1. Interconnected:** At the heart of our initiative lies the principle of interconnectedness, with HealthTech serving as a pivotal enabler. By facilitating the digital innovation of the healthcare sector, we are not only streamlining processes but also ensuring that information, resources, and innovations are seamlessly shared across regions. This interconnected approach ensures that best practices, technological advancements, and patient-centric solutions are universally accessible, bridging gaps and fostering a cohesive healthcare landscape across the EU. **2. Inclusive:** Our emphasis on transitional care is a testament to our commitment to inclusivity. Recognizing that healthcare is not just about treating ailments but also about ensuring a smooth transition for patients and their families, our project adopts a holistic approach. By focusing on transitional care, we are ensuring that patients, their families, and carers are at the center of our innovation strategy. This inclusive approach ensures that the unique needs, challenges, and aspirations of these stakeholders are addressed, fostering a healthcare ecosystem that is truly patient-centric and inclusive of all. **3. Efficient Innovation:** Efficiency is the linchpin of our innovation strategy, and our use of Living Labs (LLs) underscores this commitment. By leveraging LLs as the foundational platform for experimentation, we are ensuring that innovations are not only cutting-edge but also grounded in real-world applicability. The hands-on, practical nature of LLs ensures that solutions are tested, refined, and validated in real-world settings, ensuring that they are not only technically sound but also practically impactful. This approach drastically reduces the time-to-market, ensures relevance, and guarantees that our innovations are both efficient and effective. In conclusion, our project is not just aligned with the EU's vision but actively embodies it. Through our interconnected approach with HealthTech, our inclusive focus on transitional care, and our commitment to efficient innovation via Living Labs, we are poised to make significant strides in advancing the European Research Area and the New European Innovation Agenda.

EXPECTED Impact#2

Enhance cross-border network connectivity and inter-regional collaboration of regional innovation valleys by reinforcing their capacity to create, restore, and renew European value chains towards the sustainable green and digital transition and the EU's open strategic autonomy in EU countries and/or regions;

In response to the vision of enhancing cross-border network connectivity and fostering inter-regional collaboration among regional innovation valleys, our approach is rooted in the power of Living Labs (LLs) and their potential to revolutionize transitional care across Europe. By leveraging the power of a marketplace platform, AccelUP, we provide a centralized yet global space for stakeholders of all measure to locate, learn about, and collaborate with Living Labs and each other. This platform has the potential to greatly enhance the entire value chain of HealthTech innovation, while maximizing the spread of knowledge and use of resources. Living Labs contain a wealth of tools, machinery, technology, and know-how which is often only deployed on a local level. Our centralized ecosystem approach can unlock the value of these resources to a vastly wider group of beneficiaries, thus extending the power of Living Labs far beyond their individual geographical locations. Digitizing the availability of these services allows for greener innovation processes by lowering the time and energy required for locating a suitable Living Lab, and reducing the duplication of resources when new, siloed Living Labs are created.

EXPECTED Impact#3

Strengthen and expand cooperation between innovation ecosystems worldwide;

Leveraging the power of Living Labs (LLs), we aim to strengthen and expand cooperation between innovation ecosystems on a global scale. LLs serve as dynamic platforms for real-world experimentation and knowledge exchange, bridging regional and cultural divides. By connecting LLs from diverse ecosystems worldwide, we foster a collaborative environment where best practices, innovations, and insights are shared seamlessly, driving collective progress and ensuring that innovations are globally relevant and impactful.

EXPECTED Impact#4

Foster more inclusive and gender equal innovation ecosystems;

Through the lens of Living Labs (LLs), we are championing the cause of fostering more inclusive and gender-equal innovation ecosystems. LLs, with their hands-on and community-centric approach, provide an ideal platform to engage diverse voices, ensuring that innovations are shaped by a broad spectrum of perspectives. By actively promoting gender equality within these labs, we ensure that all innovators have equal opportunities to contribute, collaborate, and lead, paving the way for a more equitable and inclusive innovation landscape. This also applies to users and stakeholders, whose gender identity may shape their experience and needs, and is an essential perspective for innovators and policymakers.

EXPECTED Impact#5

Reducing territorial inequalities in access to innovation support.

Utilizing the capabilities of LLs, we are ardently working towards reducing territorial inequalities in access to innovation support. LLs, with their community-driven and adaptable nature, are being established in both urban centres and remote areas, ensuring that innovation is not confined to specific regions. By democratizing access to resources, knowledge, and tools through these labs, we are levelling the playing field, ensuring that every territory, irrespective of its geographical or economic status, has an equal opportunity to partake in and benefit from the innovation journey.

2.1.3 Requirements and potential barriers

We have analysed potential barriers which may affect the project using **PESTLE tool**. A PESTLE analysis provides a comprehensive view of the external macro-environment in which an organization operates. It stands for Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal, and Environmental factors.

Table 1 PESTLE Analysis for Impact

Issues that affect the project		CONTINGENCY MEASURE
P	Political instability or policy changes in EU countries	Regularly engage with policymakers and stay updated on potential policy shifts. Adapt project strategies accordingly.
E	Economic downturns or recessions affecting funding and investments.	Diversify funding sources for the experiments in the LLs and explore alternative financing options.
S	Resistance or backlash from certain societal groups against inclusivity initiatives	Conduct awareness campaigns and engage with communities to address concerns and misconceptions.
T	Rapid technological advancements outpacing the project's current strategies	Invest in continuous research and development to stay updated with the latest technological trends
L	Unexpected legal challenges or changes in regulations.	Collaborate with legal experts to ensure compliance and adapt to new legal requirements swiftly.
E	Environmental concerns or challenges related to the project's initiatives	Conduct regular environmental impact assessments and adjust strategies to minimize negative impacts

2.2 MEASURES TO MAXIMISE IMPACT

2.2.1 Dissemination, communication, and exploitation activities

The coordination of the activities in dissemination and communication will be under the responsibility of VILabs, while Exploitation activities will be led by AV.

2.2.1.1 EVOLVE2CARE Dissemination and Communication strategy and measures

The Dissemination and Communication (D&C) strategy will include three (3) distinct stages of implementation, each one encompassing relevant measures as indicated in Table 2.

Table 2 Implementation Stages of Dissemination and Communication Strategy and relevant measures

	Scope	Measures
Stage 1-Awareness (M1-M6)	Design the dissemination and communication strategy and plan. Refinement of target groups. Selection of dedicated tools for each group category. Community building activities. Inform all relevant key stakeholders about EVOLVE2CARE scope and objectives. Create the EVOLVE2CARE community and gather stakeholder requirements. Define the liaison and interaction mechanisms with relevant projects and initiatives within and beyond EVOLVE2CARE core context and identify complementarities, common practices, opportunities for collaboration and jointly organised activities. Define the relevant EU policies and strategies. Ensure maximum contribution, planning of first events organisation and participation.	Project website, C&D strategy, dedicated event calendar, project introduction flyer, project presentation, social media channels, participation to relevant conferences and events presenting EVOLVE2CARE objectives and core foundation, newsletters circulated, organised the first webinar, organisation of planned workshops, liaisons with key relevant initiatives, local and regional media channels, stakeholder community building, co-creation activities for requirements gathering.
Stage 2	Actively reach out to the main target stakeholders and generate interest in EVOLVE2CARE activities and	Create relevant videos, animations and post them on social media channels and the

	outputs. Mobilise and create awareness in the ecosystems around the EVOLVE2CARE and the linked initiatives and stakeholders. Onboard Living Labs and Innovators to the EVOLVE2CARE platform. Foster the knowledge. Best practices exchange around the EVOLVE2CARE concepts. Set a solid foundation for the planned dissemination and communication activities. Showcasing and start policy making/intervention activities. Organisation of first stand-alone or joint events. Impact creation and assessment activities. Onboarding Living Labs to the platform.	EVOLVE2CARE YouTube channel and website. Newsletters, news items, technical papers. Participation in selected events. Promote project use cases. Promote project tools (AccelUP) with dedicated campaigns. Dedicated workshop to present and validate EVOLVE2CARE concept and tools. Jointly organised sessions/webinars. Openly accessible results. Impact research webinars. Standardisation, policy and impact assessment events. Synergise with local and regional media.
Stage 3-Global outreach and sustainability (M15-M24)	Actively engage and support the adoption and deployment of the EVOLVE2CARE concepts technologies and tools offered. Promotion of the EVOLVE2CARE results and validation activities. Development and distribution of promotional materials. Open accessible project results. Participation in selected events. Marketing activities. Business exploitation activities. Impact assessment. Extend liaisons with key stakeholders and relevant initiatives. Promotion of key project results with special campaigns.	Training programmes to key stakeholders (LLs, Innovators). Promotional materials. Dedicated promotional activities. White papers. Newsletters. Interviews. Videos. Marketing activities. Jointly organized webinars/workshops. Impact assessment community activities. Final exploitation and sustainability plan. Policy recommendations. Roadmap and guidelines. Media channels for broad visibility and awareness. Participation to relevant conferences/events (e.g. startup events).

Table 3 presents the audiences targeted by EVOLVE2CARE and the associated impact and benefits for each group.

Table 3 EVOLVE2CARE Target Audiences and related impact

Target Audiences	Benefits and related impact
Innovators (researchers, SMEs, startups, corporates)	Receive personalised matching with LLs based on their goals, expertise and interests. Make informed decisions based on the resources each LL can offer. Acceleration of the experimentation process by facilitating efficient partnerships. Increase visibility. Guidance on creating pitches, presentations, business plans to attract investors.
Accelerators / Investors	Observe how innovations function in authentic environments. Engage in the innovation process by sharing best practices, knowledge bases and resources. New collaborations. Better informed decisions influenced by positive or negative experimentation outcomes.
Living Labs	Opportunity to connect with stakeholders across the globe. Ability to grow their brand name. Open up the market for new high-tech HealthTech products and services. Increased revenue through a market-centric framework.
End-users (Transitional care units, hospitals, practitioners, individuals)	Innovative and effective solutions. Benefit from the real world experimentation processes between innovators and Living Labs. More responsive, resilient and patient-centric healthcare future. Dynamic and controlled environment for testing, refining, and optimizing HealthTech solutions' integration with existing healthcare systems and electronic health records (EHRs). More personalized healthcare systems.
Policy makers / Regulatory bodies	Recognise and support transformative innovation by utilizing LLs collective knowledge on research agendas. Empirical data that can be a valuable resource for policy makers contributing to the current understanding and future formulations of Healthcare regulations.
EU initiatives (i.e. EIT Health projects)	Collaboration opportunities in the area of innovation testing. Utilisation of networking and coordination structures and tools to facilitate innovation development and access to and sharing of best practices, resources, talents, markets, expertise, services and knowledge, including open and collaborative knowledge bases and common knowledge assets (methods, data, processes).

Table 4 Dedicated Communication/Dissemination measures for reaching EVOLVE2CARE target audiences

Audiences	Website	Social media	Media	Events	Mailing	Videos	1to1 meetings
Innovators	✓	✓	✓	✓			✓

Accelerators / Investors	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
Living Labs	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓
End users	✓			✓		✓	
EC initiatives	✓	✓		✓	✓		

Communication and dissemination measures will be continuously monitored. The metrics presented in Table 5 give an overall view of what EVOLVE2CARE expects to achieve.

Table 5 Communication and Dissemination Indicators

TOOL	Indicator(s)	values	TOOL	Indicator(s)	values
Social Media	LinkedIn followers	+600	Events	Major events attended	4
	X followers	+600		EC-events attended	2
	FB followers	+350		EIT KIC events	5
	YouTube followers	+150			
	Impressions (monthly)	+3000			
Website	Monthly unique visitors	+500	Media	Articles in media	+10
	Monthly recurrent visitors	+600		Press releases	10
	Monthly pageviews	+1000			
Mailing campaigns	Mailing campaigns	10	Promotional videos	AccelUP Videos	3
	Open rate	20%		Overall views	+1000

2.2.1.2 Exploitation

The exploitation of the project refers to (1) the project itself, and (2) the experimentation results by the supported innovators within the programme.

(1) The first case provides for the creation of two different lines to further exploit and continue the EVOLVE2CARE initiative beyond the project end. **The tailored training programs** is a key outcome and result which can be further replicated as a “franchised” programme, oriented to facilitate access of deeptech innovators in experimentation spaces where they can accelerate the iteration of experimentation cycles and get real-life feedback. Another important outcome that will be the subject of a collaborative exploitation plan is the **AccelUP Platform**, which will be further developed and verified inside EVOLVE2CARE. Launching a Joint Venture focused to the commercialization of AccelUP experimentation space platform is intended to prepare the way for the go-to-market. The first business development activities will be carried out to spur market demand for the technology, also leveraging on the stakeholders involved during EVOLVE2CARE. **12 – 24 months after the project completion -> Early Customers:** The commercialisation strategy will be implemented in the EU and worldwide, leveraging on AccelUP onboarding mechanism from various distribution channels. (2) EVOLVE2CARE will assist innovators/researchers in setting up an effective commercialization strategy along with helping them in IP matters and regulatory compliance issues. The connection with other experimentation spaces will be also be further investigated.

2.2.2 Strategy for the management of intellectual property

The nature of the project, CSA, is not a traditional research project where results are due to exhaustive IPR issues which usually need deep analysis in the context of the project. The consortium will create a Consortium Agreement (CA) based on standard [DESCA model](#) and will describe all partners’ project related background information and IPR they make available to the project. The CA will be signed by all the project participants before the start of the project. The basic principle is that **knowledge resulting from the project belongs to the project partner who generated it**. If knowledge is generated jointly and separate parts cannot be distinguished, it will be jointly owned, unless the contractors concerned agree on a different solution.

2.3 SUMMARY

SPECIFIC NEEDS		EXPECTED RESULTS	D, C, & E MEASURES
▪ Transitional care improvement: Improved patient/caregiver status, technology, education or coordination of stakeholders; ▪ Faster go2 market in healthtech innovations: Quicker response to healthcare needs, developing fast competitive advantages and rapid regulatory compliance; ▪ Knowledge Enhancement and Collaboration: Increased knowledge on experimentation frameworks derived from LL research (innovators, regulators, providers, and patients); ▪ Regulatory and Cross-sectoral Coordination: Multisectoral coordinated action (innovators and regulators). Identify areas and barriers where pan-European testing and regulations are essential for fostering innovation, with compliance and safety.		ER#1: 1 Scalable, Centralized Experimentation Space (AccelUP) ER#2: 3 Specific Use Cases Addressed ER#3: 100 Living Labs Reached ER#4: 30 Living Labs Onboarded ER#5: 20 commercialization/investment assessments (KTH/Innovation Radar) ER#5: 10 reports on experimentation findings ER#6: 10 Innovation Experiments ER#7: 20 Regulatory Surveys ER#8: 2 Training Programs benefitting 30 LLs and 18 innovators ER#9: 2 Knowledge Sharing Workshops ER#10: 1 Comprehensive Regulatory Review	Communication: Developing a well recognisable project visual identity to stimulate the adoption of the project results and maximize impact // Developing communication material for branding purposes to support the project identity // Creating communication channels to inform relevant stakeholders about the project results, lessons learned, best practices and to announce upcoming events (e.g. webinars, workshops, matchmaking) Dissemination: Publish project's technical e-publications // Attending conferences symposia, seminars, workshops, and other events to present project // Scientific publications // Liaison/Collaboration with EU/EIT KIC projects and communities to ex-change knowledge, lessons learned and best practices // Knowledge sharing sessions Exploitation: Identification of all KERs. Analysis of legal and regulatory aspects for KER exploitation, including // Provide a market assessment analysis, an understanding of the regulatory framework drivers and barriers (both demand and supply side), and the competition landscape for AccelUP // Development of the Go-To-Market strategy with a joint exploitation plan. Deliver investment plan and financial projections for market growth aimed at mobilizing and attracting funds to realize the go-to-market strategy
TARGET GROUPS		OUTCOMES	IMPACT
TG#1: Innovators (researchers, SMEs, startups, corporates) TG#2: Accelerators / Investors TG#3: Living Labs TG#4: End-users (Care units, hospitals, practitioners, individuals) TG#5: Policy makers / Regulatory bodies TG#6: EU initiatives (i.e., EIT Health projects)		EO#1: Increased knowledge on cross-sectoral experimentation frameworks for testing HealthTech innovations. EO#2: Identification of barriers, and actions to address regulatory factors [legal/fiscal/technical/operational] inhibiting the development of innovation. EO#3: Reduced cost (5%), faster time to market (-3 mos.) and lower investment risk for innovators receiving EVOVLE2CARE experimentation services. EO#4: Better deployment and commercialization practices through the service offerings of Living Labs. EO#5: 2M€ Unlocked in Healthcare Savings from innovations validated across stakeholder groups	EI#1: Leveraging the strength of Living Labs produces more interconnected, inclusive, cooperative and efficient HealthTech innovation ecosystems, in the EU and globally; EI#2: Our scaled experimentation space, AccelUP, will enhance inter-regional multidisciplinary collaboration and connectivity; EI#3: Holistic, cross-disciplinary stakeholder research enabled by AccelUP will foster more inclusive and gender equal innovation ecosystems; EI#4: Democratizing access to resources, knowledge, and tools through AccelUP will reduce territorial inequalities in access to innovation support.

3 QUALITY AND EFFICIENCY OF THE IMPLEMENTATION

3.1 WORK PLAN AND RESOURCES

3.1.1 Brief presentation of the overall structure of the work plan

WP1: EVOLVE2CARE experimentation space framework. This WP will concentrate on describing the particular needs of the many stakeholders who may be influenced or affected by the results of experiments. Throughout the project, EVOLVE2CARE will rely on already-established and certified Living Labs, and capitalize on AccelUP (currently in proof of concept phase), a centralised experimentation platform where innovators (researchers, SMEs, start-ups, and corporates) can find and connect with appropriate LL services. An Action Plan will set the specifications of the digital modules to be advanced

WP2: Matching AccelUP Experimentation Space and Services with Innovators and Researchers. This WP entails creating the digital AccelUP marketplace modules required to build up the EVOLVE2CARE experimentation marketplace in accordance with the requirements and services specified in T1.4. It also encapsulates all the core architectural modules for testing the regulatory implications involved in developing and commercializing innovative solutions in the transitional care sector. This WP also includes specialised training for LLs to help them improve their abilities to assist innovators and researchers, and for innovators and researchers to effectively leverage LLs for their innovation projects.

WP3: Set Up of AccelUP experimentation Space and Services Execution, Lessons Learnt and Best practices. This WP includes the onboarding process of innovators and researchers onto the AccelUP platform and the execution of the experimentations, during which innovations in the transitional care sector will be tested in the pre-defined LL infrastructures. The Use Case experiments will be conducted in realistic environments and will be followed by the monitoring and evaluation of each experiment.

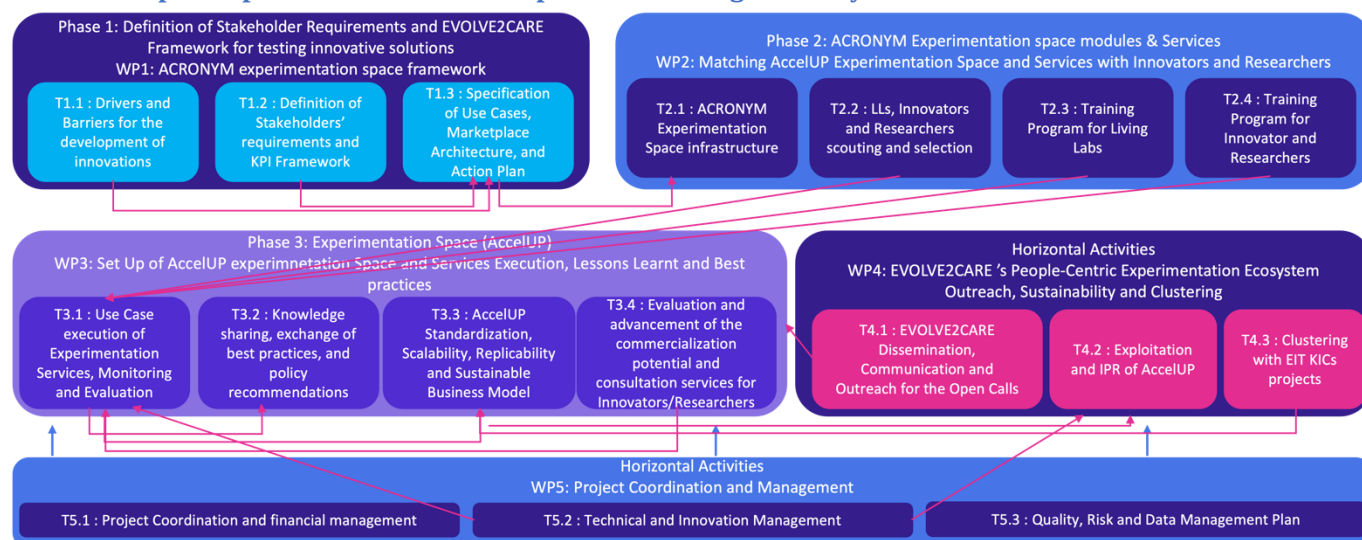
WP4: EVOLVE2CARE's People-Centric Experimentation Ecosystem Outreach, Sustainability and Clustering. WP4 includes the Dissemination, Communication and Exploitation strategy, activities and materials.

Finally, **WP5: Project Coordination and Management** deals with the coordination and management of the overall project implementation.

3.1.2 Timing of the different work packages and their components

		Year 1												Year 2											
	LEADER	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24
Phase 1: Definition of Stakeholder Requirements and EVOLVE2CARE Framework for testing innovative solutions																									
WP1: EVOLVE2CARE experimentation space framework	AUTH																								
Task 1.1 : Drivers and Barriers for the development of innovations	Sploro																								
Task 1.2 : Definition of Stakeholders’ requirements and KPI Framework	AUTH																								
Task 1.3 : Specification of Use Cases, Marketplace Architecture, and Action Plan	AUTH																								
Phase 2: EVOLVE2CARE Experimentation space modules & Services																									
WP2: Matching AccelUP Experimentation Space and Services with Innovators and Researchers	AUTH																								
Task 2.1 : EVOLVE2CARE Experimentation Space infrastructure	AUTH																								
Task 2.2 : LLs, Innovators and Researchers scouting and selection	Sploro																								
Task 2.3 : Training Program for Living Labs	ENOLL																								
Task 2.4 : Training Program for Innovator and Researchers	AV																								
Phase 3: Experimentation Space (AccelUP)																									
WP3: Set Up of AccelUP experimnetation Space and Services Execution, Lessons Learnt and Best practices	AV																								
Task 3.1 : Use Case execution of Experimentation Services, Monitoring and Evaluation	AUTH																								
Task 3.2 : Knowledge sharing, exchange of best practices, and policy recommendations	ENOLL																								
Task 3.3 : AccelUP Standardization, Scalability, Replicability and Sustainable Business Model	AV																								
Task 3.4 : Evaluation and advancement of the commercialization potential and consultation services for Innovators/Researchers	AV																								
Horizontal Activities																									
WP4: EVOLVE2CARE ’s People-Centric Experimentation Ecosystem Outreach, Sustainability and Clustering	Vilabs																								
Task 4.1 : EVOLVE2CARE Dissemination, Communication and Outreach for the Open Calls	Vilabs																								
Task 4.2 : Exploitation and IPR of AccelUP	Vilabs																								
Task 4.3 : Clustering with EIT KICs projects	ENOLL																								
WP5: Project Coordination and Management	AUTH																								
Task 5.1 : Project Coordination and financial management	AUTH																								
Task 5.2 : Technical and Innovation Management	AV																								
Task 5.3 : Quality, Risk and Data Management Plan	Sploro																								

3.1.3 Graphical presentation of the components showing how they inter-relate



3.1.4 Detailed work description

Table 3.1.g: Subcontracting Costs

1. AUTH		
	Cost (€)	Description of tasks and Justification
Subcontracting	N/A	N/A
2. ENoLL		
	Cost (€)	Description of tasks and Justification
Subcontracting	50,000.00	The cost will be subcontracted to onboarded Living Labs into the AccelUP platform for providing services to innovators who have applied to participate in the onboarding process and to experiment their ideas. In total 10 innovative solutions (~€5,000 each) will be tested in 10 different Living Labs.
3. AV		
	Cost (€)	Description of tasks and Justification
Subcontracting	N/A	N/A
4. SPLORO		
	Cost (€)	Description of tasks and Justification
Subcontracting	N/A	N/A
5. VILABS		
	Cost (€)	Description of tasks and Justification
Subcontracting	N/A	N/A

Table 3.1h: ‘Purchase costs’ items (travel and subsistence, equipment and other goods, works and services)

None of the participants would like to declare costs under other “purchase costs” categories (travel and subsistence, equipment and other goods, works and services)

Participant Number/Short Name		
	Cost (€)	Justification
Travel & subsistence	N/A	N/A
Equipment	N/A	N/A
Other goods, works and services	N/A	N/A
Remaining purchase costs (<15% of pers. Costs)	N/A	N/A
Total	N/A	N/A

Table 3.1i: ‘Other costs categories’ items (e.g. internally invoiced goods and services)

None of the participants would like to declare costs under other costs categories (i.e. internally invoiced goods and services)

Participant Number/Short Name		
	Cost (€)	Justification
Internally invoiced goods and services	N/A	N/A

Table 3.1j: ‘In-kind contributions’ provided by third parties

None of the participants would like make use of in-kind contribution.

Participant Number/Short Name				
Third party name		Category	Cost (€)	Justification
N/A		Select between Seconded personnel Travel and subsistence	N/A	N/A
		Equipment Other goods, works and services Internally invoiced goods and services		N/A

3.2 CAPACITY OF PARTICIPANTS AND CONSORTIUM AS A WHOLE

3.2.1 Consortium description

EVOLVE2CARE consortium is composed of five outstanding partners from five EU countries (Greece, Bulgaria, Belgium, Spain, Cyprus). **AUTH** and particularly iMedPhys that undertakes the execution of this project, is the expert organization that has led the design and implementation of ACELLUP in the framework of the VITALISE project (GA# 101007990). AUTH has established a LL, ThessAHALL, that is currently a user-centered innovation and experimentation hub in Central Macedonia, Greece. AUTH has long expertise in European project execution and coordination with a portfolio of more than 70 projects (national and EU). **ENOLL (BE)** is an international, non-profit, independent association of benchmarked Living Labs offering an enlarged network of collaborative testing and experimentation environments, where stakeholders from the quadruple helix i.e., citizens, government, industry, and academia work together to co-create, test, and evaluate innovative solutions in real-world settings. Its aim is to promote the Living Labs concept to influence EU policies, enhance Living Labs services and enable their implementation at a global level. Living Labs provide a unique opportunity to develop and implement experimentation frameworks that are sensitive to the diverse interests and impacts of diverse stakeholders.

ANTHOLOGY VENTURES (BG) is a start-up and business angel studio with a large experience in promoting the commercialization and investment of innovative ideas and research results. AV acts as operational co-founders for

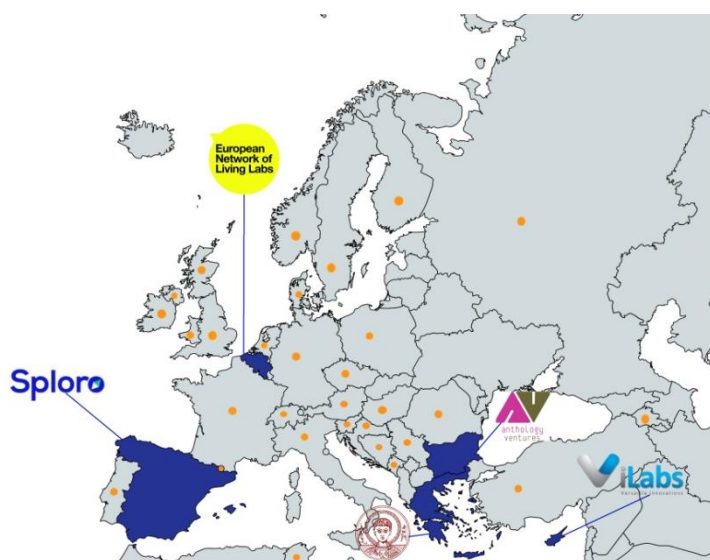


Figure 3 EVOLVE2CARE consortium and reach

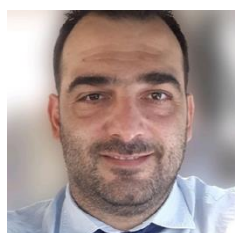
innovative companies in cleantech, healthtech, and robotics but also in more traditional startups oriented to innovative business models. AV's portfolio of start-ups i.e., innovators, includes companies in Greece, Bulgaria, Croatia, Turkey, and Spain. AV is a key partner in the design of the exploitation potential of AccelUP, a key result of the VITALISE project (H2020) in which it is a partner. AV is currently also one of three partners in Ventures Thrive (HORIZON EUROPE), a pan-European venture builder providing €1.5M to deeptech startups.

SPLORO's (ES) mission is as simple as ambitious, making innovations understandable and reachable for any organization through services and digital technologies. Specialised in three areas of business: consulting, cascade funding and their SaaS Kronis, they operate all over Europe from their central office in Spain. Currently part of 6 EU projects and customers from over 20 countries they are specialised in grant funding, innovation management and financial compliance of EU programmes for R&D.

VILABS (CY) is engaged in all stages of research, development, validation, and innovation, and provides national and international organisations with a comprehensive set of services including Project Management, Innovation Support, Gender Analysis, Software R&D, Policy Design, Dissemination & Communication, Public Sector Support, Training & Capacity Building. Throughout the years, VILABS treasured a wide network of national and international partners in Academia & Research; Industry and the Startup community; as well as the Public Sector and Social Groups & NGOs. VILABS brings together multidisciplinary stakeholder groups to collaborate and produce impactful business and societal outcomes.

The consortium counts already with a community of over 480 Living Lab members in Europe and worldwide, over 500 innovators/researchers, 50 investors, and a massive reach of diverse stakeholders such as policy makers regulators, end-users, that can be a lever not only for EVOLVE2CARE but for the whole of EIC KIC communities. In Figure 3 consortium partner countries are represented in blue colour, while the reach of the partners' network either of Living Labs or innovators is marked with a red dot. The role of each partner in the consortium is explained in **Error! Reference source not found.**

3.2.1.1 Coordinator



Dr. Evdokimos Konstantinidis has over 15 years of work experience in EU policies and projects in the R&D field. He is the leader of the Assistive Technologies and Silver Science Research Group in the Medical Physics and Digital Innovation Lab, Aristotle University of Thessaloniki and he has experience in coordinating large European projects such as: i) the Research Infrastructure H2020 project, VITALISE - aiming to harmonize the procedures and ICT tools of the Health and Wellbeing Living Labs towards creating an open ecosystem for the European researchers and ii) the RAISE Horizon Europe funded project on services for the European Open Science Cloud, towards a crowdsource network for data processing. He is the President of European Network of Living Labs (ENoLL) and coordinator of the Health and Wellbeing Living Labs Working Group. In 2020, as a result of the H2020 funded project named CAPTAIN H2020 (technically coordinated by him), he co-founded CAPTAIN-COACH, one of the first 10 spin-offs of AUTH. He has been principal investigator for a couple of national and international funded projects and has authored more than 140 publications in various international peer-reviewed journals and conferences (h-index: 18, ~ 2259 citations).

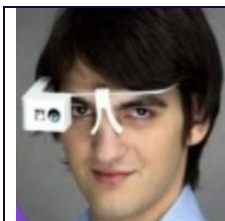
3.2.1.2 Advisory Board



Costas Piliounis is the Managing Director of PNValue, and a Professor of Management at Rome Business School. He has more than 30 years of management experience in the healthcare industry, specifically diagnostics and pharmaceuticals, previously as Corporate Vice President of **NovoNordisk**, and **Chairman of the Board at BluSense**. He is actively **involved with the healthtech startups** ReTouch (Thessaloniki, GR) and Biocos (Crete) and assists startups and spinoffs as an investor, advisor and consultant.



Idoia Muñoz is Managing Director of the Basque Health Cluster, a network partner of EIT Health Spain, and partner of the European Connect Health Alliance. She is also an expert on Living Labs. BHC's mission is to contribute to the **development, growth, and internationalisation of member companies** by creating a **differential value proposal** to boost their competitive advantage, with a main focus on the startup ecosystem specifically the subsectors of health and bioscience, including medtech and robotics.



Cornel Amariei is the Founder and CEO of dotLumen, a Romanian startup building glasses that help the blind live a better life. dotLumen has raised over €15M in private and public investments, including from the EIC. He has extensive technical experience in assistive mobility, sensors, and robotics, and **regulatory expertise in ISO14155, ISO13485 / IEC62304, ISO14971**, and Market Entry for Assistive Technologies & Medical Devices. dotLumen has been awarded by and **participated in several EIT Health programs**, including Headstarter, InnoStars, and Catapult; as well as the EIT Urban Mobility Accelerator.

3.2.1.3 Ethics Advisory Board

The EVOLVE2CARE consortium will also establish an Ethics Advisory Board that will consist of at least 50% external advisors. The external advisors will be identified by the consortium and a formal invitation for participation will be sent to them by the Coordinator. Their role will be to meet with the consortium every six months and provide guidance on ethics issues. All the required documents will be provided to them beforehand. The consortium will also investigate if a Non-Disclosure Agreement has to be signed between the external advisors and the consortium.

3.2.2 Complementarity and contributions of the partners

The partners in the consortium are perfectly fit for a programme of this nature that aims to stimulate experimentation practices. The coordinator, **AUTH** with its experience in leading the activities of developing the AccelUP platform in VITALISE has a pivotal role in the advancement and exploitation of the AccelUP for matching innovators with Living Labs holding great potential for fostering innovation. AUTH developing AccelUP as conceptualized in EVOLVE2CARE, and based on its experience a Living Lab. In the health sector, will advance AccelUP to a centralized platform that streamlines the process of connecting innovators with suitable Living Labs. This efficiency can accelerate the collaboration process and reduce barriers for both parties. AccelUP can showcase a variety of Living Labs, each with its own unique focus and specialization. This diversity of options will allow innovators from various domains to find Living Labs that align with their experimental needs. Finally, AUTH's experience from the Centrifuge & Rehabilitation Living Lab provides a strong foundation for leading innovation activities within the project's defined Use Cases, ensuring that the experimentation is guided by relevant knowledge and insights that can be used and capitalized also in other disciplines. AUTH can facilitate the transfer of knowledge and insights from the Centrifuge & Rehabilitation Living Lab to the new project's teams and collaborators. This knowledge transfer can accelerate the learning curve and ensure that valuable expertise is disseminated.

European Network of Living Labs (ENOLL), brings together a vast network of member organizations (historically 480+ members) offering experimentation environments around EU and globally. With its years of experience, ENOLL, has developed a deep understanding of how to create, manage, and optimize such experimentation spaces. ENOLL promotes a collaborative approach to innovation bringing together various stakeholders, including citizens, researchers, businesses, and governments, fostering a diverse and multidisciplinary environment that is essential for successful experimentation and innovation. Its wide network includes universities, research institutions, companies, and public bodies. This wide-reaching network enables ENOLL to connect the EVOLVE2CARE initiatives with a rich pool of resources, expertise, and potential beneficiaries. ENOLL also acts as a platform for sharing best practices and lessons learned from various living lab projects. This knowledge-sharing aspect can greatly benefit a EVOLVE2CARE promoting experimentation practices, as it provides insights into successful strategies, challenges, and innovative approaches that have worked in different contexts. ENOLL has been active in advocating for policies that support open innovation and experimentation. Their involvement in policy discussions at local, regional, and national levels can help create a favorable environment for testing innovations and ensure alignment with broader regulatory and innovation goals. ENOLL's focus on living labs is not limited to technology-driven projects. They emphasize social innovation, sustainability, and community engagement. This holistic approach ensures that the EVOLVE2CARE goals align with broader societal needs and trends. ENOLL finally provides training, workshops, and capacity-building activities to its members. For the EVOLVE2CARE which aims to stimulate experimentation practices, this means access to resources and knowledge that can enhance the effectiveness and impact of the project. **ANTHOLOGY VENTURES (AV)** has a track record of nurturing startups and Business Angels and understands the challenges and opportunities associated with experimentation, rapid iteration, and scaling new ideas. This experience can be directly applied to EVOLVE2CARE, ensuring effective implementation of the experimentation practices i.e., the Use Cases. AV through its bespoke accelerator, "the Clinic", a 60-day mentoring and coaching program emphasize at rapid and iterative approach to building and refining new concepts. This aligns well with the experimentation mindset, where ideas are tested, adjusted, and improved based on real-world feedback. Anthology Ventures can help structure the project's experimentation process for maximum learning and adaptation. AV is experienced in providing start-ups with resources such as funding, mentorship, workspace, and access to networks. For a project focused on experimentation practices, these resources can facilitate the creation and testing of

prototypes, concepts, and innovative solutions, enhancing the EVOLVE2CARE's overall impact. AV is also accustomed to managing and mitigating risks associated with innovation. It understands that not all experiments will succeed, and they can help design the Use Cases in a way that allows for controlled risk-taking while minimizing potential negative impacts. AV has an established network within the startup ecosystem, including investors, industry experts, and potential collaborators. These connections can be leveraged to bring in additional expertise, funding, and partnerships that are crucial for the success of EVOLVE2CARE stimulating experimentation practices and fostering innovation. Finally, AV's experience on building startups that have the potential to scale rapidly can translate well to the EVOLVE2CARE's scalability goals, as successful experimentation practices can lead to scalable solutions and innovations.

SPLORO, with its validated methodology of linking innovators to financiers can play a significant role in supporting EVOLVE2CARE for stimulating experimentation practices. It will help in developing EVOLVE2CARE methodology for matching innovators with Living Labs and their experimentation spaces. SPLORO's methodology will act as a bridge between innovators with experimental ideas and experimentation spaces that provide real-world testing environments and a network of diverse stakeholders. This methodology will be incorporated into AccelUP to facilitate the identification and connection of suitable innovators with the right Living Labs, fostering a productive collaboration. Its experience in Cascade funding which involves allocating financial resources to innovative projects through a tiered approach can also leverage funding opportunities for the innovations being tested in the Living Lab environments. Funding opportunities through cascade funding can be identified at various stages of experimentation, allowing innovators to develop and refine their concepts within the Living Lab environment. These opportunities for linking innovators with resources that can support the prototype development, testing, and scaling efforts can accelerate the experimentation process by providing innovators with the resources needed to carry out their experiments more effectively and efficiently. This can lead to faster iteration cycles, quicker validation of ideas, and accelerated learning and therefore a greater EVOLVE2CARE impact beyond the project.

VILABS is an SME created in 2011, that acts both as a private research and innovation laboratory and as an innovation Hub for startups. VIL provides a wide range of research, development and consulting services to national as well as international enterprises and organisations, utilising a unique set of tangible and intangible resources, including knowledge, facilities, human and financial resources, supporting researchers and entrepreneurs to innovate. VIL is active in the sectors of ICT, cybersecurity, energy, health, gender and entrepreneurship through all stages of Research, Technological Development and Innovation. VIL has become a leading promoter of linkages between research and/or educational centers, organisations, public and private sector and the industrial world. It has coordinated and provided expert support on EU projects providing high impact and good practices into various concepts and domains.

3.2.3 Industrial / Commercial involvement to ensure exploitation

The exploitation of results needs to be seen at three levels (1) **researchers/innovators**: the aim of the training and services provision (2) **consortium**: Improving their connection with innovators i.e., including deeptech startups as the next "big thing" in the investment arena (3) **AccelUP experimentation space**: the experimentation space will promote experimentation environments around EU which are conducive to innovation. The five partners are committed to building a sustainable product which can be extended and capitalized further after.

4 ETHICS SELF-ASSESSMENT

4.1 ETHICAL DIMENSION OF THE OBJECTIVES, METHODOLOGY AND LIKELY IMPACT

EVOLVE2CARE is not a research project in the strict sense. We are a CSA proposal which will provide support services to innovators/ researchers to decrease barriers to innovation. Regarding ethical aspects of the proposal, it is subject to the Horizon Europe Ethics Review Procedure's Ethics Screening process. At all times throughout the project the consortium will remain fully aware of, and compliant with, the ethical and legal principles and requirements of European Union policy: <http://ec.europa.eu/research/swafs/index.cfm?pg=policy&lib=ethics>

4.2 COMPLIANCE WITH ETHICAL PRINCIPLES AND RELEVANT LEGISLATIONS

EVOLVE2CARE is committed to perform the project in compliance with the General Data Protection Regulation 2016/679 ("GDPR") and any implementing local legislation (collectively referred to as the "EU Data Protection Legislation"). All details about personal data collection, processing, storage and destruction will be specified in the Data Management Plan of the project (D5.1), and specific measures about privacy and protection of personal data will be carried out in the scope of different tasks. One of the main objectives of EVOLVE2CARE project is to identify, catalogue and make it available existing data sources and datasets, including among others, personal data. The project will respect specific existing conditions about access, permissions, etc. to use of all datasets in general and personal datasets in particular. The following aspects, among others, will be considered:

-Identify which personal data are going to be processed, develop a proportionality test in order to verify whether all those data are needed to successfully contact LLs and innovators/researchers to participate in the project, set-up the boundaries of what personal. data will be finally used during the project, and inform partners about those boundaries and complete prohibition of using additional data.

-Develop a Record of Processing Activities, in order to identify activities involving processing of personal data and their purposes. Involved partners will be warned that other purposes regarding the processing of personal data can not be pursued (purpose limitation), unless it is communicated.

- Storage limitation principle will be ensured by design by defining all data retention periods according to the purposes of the processing. Once these data retention periods are defined, the project will implement alerts regarding the expiration date to erase the personal data process in line with the data retention period defined at the beginning of the project. Data erasure methodology will be defined to ensure a safe deletion routine of personal data. Detailed specification of mentioned processes will be provided in the Data Management Plan. All processes will be compliant with national and EU legislation. Specifics about this compliance with EU and national laws will also be included as part of the DMP.

Additionally, partners will ensure that no personal data will be shared between them unless (i) it has been fully anonymized prior to the data sharing, or (2) the specific partners who have elected to exchange or otherwise process Personal Data, have entered into separate data processing agreement and have determined what operational measures should be taken prior to such Personal Data exchange or processing, all in accordance with the EU Data Protection Legislation.

ANNEX 2

ESTIMATED BUDGET (LUMP SUM BREAKDOWN) FOR THE ACTION

	Estimated EU contribution						Maximum grant amount ¹
	Estimated eligible lump sum contributions (per work package)						
	WP1 EVOLVE2CARE experimentation space framework	WP2 Matching AccelUP Experimentation Space and Services with Innovators and Researchers	WP3 Set Up of AccelUP experimentation Space and Services Execution, Lessons Learnt and Best practices	WP4 EVOLVE2CARE's People- Centric Experimentation Ecosystem Outreach, Sustainability and Clustering	WP5 Project Coordination and Management	WP6 Ethics requirements	
	Forms of funding	Lump sum contribution	Lump sum contribution	Lump sum contribution	Lump sum contribution	Lump sum contribution	
	a	b	c	d	e	f	g = a + b + c + d + e + f
1 - AUTH	30 625.00	77 625.00	54 812.50	29 875.00	36 625.00	0.00	229 562.50
2 - ENoLL IVZW	8 750.00	36 375.00	103 875.00	40 500.00	25 000.00	0.00	214 500.00
3 - AV	30 743.70	41 400.90	90 044.10	55 331.84	11 209.60	0.00	228 730.14
4 - SPLORO	13 906.25	127 656.25	12 500.00	13 750.00	12 500.00	0.00	180 312.50
5 - VILABS	2 500.00	5 000.00	3 125.00	108 625.00	14 875.00	0.00	134 125.00
Σ consortium	86 524.95	288 057.15	264 356.60	248 081.84	100 209.60	0.00	987 230.14

¹ The 'maximum grant amount' is the maximum grant amount fixed in the grant agreement (on the basis of the sum of the beneficiaries' lump sum shares for the work packages).

ANNEX 3

ACCESSION FORM FOR BENEFICIARIES

EUROPEAN NETWORK OF LIVING LABS IVZW (ENoLL IVZW), PIC 984556306,
established in KUNSTLAAN 6, SINT JOOST TEN NOODE 1210, Belgium,

hereby agrees

to become beneficiary

in Agreement No 101158152 — EVOLVE2CARE ('the Agreement')

between ARISTOTELIO PANEPISTIMIO THESSALONIKIS (AUTH) **and** the **European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA)** ('EU executive agency' or 'granting authority'), under the powers delegated by the European Commission ('European Commission'),

and mandates

the coordinator to submit and sign in its name and on its behalf any **amendments** to the Agreement, in accordance with Article 39.

By signing this accession form, the beneficiary accepts the grant and agrees to implement it in accordance with the Agreement, with all the obligations and terms and conditions it sets out.

SIGNATURE

For the beneficiary

ANNEX 3

ACCESSION FORM FOR BENEFICIARIES

ANTHOLOGY VENTURES JSC (AV), PIC 895312523, established in 37 G. BENKOVSKI STR.
1ST FLOOR OBOR, SOFIA 1000, Bulgaria,

hereby agrees

to become beneficiary

in Agreement No 101158152 — EVOLVE2CARE ('the Agreement')

between ARISTOTELIO PANEPISTIMIO THESSALONIKIS (AUTH) **and** the **European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA)** ('EU executive agency' or 'granting authority'), under the powers delegated by the European Commission ('European Commission'),

and mandates

the coordinator to submit and sign in its name and on its behalf any **amendments** to the Agreement, in accordance with Article 39.

By signing this accession form, the beneficiary accepts the grant and agrees to implement it in accordance with the Agreement, with all the obligations and terms and conditions it sets out.

SIGNATURE

For the beneficiary

ANNEX 3

ACCESSION FORM FOR BENEFICIARIES

SPLOROTECH SL (SPLORO), PIC 890190147, established in PARQUE TOMAS CABALLERO 2 PLANTA PRIMERA OFICINA 1, PAMPLONA 31006, Spain,

hereby agrees

to become beneficiary

in Agreement No 101158152 — EVOLVE2CARE ('the Agreement')

between ARISTOTELIO PANEPISTIMIO THESSALONIKIS (AUTH) **and** the **European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA)** ('EU executive agency' or 'granting authority'), under the powers delegated by the European Commission ('European Commission'),

and mandates

the coordinator to submit and sign in its name and on its behalf any **amendments** to the Agreement, in accordance with Article 39.

By signing this accession form, the beneficiary accepts the grant and agrees to implement it in accordance with the Agreement, with all the obligations and terms and conditions it sets out.

SIGNATURE

For the beneficiary

Miguel García González with ECAS id n007atxd signed in the Participant Portal on 17/05/2024 at 12:49:41 (transaction id SigId-20950-ZZigWsSwaILZixd7wzX15lnTJ421cu7FT28Dk1GdbbpFEBsSNa2xTQSOsweTG3t8XQuxEVj6fQZm7KQL1YX7ze-yntOf97TTHq5dFosMotCJW-x65CtYBMksN6wggf15bjSy163CQ9GrsgSKPfHP2445XcIEZLijNfhWbYU9mX19titGdO6TfXdsSjoqv1b0xBm0).
Timestamp by third party at
2024.05.17 12:49:45 CEST

ANNEX 3

ACCESSION FORM FOR BENEFICIARIES

VILABS (CY) LTD (VILABS), PIC 917943205, established in VICTORY HOUSE 205 ARCHBISHOP MAKARIOS, LIMASSOL 3030, Cyprus,

hereby agrees

to become beneficiary

in Agreement No 101158152 — EVOLVE2CARE ('the Agreement')

between ARISTOTELIO PANEPISTIMIO THESSALONIKIS (AUTH) **and the European Innovation Council and SMEs Executive Agency (EISMEA)** ('EU executive agency' or 'granting authority'), under the powers delegated by the European Commission ('European Commission'),

and mandates

the coordinator to submit and sign in its name and on its behalf any **amendments** to the Agreement, in accordance with Article 39.

By signing this accession form, the beneficiary accepts the grant and agrees to implement it in accordance with the Agreement, with all the obligations and terms and conditions it sets out.

SIGNATURE

For the beneficiary

Apostolos VONTAS with ECAS id nvontapo signed in the Participant Portal on 17/05/2024 at 13:05:21 (transaction id SigId-21188-kp29 mdh5pxrCi5mB6vJGJMxzSN91cvkTi2CD4LGfYeNIXnsHPWzvLafbKx P7PXJGAGCCLsZDZkQos1JpLTKNBT-yntOf97TTHq5dFosMotCJW-kd BF4D6D7zzyi8CzwACBeeIzO694SiPdgtS8cwW1zu41Om9B5O7JOXI ztNfJNeSHLIXIAfjchiElQaY2MxdkGIW). Timestamp by third party at 2024.05.17 13:05:26 CEST

FINANCIAL STATEMENT FOR THE ACTION FOR REPORTING PERIOD [NUMBER]

EU contribution												
Eligible lump sum contributions (per work package)												Requested EU contribution
	WP1 [name]	WP2 [name]	WP3 [name]	WP4 [name]	WP5 [name]	WP6 [name]	WP7 [name]	WP8 [name]	WP9 [name]	WP10 [name]	WP [XX]	
Forms of funding	[Lump sum contribution// Financing not linked to costs]	[Lump sum contribution// Financing not linked to costs]	[Lump sum contribution// Financing not linked to costs]	[Lump sum contribution// Financing not linked to costs]	[Lump sum contribution// Financing not linked to costs]	[Lump sum contribution// Financing not linked to costs]	[Lump sum contribution// Financing not linked to costs]	[Lump sum contribution// Financing not linked to costs]	[Lump sum contribution// Financing not linked to costs]	[Lump sum contribution// Financing not linked to costs]	[Lump sum contribution// Financing not linked to costs]	
Status of completion	COMPLETED	COMPLETED	COMPLETED	COMPLETED	COMPLETED	COMPLETED	COMPLETED	PARTIALLY COMPLETED	PARTIALLY COMPLETED	COMPLETED	NOT COMPLETED	
	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i	j	k	l = a + b+ c+ d+ e+ f+ g+ h+ i+ j+ k
1 – [short name beneficiary]												
1.1 – [short name affiliated entity]												
2 – [short name beneficiary]												
2.1 – [short name affiliated entity]												
X – [short name associated partner]												
Total consortium												

The consortium hereby confirms that:

The information provided is complete, reliable and true.

The lump sum contributions declared are eligible (in particular, the work packages have been completed and the work has been properly implemented and/or the results were achieved; see Article 6).

The proper implementation of the action/achievement of the results can be substantiated by adequate records and supporting documentation that will be produced upon request or in the context of checks, reviews, audits and investigations (see Articles 19, 21 and 25).

ANNEX 5

SPECIFIC RULES

CONFIDENTIALITY AND SECURITY (— ARTICLE 13)

Sensitive information with security recommendation

Sensitive information with a security recommendation must comply with the additional requirements imposed by the granting authority.

Before starting the action tasks concerned, the beneficiaries must have obtained all approvals or other mandatory documents needed for implementing the task. The documents must be kept on file and be submitted upon request by the coordinator to the granting authority. If they are not in English, they must be submitted together with an English summary.

For requirements restricting disclosure or dissemination, the information must be handled in accordance with the recommendation and may be disclosed or disseminated only after written approval from the granting authority.

EU classified information

If EU classified information is used or generated by the action, it must be treated in accordance with the security classification guide (SCG) and security aspect letter (SAL) set out in Annex 1 and Decision 2015/444¹ and its implementing rules — until it is declassified.

Deliverables which contain EU classified information must be submitted according to special procedures agreed with the granting authority.

Action tasks involving EU classified information may be subcontracted only with prior explicit written approval from the granting authority and only to entities established in an EU Member State or in a non-EU country with a security of information agreement with the EU (or an administrative arrangement with the Commission).

EU classified information may not be disclosed to any third party (including participants involved in the action implementation) without prior explicit written approval from the granting authority.

ETHICS (— ARTICLE 14)

Ethics and research integrity

The beneficiaries must carry out the action in compliance with:

- ethical principles (including the highest standards of research integrity)

¹ Commission Decision 2015/444/EC, Euratom of 13 March 2015 on the security rules for protecting EU classified information (OJ L 72, 17.3.2015, p. 53).

and

- applicable EU, international and national law, including the EU Charter of Fundamental Rights and the European Convention for the Protection of Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms and its Supplementary Protocols.

No funding can be granted, within or outside the EU, for activities that are prohibited in all Member States. No funding can be granted in a Member State for an activity which is forbidden in that Member State.

The beneficiaries must pay particular attention to the principle of proportionality, the right to privacy, the right to the protection of personal data, the right to the physical and mental integrity of persons, the right to non-discrimination, the need to ensure protection of the environment and high levels of human health protection.

The beneficiaries must ensure that the activities under the action have an exclusive focus on civil applications.

The beneficiaries must ensure that the activities under the action do not:

- aim at human cloning for reproductive purposes
- intend to modify the genetic heritage of human beings which could make such modifications heritable (with the exception of research relating to cancer treatment of the gonads, which may be financed)
- intend to create human embryos solely for the purpose of research or for the purpose of stem cell procurement, including by means of somatic cell nuclear transfer, or
- lead to the destruction of human embryos (for example, for obtaining stem cells).

Activities involving research on human embryos or human embryonic stem cells may be carried out only if:

- they are set out in Annex 1 or
- the coordinator has obtained explicit approval (in writing) from the granting authority.

In addition, the beneficiaries must respect the fundamental principle of research integrity — as set out in the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity².

This implies compliance with the following principles:

- reliability in ensuring the quality of research reflected in the design, the methodology, the analysis and the use of resources
- honesty in developing, undertaking, reviewing, reporting and communicating research in a transparent, fair and unbiased way

² European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity of ALLEA (All European Academies).

- respect for colleagues, research participants, society, ecosystems, cultural heritage and the environment
- accountability for the research from idea to publication, for its management and organisation, for training, supervision and mentoring, and for its wider impacts

and means that beneficiaries must ensure that persons carrying out research tasks follow the good research practices including ensuring, where possible, openness, reproducibility and traceability and refrain from the research integrity violations described in the Code.

Activities raising ethical issues must comply with the additional requirements formulated by the ethics panels (including after checks, reviews or audits; see Article 25).

Before starting an action task raising ethical issues, the beneficiaries must have obtained all approvals or other mandatory documents needed for implementing the task, notably from any (national or local) ethics committee or other bodies such as data protection authorities.

The documents must be kept on file and be submitted upon request by the coordinator to the granting authority. If they are not in English, they must be submitted together with an English summary, which shows that the documents cover the action tasks in question and includes the conclusions of the committee or authority concerned (if any).

VALUES (— ARTICLE 14)

Gender mainstreaming

The beneficiaries must take all measures to promote equal opportunities between men and women in the implementation of the action and, where applicable, in line with the gender equality plan. They must aim, to the extent possible, for a gender balance at all levels of personnel assigned to the action, including at supervisory and managerial level.

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY RIGHTS (IPR) — BACKGROUND AND RESULTS — ACCESS RIGHTS AND RIGHTS OF USE (— ARTICLE 16)

Definitions

Access rights — Rights to use results or background.

Dissemination — The public disclosure of the results by appropriate means, other than resulting from protecting or exploiting the results, including by scientific publications in any medium.

Exploit(ation) — The use of results in further research and innovation activities other than those covered by the action concerned, including among other things, commercial exploitation such as developing, creating, manufacturing and marketing a product or process, creating and providing a service, or in standardisation activities.

Fair and reasonable conditions — Appropriate conditions, including possible financial terms or royalty-free conditions, taking into account the specific circumstances of the request for access, for example the actual or potential value of the results or background to which access is requested and/or the scope, duration or other characteristics of the exploitation envisaged.

FAIR principles — ‘findability’, ‘accessibility’, ‘interoperability’ and ‘reusability’.

Open access — Online access to research outputs provided free of charge to the end-user.

Open science — An approach to the scientific process based on open cooperative work, tools and diffusing knowledge.

Research data management — The process within the research lifecycle that includes the organisation, storage, preservation, security, quality assurance, allocation of persistent identifiers (PIDs) and rules and procedures for sharing of data including licensing.

Research outputs — Results to which access can be given in the form of scientific publications, data or other engineered results and processes such as software, algorithms, protocols, models, workflows and electronic notebooks.

Scope of the obligations

For this section, references to ‘beneficiary’ or ‘beneficiaries’ do not include affiliated entities (if any).

Agreement on background

The beneficiaries must identify in a written agreement the background as needed for implementing the action or for exploiting its results.

Where the call conditions restrict control due to strategic interests reasons, background that is subject to control or other restrictions by a country (or entity from a country) which is not one of the eligible countries or target countries set out in the call conditions and that impact the exploitation of the results (i.e. would make the exploitation of the results subject to control or restrictions) must not be used and must be explicitly excluded from it in the agreement on background — unless otherwise agreed with the granting authority.

Ownership of results

Results are owned by the beneficiaries that generate them.

However, two or more beneficiaries own results jointly if:

- they have jointly generated them and
- it is not possible to:
 - establish the respective contribution of each beneficiary, or
 - separate them for the purpose of applying for, obtaining or maintaining their protection.

The joint owners must agree — in writing — on the allocation and terms of exercise of their joint ownership (**‘joint ownership agreement’**), to ensure compliance with their obligations under this Agreement.

Unless otherwise agreed in the joint ownership agreement or consortium agreement, each joint owner may grant non-exclusive licences to third parties to exploit the jointly-owned results (without any right to sub-license), if the other joint owners are given:

- at least 45 days advance notice and
- fair and reasonable compensation.

The joint owners may agree — in writing — to apply another regime than joint ownership.

If third parties (including employees and other personnel) may claim rights to the results, the beneficiary concerned must ensure that those rights can be exercised in a manner compatible with its obligations under the Agreement.

The beneficiaries must indicate the owner(s) of the results (results ownership list) in the final periodic report.

Protection of results

Beneficiaries which have received funding under the grant must adequately protect their results — for an appropriate period and with appropriate territorial coverage — if protection is possible and justified, taking into account all relevant considerations, including the prospects for commercial exploitation, the legitimate interests of the other beneficiaries and any other legitimate interests.

Exploitation of results

Beneficiaries which have received funding under the grant must — up to four years after the end of the action (see Data Sheet, Point 1) — use their best efforts to exploit their results directly or to have them exploited indirectly by another entity, in particular through transfer or licensing.

If, despite a beneficiary's best efforts, the results are not exploited within one year after the end of the action, the beneficiaries must (unless otherwise agreed in writing with the granting authority) use the Horizon Results Platform to find interested parties to exploit the results.

If results are incorporated in a standard, the beneficiaries must (unless otherwise agreed with the granting authority or unless it is impossible) ask the standardisation body to include the funding statement (see Article 17) in (information related to) the standard.

Additional exploitation obligations

Where the call conditions impose additional exploitation obligations (including obligations linked to the restriction of participation or control due to strategic assets, interests, autonomy or security reasons), the beneficiaries must comply with them — up to four years after the end of the action (see Data Sheet, Point 1).

Where the call conditions impose additional exploitation obligations in case of a public emergency, the beneficiaries must (if requested by the granting authority) grant for a limited period of time specified in the request, non-exclusive licences — under fair and reasonable conditions — to their results to legal entities that need the results to address the public emergency and commit to rapidly and broadly exploit the resulting products and services at fair and reasonable conditions. This provision applies up to four years after the end of the action (see Data Sheet, Point 1).

Additional information obligation relating to standards

Where the call conditions impose additional information obligations relating to possible standardisation, the beneficiaries must — up to four years after the end of the action (see Data Sheet, Point 1) — inform the granting authority, if the results could reasonably be expected to contribute to European or international standards.

Transfer and licensing of results

Transfer of ownership

The beneficiaries may transfer ownership of their results, provided this does not affect compliance with their obligations under the Agreement.

The beneficiaries must ensure that their obligations under the Agreement regarding their results are passed on to the new owner and that this new owner has the obligation to pass them on in any subsequent transfer.

Moreover, they must inform the other beneficiaries with access rights of the transfer at least 45 days in advance (or less if agreed in writing), unless agreed otherwise in writing for specifically identified third parties including affiliated entities or unless impossible under the applicable law. This notification must include sufficient information on the new owner to enable the beneficiaries concerned to assess the effects on their access rights. The beneficiaries may object within 30 days of receiving notification (or less if agreed in writing), if they can show that the transfer would adversely affect their access rights. In this case, the transfer may not take place until agreement has been reached between the beneficiaries concerned.

Granting licences

The beneficiaries may grant licences to their results (or otherwise give the right to exploit them), including on an exclusive basis, provided this does not affect compliance with their obligations.

Exclusive licences for results may be granted only if all the other beneficiaries concerned have waived their access rights.

Granting authority right to object to transfers or licensing — Horizon Europe actions

Where the call conditions in Horizon Europe actions provide for the right to object to transfers or licensing, the granting authority may — up to four years after the end of the action (see Data Sheet, Point 1) — object to a transfer of ownership or the exclusive licensing of results, if:

- the beneficiaries which generated the results have received funding under the grant
- it is to a legal entity established in a non-EU country not associated with Horizon Europe, and
- the granting authority considers that the transfer or licence is not in line with EU interests.

Beneficiaries that intend to transfer ownership or grant an exclusive licence must formally notify the granting authority before the intended transfer or licensing takes place and:

- identify the specific results concerned
- describe in detail the new owner or licensee and the planned or potential exploitation of the results, and
- include a reasoned assessment of the likely impact of the transfer or licence on EU interests, in particular regarding competitiveness as well as consistency with ethical principles and security considerations.

The granting authority may request additional information.

If the granting authority decides to object to a transfer or exclusive licence, it must formally notify the beneficiary concerned within 60 days of receiving notification (or any additional information it has requested).

No transfer or licensing may take place in the following cases:

- pending the granting authority decision, within the period set out above
- if the granting authority objects
- until the conditions are complied with, if the granting authority objection comes with conditions.

A beneficiary may formally notify a request to waive the right to object regarding intended transfers or grants to a specifically identified third party, if measures safeguarding EU interests are in place. If the granting authority agrees, it will formally notify the beneficiary concerned within 60 days of receiving notification (or any additional information requested).

Granting authority right to object to transfers or licensing — Euratom actions

Where the call conditions in Euratom actions provide for the right to object to transfers or licensing, the granting authority may — up to four years after the end of the action (see Data Sheet, Point 1) — object to a transfer of ownership or the exclusive or non-exclusive licensing of results, if:

- the beneficiaries which generated the results have received funding under the grant
- it is to a legal entity established in a non-EU country not associated to the Euratom Research and Training Programme 2021-2025 and
- the granting authority considers that the transfer or licence is not in line with the EU interests.

Beneficiaries that intend to transfer ownership or grant a licence must formally notify the granting authority before the intended transfer or licensing takes place and:

- identify the specific results concerned
- describe in detail the results, the new owner or licensee and the planned or potential exploitation of the results, and
- include a reasoned assessment of the likely impact of the transfer or licence on EU interests, in particular regarding competitiveness as well as consistency with

ethical principles and security considerations (including the defence interests of the EU Member States under Article 24 of the Euratom Treaty).

The granting authority may request additional information.

If the granting authority decides to object to a transfer or licence, it will formally notify the beneficiary concerned within 60 days of receiving notification (or any additional information requested).

No transfer or licensing may take place in the following cases:

- pending the granting authority decision, within the period set out above
- if the granting authority objects
- until the conditions are complied with, if the granting authority objection comes with conditions.

A beneficiary may formally notify a request to waive the right to object regarding intended transfers or grants to a specifically identified third party, if measures safeguarding EU interests are in place. If the granting authority agrees, it will formally notify the beneficiary concerned within 60 days of receiving notification (or any additional information requested).

Limitations to transfers and licensing due to strategic assets, interests, autonomy or security reasons of the EU and its Member States

Where the call conditions restrict participation or control due to strategic assets, interests, autonomy or security reasons, the beneficiaries may not transfer ownership of their results or grant licences to third parties which are established in countries which are not eligible countries or target countries set out in the call conditions (or, if applicable, are controlled by such countries or entities from such countries) — unless they have requested and received prior approval by the granting authority.

The request must:

- identify the specific results concerned
- describe in detail the new owner and the planned or potential exploitation of the results, and
- include a reasoned assessment of the likely impact of the transfer or license on the strategic assets, interests, autonomy or security of the EU and its Member States.

The granting authority may request additional information.

Access rights to results and background

Exercise of access rights — Waiving of access rights — No sub-licensing

Requests to exercise access rights and the waiver of access rights must be in writing.

Unless agreed otherwise in writing with the beneficiary granting access, access rights do not include the right to sub-license.

If a beneficiary is no longer involved in the action, this does not affect its obligations to grant access.

If a beneficiary defaults on its obligations, the beneficiaries may agree that that beneficiary no longer has access rights.

Access rights for implementing the action

The beneficiaries must grant each other access — on a royalty-free basis — to background needed to implement their own tasks under the action, unless the beneficiary that holds the background has — before acceding to the Agreement —:

- informed the other beneficiaries that access to its background is subject to restrictions, or
- agreed with the other beneficiaries that access would not be on a royalty-free basis.

The beneficiaries must grant each other access — on a royalty-free basis — to results needed for implementing their own tasks under the action.

Access rights for exploiting the results

The beneficiaries must grant each other access — under fair and reasonable conditions — to results needed for exploiting their results.

The beneficiaries must grant each other access — under fair and reasonable conditions — to background needed for exploiting their results, unless the beneficiary that holds the background has — before acceding to the Agreement — informed the other beneficiaries that access to its background is subject to restrictions.

Requests for access must be made — unless agreed otherwise in writing — up to one year after the end of the action (see Data Sheet, Point 1).

Access rights for entities under the same control

Unless agreed otherwise in writing by the beneficiaries, access to results and, subject to the restrictions referred to above (if any), background must also be granted — under fair and reasonable conditions — to entities that:

- are established in an EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country
- are under the direct or indirect control of another beneficiary, or under the same direct or indirect control as that beneficiary, or directly or indirectly controlling that beneficiary and
- need the access to exploit the results of that beneficiary.

Unless agreed otherwise in writing, such requests for access must be made by the entity directly to the beneficiary concerned.

Requests for access must be made — unless agreed otherwise in writing — up to one year after the end of the action (see Data Sheet, Point 1).

Access rights for the granting authority, EU institutions, bodies, offices or agencies and national authorities to results for policy purposes — Horizon Europe actions

In Horizon Europe actions, the beneficiaries which have received funding under the grant must grant access to their results — on a royalty-free basis — to the granting authority, EU institutions, bodies, offices or agencies for developing, implementing and monitoring EU policies or programmes. Such access rights do not extend to beneficiaries' background.

Such access rights are limited to non-commercial and non-competitive use.

For actions under the cluster 'Civil Security for Society', such access rights also extend to national authorities of EU Member States for developing, implementing and monitoring their policies or programmes in this area. In this case, access is subject to a bilateral agreement to define specific conditions ensuring that:

- the access rights will be used only for the intended purpose and
- appropriate confidentiality obligations are in place.

Moreover, the requesting national authority or EU institution, body, office or agency (including the granting authority) must inform all other national authorities of such a request.

Access rights for the granting authority, Euratom institutions, funding bodies or the Joint Undertaking Fusion for Energy — Euratom actions

In Euratom actions, the beneficiaries which have received funding under the grant must grant access to their results — on a royalty-free basis — to the granting authority, Euratom institutions, funding bodies or the Joint Undertaking Fusion for Energy for developing, implementing and monitoring Euratom policies and programmes or for compliance with obligations assumed through international cooperation with non-EU countries and international organisations.

Such access rights include the right to authorise third parties to use the results in public procurement and the right to sub-license and are limited to non-commercial and non-competitive use.

Additional access rights

Where the call conditions impose additional access rights, the beneficiaries must comply with them.

**COMMUNICATION, DISSEMINATION, OPEN SCIENCE AND VISIBILITY (—
ARTICLE 17)**

Dissemination

Dissemination of results

The beneficiaries must disseminate their results as soon as feasible, in a publicly available format, subject to any restrictions due to the protection of intellectual property, security rules or legitimate interests.

A beneficiary that intends to disseminate its results must give at least 15 days advance notice to the other beneficiaries (unless agreed otherwise), together with sufficient information on the results it will disseminate.

Any other beneficiary may object within (unless agreed otherwise) 15 days of receiving notification, if it can show that its legitimate interests in relation to the results or background would be significantly harmed. In such cases, the results may not be disseminated unless appropriate steps are taken to safeguard those interests.

Additional dissemination obligations

Where the call conditions impose additional dissemination obligations, the beneficiaries must also comply with those.

Open Science

Open science: open access to scientific publications

The beneficiaries must ensure open access to peer-reviewed scientific publications relating to their results. In particular, they must ensure that:

- at the latest at the time of publication, a machine-readable electronic copy of the published version or the final peer-reviewed manuscript accepted for publication, is deposited in a trusted repository for scientific publications
- immediate open access is provided to the deposited publication via the repository, under the latest available version of the Creative Commons Attribution International Public Licence (CC BY) or a licence with equivalent rights; for monographs and other long-text formats, the licence may exclude commercial uses and derivative works (e.g. CC BY-NC, CC BY-ND) and
- information is given via the repository about any research output or any other tools and instruments needed to validate the conclusions of the scientific publication.

Beneficiaries (or authors) must retain sufficient intellectual property rights to comply with the open access requirements.

Metadata of deposited publications must be open under a Creative Common Public Domain Dedication (CC 0) or equivalent, in line with the FAIR principles (in particular machine-actionable) and provide information at least about the following: publication (author(s), title, date of publication, publication venue); Horizon Europe or Euratom funding; grant project name, acronym and number; licensing terms; persistent identifiers for the publication, the authors involved in the action and, if possible, for their organisations and the grant. Where applicable, the metadata must include persistent identifiers for any research output or any other tools and instruments needed to validate the conclusions of the publication.

Only publication fees in full open access venues for peer-reviewed scientific publications are eligible for reimbursement.

Open science: research data management

The beneficiaries must manage the digital research data generated in the action ('data') responsibly, in line with the FAIR principles and by taking all of the following actions:

- establish a data management plan ('DMP') (and regularly update it)

- as soon as possible and within the deadlines set out in the DMP, deposit the data in a trusted repository; if required in the call conditions, this repository must be federated in the EOSC in compliance with EOSC requirements
- as soon as possible and within the deadlines set out in the DMP, ensure open access — via the repository — to the deposited data, under the latest available version of the Creative Commons Attribution International Public License (CC BY) or Creative Commons Public Domain Dedication (CC 0) or a licence with equivalent rights, following the principle ‘as open as possible as closed as necessary’, unless providing open access would in particular:
 - be against the beneficiary’s legitimate interests, including regarding commercial exploitation, or
 - be contrary to any other constraints, in particular the EU competitive interests or the beneficiary’s obligations under this Agreement; if open access is not provided (to some or all data), this must be justified in the DMP
- provide information via the repository about any research output or any other tools and instruments needed to re-use or validate the data.

Metadata of deposited data must be open under a Creative Commons Public Domain Dedication (CC 0) or equivalent (to the extent legitimate interests or constraints are safeguarded), in line with the FAIR principles (in particular machine-actionable) and provide information at least about the following: datasets (description, date of deposit, author(s), venue and embargo); Horizon Europe or Euratom funding; grant project name, acronym and number; licensing terms; persistent identifiers for the dataset, the authors involved in the action, and, if possible, for their organisations and the grant. Where applicable, the metadata must include persistent identifiers for related publications and other research outputs.

Open science: additional practices

Where the call conditions impose additional obligations regarding open science practices, the beneficiaries must also comply with those.

Where the call conditions impose additional obligations regarding the validation of scientific publications, the beneficiaries must provide (digital or physical) access to data or other results needed for validation of the conclusions of scientific publications, to the extent that their legitimate interests or constraints are safeguarded (and unless they already provided the (open) access at publication).

Where the call conditions impose additional open science obligations in case of a public emergency, the beneficiaries must (if requested by the granting authority) immediately deposit any research output in a repository and provide open access to it under a CC BY licence, a Public Domain Dedication (CC 0) or equivalent. As an exception, if the access would be against the beneficiaries’ legitimate interests, the beneficiaries must grant non-exclusive licenses — under fair and reasonable conditions — to legal entities that need the research output to address the public emergency and commit to rapidly and broadly exploit the resulting products and services at fair and reasonable conditions. This provision applies up to four years after the end of the action (see Data Sheet, Point 1).

Plan for the exploitation and dissemination of results including communication activities

Unless excluded by the call conditions, the beneficiaries must provide and regularly update a plan for the exploitation and dissemination of results including communication activities.

SPECIFIC RULES FOR CARRYING OUT THE ACTION (— ARTICLE 18)

Implementation in case of restrictions due to strategic assets, interests, autonomy or security of the EU and its Member States

Where the call conditions restrict participation or control due to strategic assets, interests, autonomy or security, the beneficiaries must ensure that none of the entities that participate as affiliated entities, associated partners, subcontractors or recipients of financial support to third parties are established in countries which are not eligible countries or target countries set out in the call conditions (or, if applicable, are controlled by such countries or entities from such countries) — unless otherwise agreed with the granting authority.

The beneficiaries must moreover ensure that any cooperation with entities established in countries which are not eligible countries or target countries set out in the call conditions (or, if applicable, are controlled by such countries or entities from such countries) does not affect the strategic assets, interests, autonomy or security of the EU and its Member States.

Recruitment and working conditions for researchers

The beneficiaries must take all measures to implement the principles set out in the Commission Recommendation on the European Charter for Researchers and the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers³, in particular regarding:

- working conditions
- transparent recruitment processes based on merit, and
- career development.

The beneficiaries must ensure that researchers and all participants involved in the action are aware of them.

Specific rules for access to research infrastructure activities

Definitions

Research Infrastructures — Facilities that provide resources and services for the research communities to conduct research and foster innovation in their fields. This definition includes the associated human resources, and it covers major equipment or sets of instruments; knowledge-related facilities such as collections, archives or scientific data infrastructures; computing systems, communication networks, and any other infrastructure, of a unique nature and open to external users, essential to achieve excellence in research and innovation. Where relevant, they may be used beyond research, for example

³ Commission Recommendation 2005/251/EC of 11 March 2005 on the European Charter for Researchers and on a Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers (OJ L 75, 22.3.2005, p. 67).

for education or public services, and they may be ‘single-sited’, ‘virtual’ or ‘distributed’⁴:

When implementing access to research infrastructure activities, the beneficiaries must respect the following conditions:

- for transnational access:

- access which must be provided:

The access must be free of charge, transnational access to research infrastructure or installations for selected user-groups.

The access must include the logistical, technological and scientific support and the specific training that is usually provided to external researchers using the infrastructure. Transnational access can be either in person (hands-on), provided to selected users that visit the installation to make use of it, or remote, through the provision to selected user-groups of remote scientific services (e.g. provision of reference materials or samples, remote access to a high-performance computing facility).

- categories of users that may have access:

Transnational access must be provided to selected user-groups, i.e. teams of one or more researchers (users).

The majority of the users must work in a country other than the country(ies) where the installation is located (unless access is provided by an international organisation, the Joint Research Centre (JRC), an ERIC or similar legal entity).

Only user groups that are allowed to disseminate the results they have generated under the action may benefit from the access (unless the users are working for SMEs).

Access for user groups with a majority of users not working in a EU Member State or Horizon Europe associated country is limited to 20% of the total amount of units of access provided under the grant (unless a higher percentage is foreseen in Annex 1).

- procedure and criteria for selecting user groups:

The user groups must request access by submitting (in writing) a description of the work that they wish to carry out and the names, nationalities and home institutions of the users.

The user groups must be selected by (one or more) selection panels set up by the consortium.

⁴ See Article 2(1) of the Horizon Europe Framework Programme Regulation 2021/695.

The selection panels must be composed of international experts in the field, at least half of them independent from the consortium (unless otherwise specified in Annex 1).

The selection panels must assess all proposals received and recommend a short-list of the user groups that should benefit from access.

The selection panels must base their selection on scientific merit, taking into account that priority should be given to user groups composed of users who:

- have not previously used the installation and
- are working in countries where no equivalent research infrastructure exist.

It will apply the principles of transparency, fairness and impartiality.

Where the call conditions impose additional rules for the selection of user groups, the beneficiaries must also comply with those.

- other conditions:

The beneficiaries must request written approval from the granting authority for the selection of user groups requiring visits to the installations exceeding 3 months (unless such visits are foreseen in Annex 1).

In addition, the beneficiaries must:

- advertise widely, including on a their websites, the access offered under the Agreement
 - promote equal opportunities in advertising the access and take into account the gender dimension when defining the support provided to users
 - ensure that users comply with the terms and conditions of the Agreement
 - ensure that its obligations under Articles 12, 13, 17 and 33 also apply to the users
 - keep records of the names, nationalities, and home institutions of users, as well as the nature and quantity of access provided to them
- for virtual access:
 - access which must be provided:

The access must be free of charge, virtual access to research infrastructure or installations.

‘Virtual access’ means open and free access through communication networks to digital resources and services needed for research, without selecting the users to whom access is provided.

The access must include the support that is usually provided to external users.

Where allowed by the call conditions, beneficiaries may in justified cases define objective eligibility criteria (e.g. affiliation to a research or academic institution) for specific users.

- other conditions:

The beneficiaries must have the virtual access services assessed periodically by a board composed of international experts in the field, at least half of whom must be independent from the consortium (unless otherwise specified in Annex 1). For this purpose, information and statistics on the users and the nature and quantity of the access provided, must be made available to the board.

The beneficiaries must advertise widely, including on a dedicated website, the access offered under the grant and the eligibility criteria, if any.

Where the call conditions impose additional traceability⁵ obligations, information on the traceability of the users and the nature and quantity of access must be provided by the beneficiaries.

These obligations apply regardless of the form of funding or budget categories used to declare the costs (unit costs or actual costs or a combination of the two).

⁵ According to the definition given in ISO 9000, i.e.: “Traceability is the ability to trace the history, application, use and location of an item or its characteristics through recorded identification data.” The users can be traced, for example, by authentication and/or by authorization or by other means that allows for analysis of the type of users and the nature and quantity of access provided.



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